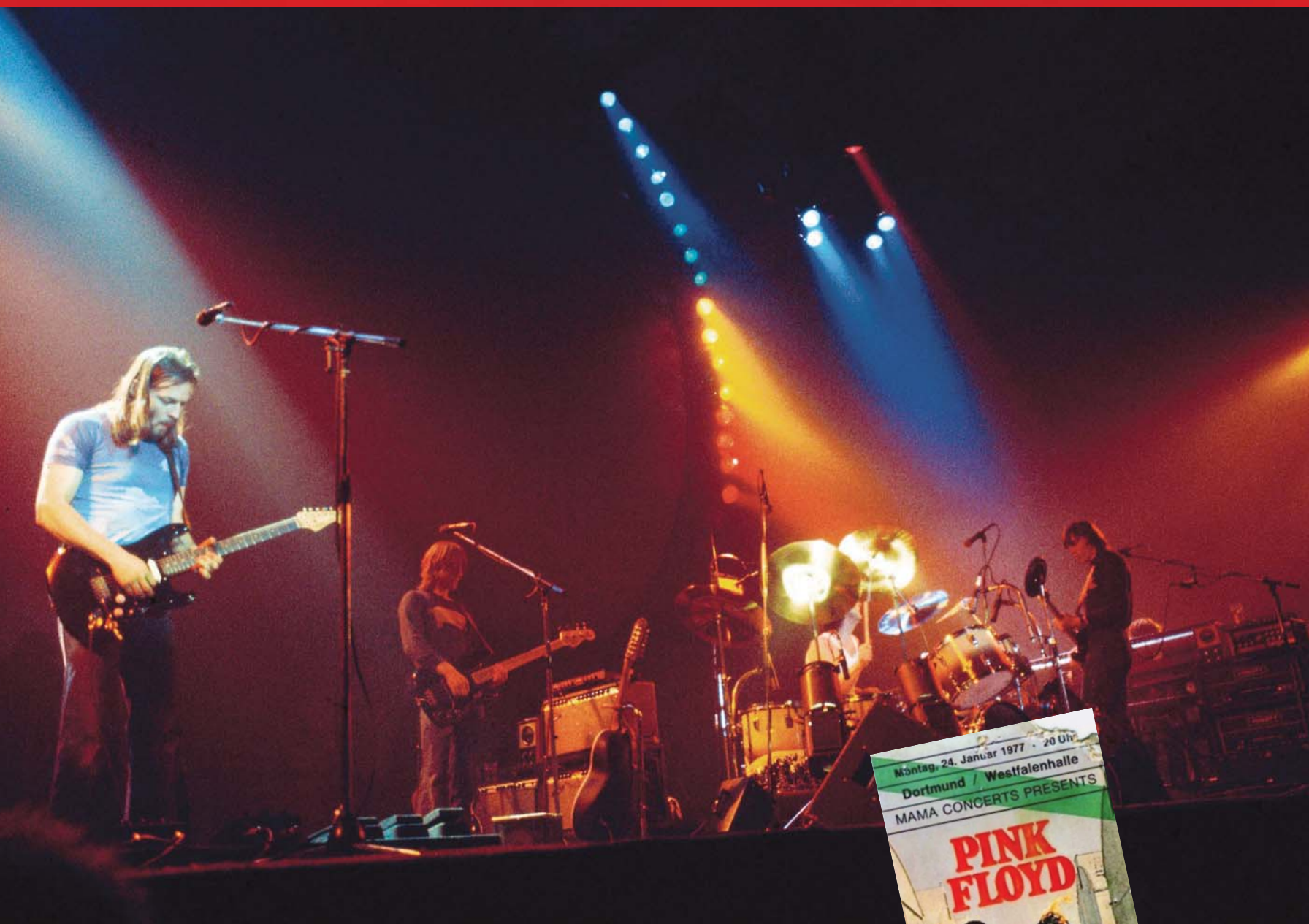




ABOVE: Pink Floyd performing live onstage during the Animals tour on March 1, 1977.



RIGHT: 1977 ticket to a Pink Floyd concert in Dortmund, Germany.



WATERS EVENTUALLY SNAPPED ON THE LAST NIGHT OF THE TOUR WHEN HE SPAT IN THE FACE OF A CONCERTGOER...

ABOVE: Posters promoting Pink Floyd concerts in Chicago and Oakland in the U.S.

The European dates took place in arenas, but when the *In the Flesh* tour reached the U.S. in April the band played several outdoor shows in sports stadiums. To meet the added scale of these shows, more inflatables were added: a television, a Cadillac, and a refrigerator with a door that opened to reveal a clew of worms—a pungent comment on the consumerism and decay the band were railing against. For the first few stadium dates, a second pig was added, too, and would rise up from behind the stage, reaching a height of some 300 ft. before bursting into flames. The second pig’s showbusiness career came to an early end, however, when an overeager member of the production crew filled the inflatable with a mixture of acetylene and oxygen (rather than the usual propane) for the show at Milwaukee County Stadium. As it rose up above the stage, the pig exploded with a deafening noise that startled the band and sent pieces of flaming plastic showering back down to Earth.

Pink Floyd set new attendance records across the U.S., playing to 80,000 people in Cleveland and Montreal, and more than 95,000 at Soldier Field Stadium in Chicago (a figure disputed by the promoter until manager Steve O’Rourke hired a helicopter to fly over and photograph the crowd), but they found playing to such large crowds—in what was frequently a rowdy circus atmosphere—unpleasant, particularly as it went against the very themes they were attempting to address. Whereas European crowds usually came to see the show—and could be relied upon to be noisily appreciative—the audiences at these U.S. shows

seemed to be there purely to party, and the irony that the band’s spectacular staging effects were simply adding to the carnival feel was not lost on them. Waters in particular found the U.S. tour dispiriting, and he would sometimes berate audiences if he felt they were not paying attention. By now, he was also traveling separately from the rest of the group, and the mood among them was sullen at best.

Waters eventually snapped on July 6, the last night of the tour, at the Stade Olympique in Montreal, Canada. In the weeks leading up to the show, he had failed to emerge for the encore at Philadelphia’s Spectrum theater, and he had sworn at an audience in New York’s Madison Square Garden when people started letting off firecrackers. In Montreal he became increasingly agitated by the behavior of some unruly fans in front of the stage, and during “Pigs” he beckoned a male concertgoer toward him before deliberately spitting in his face.

The rest of the audience was largely unaware of what had happened, but for the band it was a depressing way to end the tour. This time it was Gilmour who skipped the encore, choosing instead to watch from the sound desk as the others played a slow 12-bar blues. As the band played on, the road crew gradually dismantled their equipment before physically removing the musicians—Pink Floyd’s preferred method of letting the stadium crowd know that the show really was over. As it turned out, this would be the last ever tour by Pink Floyd in their current guise, although they did have one more spectacular show to perform.

GILMOUR'S GEAR

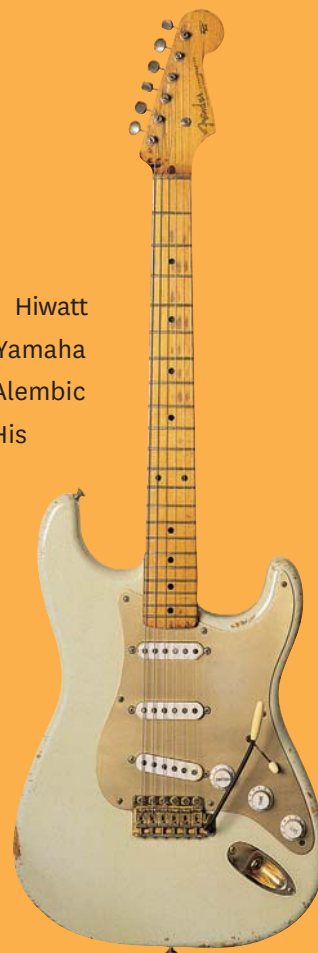
David Gilmour has always been associated with the Fender Stratocaster guitar. His infatuation with the instrument began when he saw Hank Marvin, lead guitarist in the British instrumental group the Shadows, play one in the early 1960s.

When he joined Pink Floyd in 1968, Gilmour was playing a blond Strat—a birthday present from his parents. When the guitar got lost during an American tour that summer, the band replaced it with a white model.

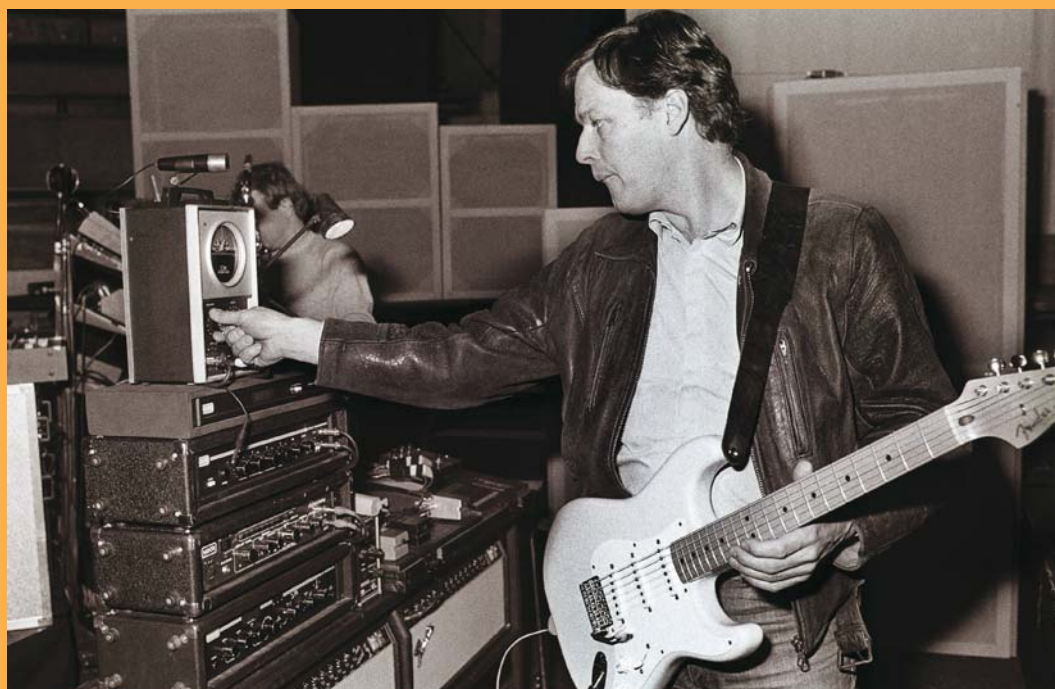
In 1970 Gilmour bought a black Stratocaster at Manny's guitar shop in New York. It has become indelibly linked to him ever since, having featured on "Money," "Shine on You Crazy Diamond," "Comfortably Numb," and numerous other classic Pink Floyd tracks, leading Fender to issue a David Gilmour Signature model in 2009.

Since reviving Pink Floyd in 1985, however, Gilmour has tended to favor a red Strat. He has also used other guitars, like the Bill Lewis he uses to reach the high tones on "Money," and the Fender 1000 pedal-steel guitar he plays on "Breathe" and "The Great Gig in the Sky."

Gilmour plays his guitars through Hiwatt amplifiers and WEM cabinets using a Yamaha RA-200 rotating speaker and an Alembic F-2B preamp—his "secret ingredient." His effects board has been customized by Pete Cornish, creator of his own tone pedal, custom fuzz, and ST-2 treble and bass booster. Among the other pedals he has used are the Dallas Arbiter Fuzz Face, the Electro Harmonix Big Muff, and the Cry Baby wah-wah—not forgetting the now-legendary Binson Echorec II, which Gilmour inherited from Syd Barrett when he first joined the band. When the Binson started to become unreliable, Gilmour replaced it with an MXR Digital Delay System, which he has used ever since.



ABOVE: David Gilmour's 1954 Fender Stratocaster.



LEFT: David Gilmour onstage during a soundcheck at Vredenburg in Utrecht, the Netherlands, with Fender amplifier heads and Stratocaster.

BELOW: David Gilmour onstage during a soundcheck at Vredenburg in Utrecht playing his Fender 1000 pedal-steel guitar.



CHAPTER 8

Walls and Burning Bridges

RIGHT: From left to right: Brian James of the punk group the Damned, Capital Radio DJ Nicky Horne, and Nick Mason (on the far right) who produced their second album while on a break from Pink Floyd.

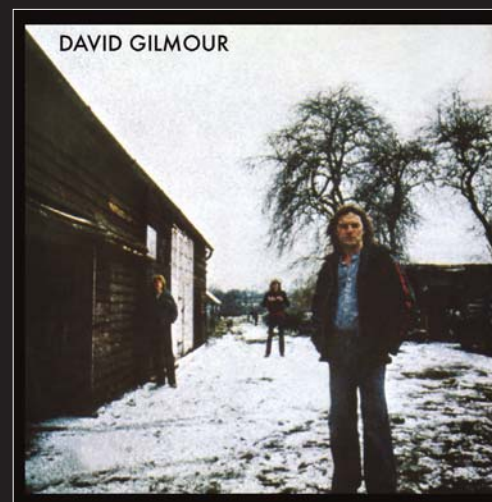


Returning from the grueling In the Flesh tour in July 1977, the weary members of Pink Floyd scattered to recuperate. By the end of the tour, they were barely communicating; now, each pursued their own interests.

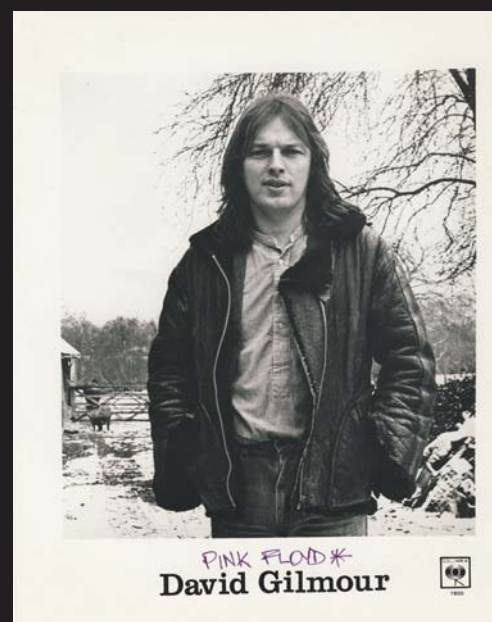
Gilmour had serious doubts as to whether Pink Floyd would continue to function—whether they had anything more to offer as a band. To stop his mind from wandering, he made a solo album, working with his old Jokers Wild rhythm section of drummer Willie Wilson, who had subsequently played with Syd Barrett before joining Quiver, and bassist Rick Wills, who had gone on to play with Peter Frampton, Roxy Music, and the Small Faces. The album, simply entitled *David Gilmour*, was deliberately light and relaxed in comparison with Pink Floyd’s seriously calculated material. Gilmour asked Roy Harper to write the lyrics for one song, and he also covered a track by Unicorn, the band he’d produced a couple of years back. Released in May 1978, it was a pleasant enough album but not particularly memorable.

That same month, Wright released his solo album, *Wet Dream*, for which he called in touring guitarist Snowy White plus saxophonist and flautist Mel Collins, who had previously played on sessions with the band. The result was an album that often sounds like Floyd outtakes from a couple of albums back. Wright had not been in a good place while making the album. His relationship with his wife, Juliette, to whom he’d been married since 1965, was falling apart. (Likewise, Mason and Waters had also separated from the women they’d wed in the 1960s; only Gilmour was bucking the trend, having married his American girlfriend Ginger a couple of years earlier.)

A few months earlier, Mason had an unexpected brush with the punk movement when he was asked to produce the second album by the Damned, who had been the first British punk band to make a record. The Damned had initially wanted Syd Barrett to produce the album but—like everyone else who sought him out—had been unable to track him down. Mason accepted the challenge but soon found a band mired in “musical differences”: guitarist and songwriter Brian James was keen to move things on; the others, in true punk style, were resistant to progress. As Mason would later note, *Music for Pleasure* (a jokey reference to a budget record label) was recorded in less time than it took to set up Pink Floyd’s microphones. It consists largely of under-rehearsed leftovers from the band’s first album, plus an intriguing exploration of psychedelic jazz on the closing track,



ABOVE: David Gilmour’s solo album released in 1978, simply entitled *David Gilmour*.



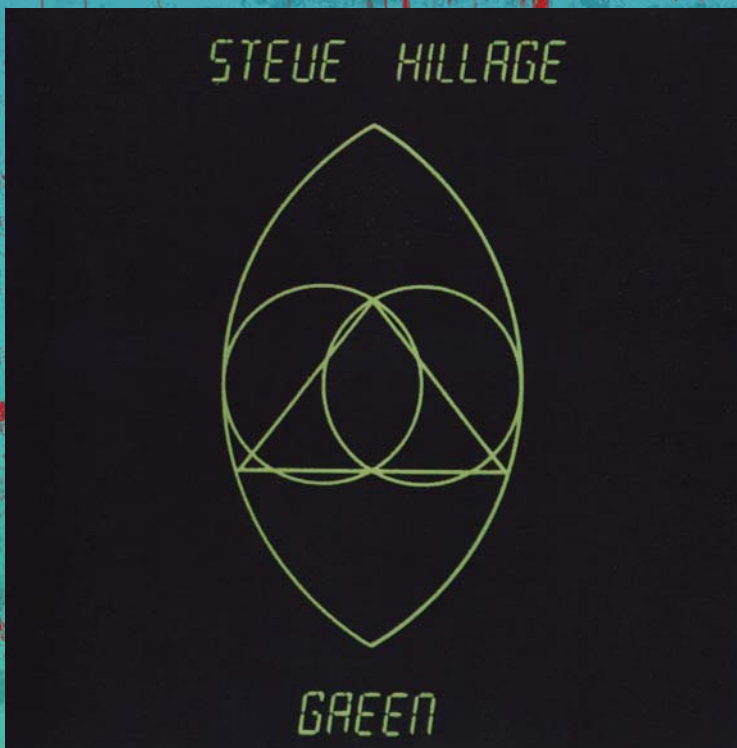
ABOVE: Promotional photo of David Gilmour in the late 1970s.



ABOVE: Richard Wright’s solo album entitled *Wet Dream*, also released in 1978.



ABOVE: The Damned's second album, *Music for Pleasure*, produced by Nick Mason.



ABOVE: Nick Mason worked with guitarist Steve Hillage on his album, *Green*.

"You Know." More rewarding, for Mason, was his subsequent assignment with guitarist Steve Hillage, formerly of the 1960s hippie outfit Gong. The resulting album, *Green*, features experiments with ambient electronic music reminiscent at times of David Bowie's collaborations with Brian Eno.

Waters, meanwhile, had gone to Switzerland to recover from what, for him, had been a particularly exhausting and traumatic tour—an experience he did not intend to repeat. It had, however, given him some ideas for the next Pink Floyd project. He talked with friends about the feelings of alienation he had felt from the audiences, the distance between them, the difficulty of communicating with them, the metaphorical *wall* between them.

In the summer of 1978 Pink Floyd convened for the first time in a year at Britannia Row Studios, where Waters played them cassettes of demos he had recorded for two possible album projects and asked them to pick a favorite. One had the working title *Bricks in the Wall*; the other would subsequently become his first solo album, *The Pros and Cons of Hitch Hiking*. Gilmour, Wright, and Mason unanimously voted for *Bricks in the Wall*, but not without reservations. Wright was concerned that the songs were all in the same key and tempo, while Gilmour felt that some of the music was weak, and that some of the lyrics amounted simply to "whingeing." But he was confident that the band could make it work.

Early on, they agreed to bring in an outside producer to help shape what was already looking like it would end up as a double album. Waters chose Bob Ezrin, whom his girlfriend of the time, Carolyn Christie, had worked for, and whom he had met previously. Born in Toronto, Canada, Ezrin had produced Alice Cooper's *Love it to Death*, *Killer*, and *School's Out* before enhancing his reputation by arm wrestling the *Berlin* album out of Lou Reed, finding the sound to match the makeup on Kiss's *Destroyer*, and producing Peter Gabriel's first solo record.

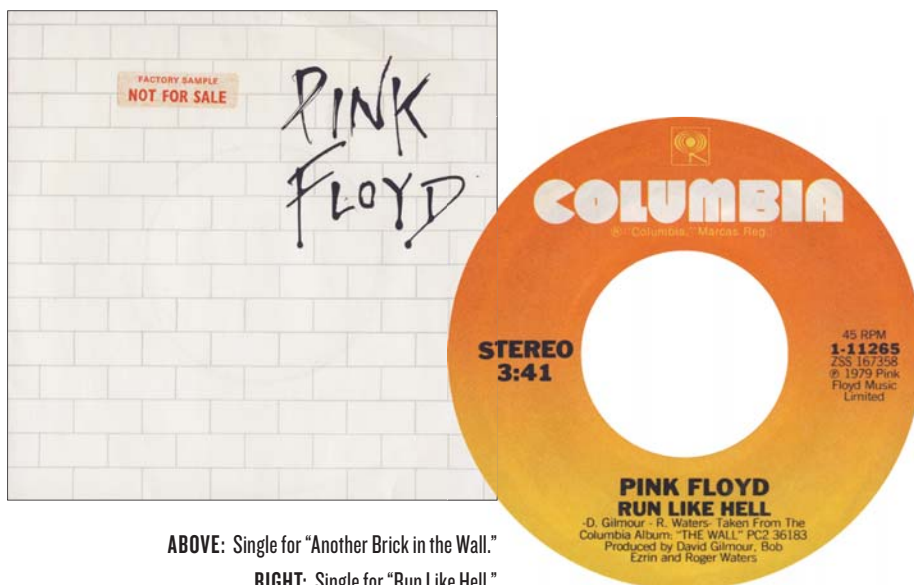
Ezrin later recalled that Waters had made it clear early on that the project was his, while also noting how such a declaration can make it difficult for a band to work together. "Roger was sensitive to that—or as sensitive as Roger can be—so he brought me in, I think, as an ally," Ezrin said. "But my perception of my job was to be an advocate of the work itself, and that very often meant disagreeing with Roger, and other people, and being a catalyst for them to get past whatever arguments might exist."





**WATERS TALKED
ABOUT THE
FEELINGS OF
ALIENATION HE
HAD FELT FROM
THE AUDIENCES...
THE METAPHORICAL
WALL BETWEEN
THEM...**

LEFT: Roger Waters performing circa 1979.



Mason told *Record Collector* magazine that the “basic structure” of the album was already there at the start of the sessions: “Like a skeleton with lots of bones missing, the story was roughly laid out. A few numbers needed chucking, and Roger spent a lot of time with Bob Ezrin making the story comprehensible. Then we reconvened at Britannia Row in October 1978 and started turning it into something good.”

Trying to lighten and brighten some of the denser parts of Waters’s concept was a struggle, according to Ezrin, who remembered Waters “grudgingly” accepting Gilmour’s “Comfortably Numb” for the album. Ezrin also recognized the potential of “Another Brick in the Wall Part 2,” but struggled to get the band to see it. “I’d just done a session in New York,” he recalled, “and Nile Rodgers and Bernard Edwards were in the next studio. I heard this drum beat and went, ‘Wow, that would work great with rock’n’roll.’ When I started listening to ‘Another Brick in the Wall,’ that beat kept playing through my head. But what Roger had written was just one verse and one chorus long. When we played it with the disco beat, I said, ‘This is a hit. But we need two verses and two choruses.’ And they said, ‘Well, you’re not bloody getting them. We don’t do singles, so fuck you.’ So while they were gone, I copied the verse and chorus, took one of the drum fills, and put it in between [them to] extended the chorus. Then I played it to them.”

Gilmour would later recall Ezrin telling him to go out to clubs and listen to some disco music. “So I forced myself out and listened to loud four-to-the-beat drums and stuff and thought ‘Gawd awful.’ But when we tried putting it onto ‘Another Brick in

the Wall,’ it seemed to make it more catchy. We did the same exercise on ‘Run Like Hell.’”

Recording continued at Pink Floyd’s typically stately pace until, early in 1979, they were suddenly confronted by impending financial disaster. A couple of years earlier, they had placed the considerable fortunes earned from *Dark Side of the Moon* and *Wish You Were Here* in the hands of investment company Norton Warburg, run by Andrew Warburg, Waters’s friend and godfather to one of his children. Norton Warburg persuaded the band to invest their money in a diverse range of enterprises and promised to arrange their tax affairs and pensions so that they could be offset against the 83 percent tax rate Pink Floyd would have been liable to pay in Britain in the 1970s.

However, the business ventures that Norton Warburg had chosen turned out, without exception, to be complete failures. These included a floating restaurant, a hotel that branched out into manufacturing fudge, a computer game, a film that nobody saw, a skateboard company, a car-hire business, and a children’s shoe factory. In an attempt to recoup the losses, Norton Warburg had started investing money it no longer had into further ventures that also failed. Worse still, the company had made no provision for tax avoidance, which meant the band members were now liable to pay tax on money that had already been squandered. Unsurprisingly, Andrew Warburg had since fled to Spain. (He was later arrested and jailed for fraud.)

“It was entirely our fault,” Gilmour told the Belgian magazine *Weekend Knack*. “Pure stupidity. We thought we had handled our

money with care. The financial experts we appointed made a mess of our administration. If we hadn't taken action immediately, we would have been bankrupt."

Teams of accountants moved into Britannia Row, examining the band's financial affairs to see what could be salvaged while also seeking to minimize their tax exposure. The accountants' advice was unequivocal: the band needed to become tax exiles and leave the country—at once. They would not be able to return to Britain for a least a year. And they still owed a hefty tax bill. Within three weeks, Pink Floyd had relocated to the south of France with their tapes and as much as they could carry with them. For a band that had always maintained their English roots—however many holiday homes they might have acquired along the way—it was a very unsettling experience.

The band picked the south of France because both Gilmour and Wright had recorded their solo albums at Super Bear Studios in the mountains above Nice. They had enjoyed working there and felt that it would be a good place to continue work on their new album. By now, *The Wall* had taken on an added significance, since Pink Floyd would be relying on its success to pay their bills. However, the delays caused by the various difficulties the band had faced at home meant that the original projected release date in the fall of 1979 was now out of the question. The atmosphere in the studio was fraught, with creative and musical tensions regularly bubbling over—or, as Mason later put it, "Roger was starting to go a bit mad."

"There was tension between the band members, even tension between the wives of the band members," Ezrin recalled. "There was a period in France where it was very hostile; that passive-aggressive English-style conflict. Roger and I were having a particularly difficult time. I really dreaded going in to face the tension so I would find any excuse to come in late the next morning. And that of course just made things worse."

For Gilmour, most of the disagreements were artistic in nature. "It wasn't total war," he said, "although there were bad vibes—certainly toward Rick, because he didn't seem to be pulling his weight." Wright had reached a creative impasse and was unable to play his keyboard parts to Waters's satisfaction. The relationship between the two was disintegrating; Wright believed Waters was trying to get rid of him, which was in danger of becoming a self-fulfilling prophecy. Even Ezrin thought that Wright "was being set up to fail."

In fact, Waters was becoming increasingly exasperated not just with Wright but with the whole band. He later told *Mojo* magazine that Gilmour was "just not interested," Wright was "pretty closed down," and Mason was "happy to listen but more interested in his racing cars." Gilmour and Mason would both argue that they contributed as much as they could, but it wasn't easy. Even Waters would admit that there was no democracy involved in the recording process. "If somebody had a good idea," he said, "I would accept it and maybe use it. There was only one chief, and that was me."

The crunch came when CBS Records, desperate to release the album before the end of the year, offered to increase the band's royalty rate if they could deliver the record in time. Waters and Ezrin decided this might be possible if they hired a second studio to speed up the recording before the mixing process, which was scheduled to take place in Los Angeles after a planned break. A suitable studio was found some 50 miles away; Waters and Ezrin moved there to work on the vocals while the others remained at Super Bear to complete the instrumental parts.

**"IF SOMEBODY HAD A GOOD IDEA,
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—ROGER WATERS**

With the deadline looming for finishing the recording, Wright had still not completed his keyboard parts. When he was asked to curtail his summer break and finish the recording in Los Angeles, however, Wright refused, using a well-known two-word Anglo Saxon phrase—at which point Waters boiled over and demanded that Wright leave the group, threatening to cancel the album (on which they were all financially dependent) if he didn't.

Gilmour told Wright that he would back him if he wanted to stay, even though he was contributing nothing of note to the band, telling him that he felt he had a "sacrosanct right" as a founding member to remain in the band as long as he wanted.



“He said, ‘Do you still want me in this band?’” Gilmour recalled. “I said, ‘Not particularly, because you’re not doing anything, but I’ll support your right to be in it till the end.’”

Mason was also against forcing Wright out, not least because he thought he might be next. Waters would later claim that Gilmour suggested they should get rid of Mason; Gilmour says he didn’t. In the end, however, Wright decided to quit the group, which he felt was disintegrating anyway. It was agreed that he would finish his contributions to the album and then leave quietly. Nothing would be announced. The reason for this subterfuge was that Pink Floyd were still in the process of negotiating a new contract with CBS in America, and they figured that their position would be weakened if one of them had just left. To cover themselves, they added a clause specifying exactly who and what might constitute Pink Floyd. Among the permutations was a version of Pink Floyd that did not include Wright, and another that did not include Waters—something that would have significant ramifications a few years down the line.

The mixing sessions took place in a cold, inhospitable atmosphere. Mason’s insecurities were not assuaged when he was unable to nail the drumming for “Mother” to Water’s satisfaction, leading him to bring in Toto drummer and noted session player Jeff Porcaro to play on the track in Mason’s place. Meanwhile, Ezrin remained convinced that “Another Brick in the Wall Part 2” could be a big hit, but he still only had one verse and one chorus to work with.

IN THE END, WRIGHT DECIDED TO QUIT THE GROUP, WHICH HE FELT WAS DISINTEGRATING ANYWAY...

“They knew I was doing a lot of work on the song,” he recalled. “They were just sort of letting me do whatever I wanted. Roger’s attitude was, ‘Go ahead and waste your time doing a lot of silly stuff. In the end, it’s going to be the way I hear it.’ Well, I’m the guy who did ‘School’s Out,’ and I’ve got this thing about kids on a record. And this song was about kids.”

LEFT: Toto drummer Jeff Porcaro performing in February of 1981 in Los Angeles, California. Porcaro was brought in to drum for the song “Mother” when Mason didn’t perform the song to Waters’s satisfaction.

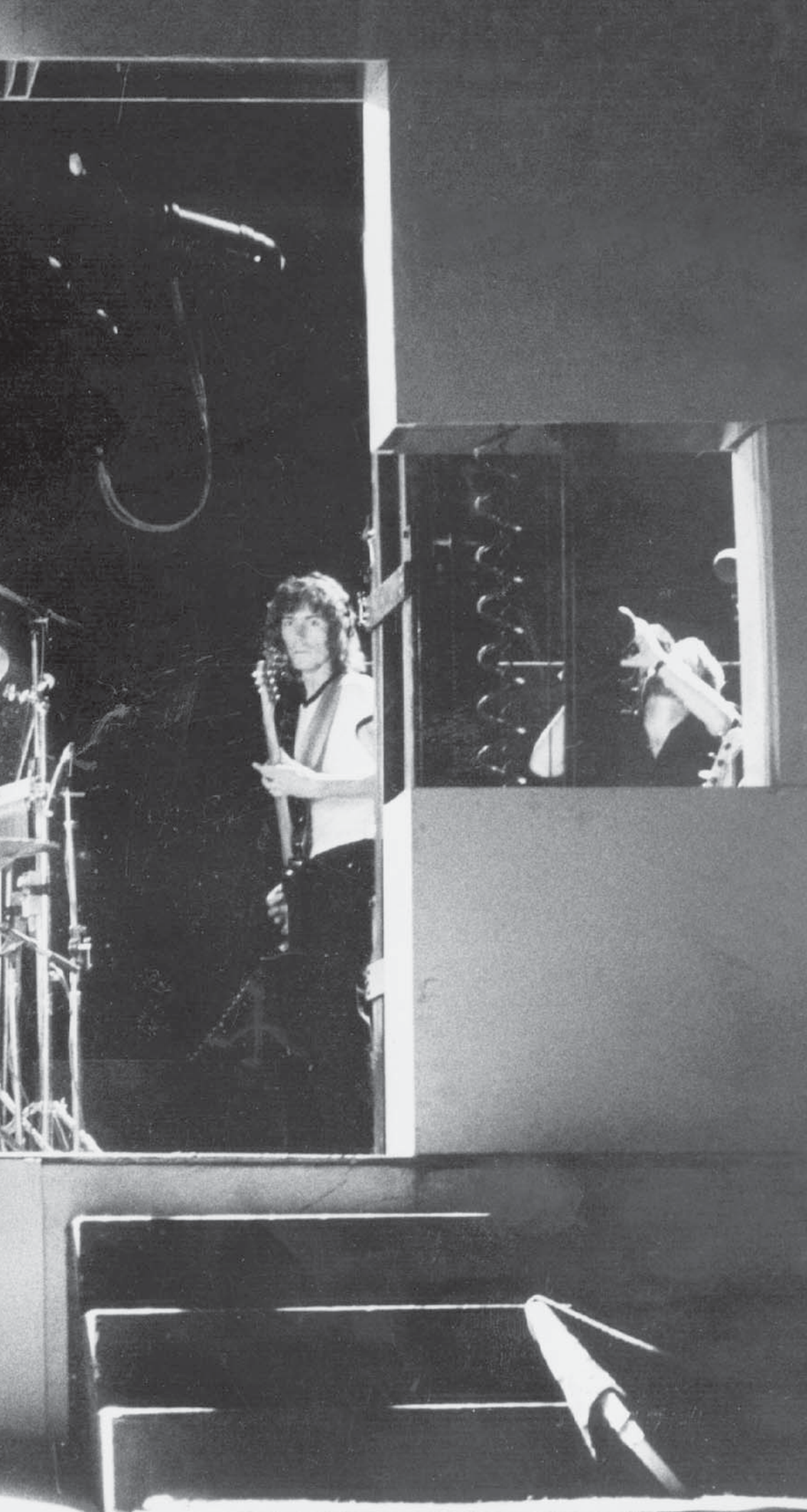
Ezrin telephoned Nick Griffiths, the engineer who was in charge of Britannia Row Studios during Pink Floyd’s absence, and asked him to round up a bunch of kids from the nearby Islington Green School, telling him he wanted them to sound “cockney.” Griffiths managed to get a class of kids (plus music teacher) for one lesson’s worth of time in exchange for agreeing to record the school orchestra. The reaction of the music teacher to the famous refrain about not needing no education was not recorded, but Ezrin got what he wanted. “I called Roger into the room, and when the kids came in on the second verse there was a total softening of his face—he got it.”

There were a few more musical arguments to be resolved during the mixing sessions. Arranger and composer Michael Kamen had been brought in to add orchestral arrangements to several tracks, but Gilmour was not happy with what he heard on “Comfortably Numb.” The debate rumbled on for weeks, but Ezrin and Waters were in agreement on this one, and eventually Gilmour gave way.

BELOW: Rick Wright with his son, Jamie, in Munich, Germany, in 1977.







LEFT: Roger Waters rehearsing for The Wall in London, 1980.

The band's record companies had settled on November 30 as the last possible release date for *The Wall* in order to maximize pre-Christmas sales, and label executives began to panic when the band were still tinkering in the studio at the beginning of the month. There were even veiled threats to seize the tapes—further heightening the paranoia levels inside and outside the studio—but in the end the band were able to finish the record just in time to meet the planned date.

Waters had fallen out with Storm Thorgerson and Hipgnosis in the wake of the *Animals* cover debacle, so the band's new double album would be housed inside a sleeve designed by Gerald Scarfe, with whom they had recently collaborated on the *In the Flesh* tour. The minimal artwork featured a plain white wall outlined in pale blue across the front and back covers, with the title of the record and the band's name displayed on a transparent sticker fixed to the front. The inside artwork featured a set of characters designed by Scarfe—characters that would shortly be seen breaking through gaps in the wall as part of the band's upcoming live show. The album credits, meanwhile, were clearly assembled in haste: backing singers, orchestral arrangers, and sound man are all present and correct, but there's no mention of Wright or Mason anywhere, and you have to look hard to find Gilmour's name.

The Wall entered the U.S. Top 40 just before Christmas and then began its slow climb up the charts, eventually dislodging greatest hits collections by Donna Summer and the Bee Gees to hit No. 1 in mid January. It would remain at the top for a total of 15 weeks, and was still in the Top 20 in July. Surprisingly, one of the few major territories where it failed to top the charts was the U.K., where *The Wall* peaked at No. 3 after failing to dislodge hits compilations by Abba and Rod Stewart despite selling more than a million copies in its first two months of release. Today, total worldwide sales are estimated to have reached some 30 million copies.

Bob Ezrin had his point about "Another Brick in the Wall Part 2" proven emphatically when it hit No. 1 around the world. It even reached the much sought-after Christmas No. 1 slot in the U.K., although the band's self-imposed tax exile meant they were unable to return for the festivities, which would presumably have included a first appearance on *Top of the Pops* in a number of years. In the U.S. the single spent four consecutive weeks at the top of the charts between February and March 1980. And just like

that, Pink Floyd's financial problems had been solved, almost as quickly as they had first arisen.

No sooner had the band finished work on the album than they started preproduction on the live show to accompany *The Wall*. "I always knew right from the word go that this was going to be a record, a show in three or four cities, and a movie," Waters later claimed. He had devised a show that involved building a wall across the front of the stage during the performance that would completely obscure the band from the audience (and vice versa) to reinforce the themes of isolation and alienation that the album portrayed.

Nothing like this had ever been attempted in the arenas that Pink Floyd were planning to play. Architectural designers Mark Fisher and Jonathan Ward, who had been involved with the band's use of inflatables, were charged with putting Waters's vision into practice and designed a wall that was 40 ft. high and 160 ft. wide. It would need to be constructed, brick by brick, in front of the band during the first half of the show, and then come crashing down at the climax—hopefully without tumbling into the audience. In addition, provisions needed to be made for sections of the wall to be opened up during the second half of the show so that particular scenes could be enacted within.

THERE IS NO MENTION OF WRIGHT OR MASON ANYWHERE ON THE ALBUM CREDITS, AND YOU HAVE TO LOOK HARD TO FIND GILMOUR'S NAME...

"I never doubted that it could be done," Fisher said. "Obviously, it was more ambitious than anything that had been tried before, and therefore entailed more kit, but all that really meant was that there were larger versions of the same old problems. My main consideration was how to accomplish the task without compromising the creative and philosophical ideas of the show itself."

RIGHT: Pink Floyd performing on February 28, 1980, at Nassau Coliseum in Uniondale, New York.



The first issue involved the bricks themselves. Ward estimated that they would need 400 or so, and they would need to be light and transportable. “I toyed with the idea of slotting plywood panels together,” he recalled, “but I realized this would make them too heavy, and we’d rejected anything molded as too big. The solution came to us in a pub. Someone suddenly remembered that cardboard boxes are delivered in flat packs, then unfolded into shape.”

After working out how to fit the boxes together (and what kind of cardboard to use), Fisher and Ward then had to devise a method of building the wall on the stage. Ward spent a month at the Seattle-based company that made portable Genie Hoist lifting cranes, which he then adapted so that they could be coupled together to make hydraulic lifting platforms. Figuring out how to have the wall come tumbling down without crushing the front rows of the audience required more ingenuity. “It had to come down from the top,” Ward recalled, “so we added an arm to the hoists to knock the bricks off that was operated by a system of air cylinders.”

The wall itself needed to be white so that Gerald Scarfe’s animations could be projected onto it. Ward and his team tried various techniques before discovering that household white emulsion paint worked best. Scarfe had also designed a new range of inflatables—a teacher, a mother, a lover, and an even more evil-looking pig than before—that needed to hover, dance, and glower above the audience. And then there was the life-size plane that needed to fly down from the back of the arena and crash onto the stage.

While Waters worked on creating the show, Gilmour assembled the music, which was essentially the full album adapted for the show, which required a second “surrogate” band to play alongside—and sometimes replace—the real Pink Floyd. This band included Snowy White, from the *In the Flesh* tour, and former Jokers Wild drummer Willie Wilson. Wright, who was no longer an official member of Pink Floyd (although nobody knew that yet), was hired to play with his old band; because of his “non-member” status, Mason would later joke that Wright was the only one who made any money out of the shows. As a result of the complex and expensive staging, the others are estimated to have lost almost a million dollars from staging *The Wall*, although it must be said that none of them has ever seriously complained about it.

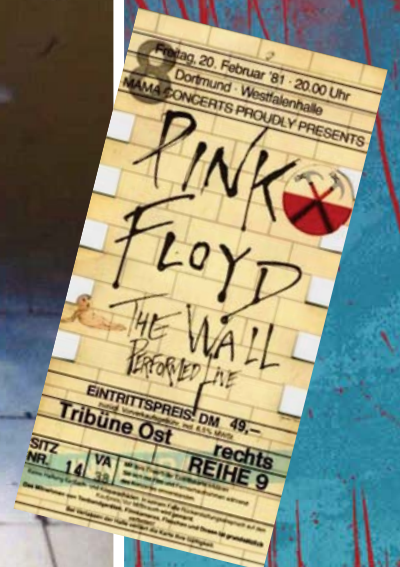
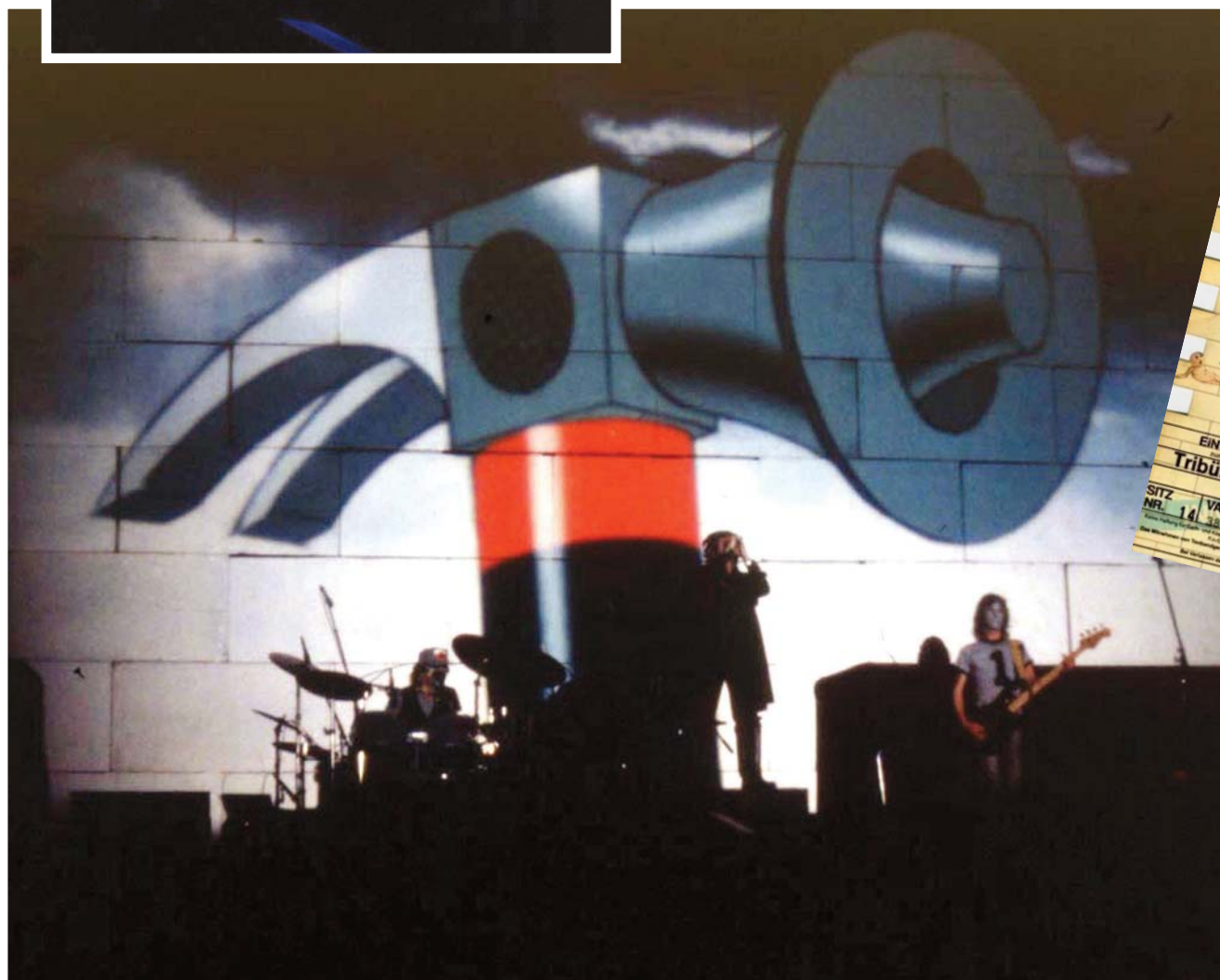
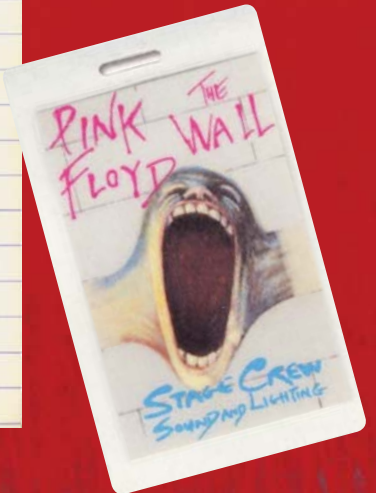
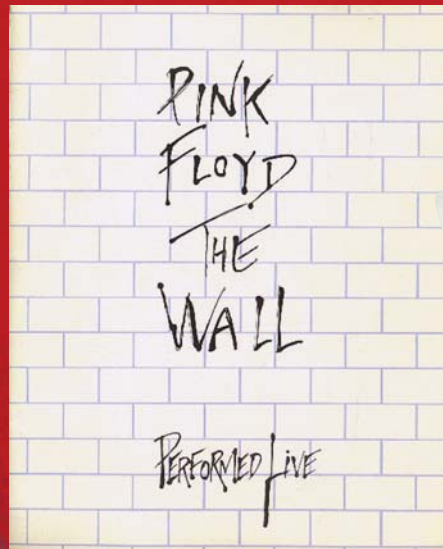
The logistics and equipment involved in presenting *The Wall* on stage—including a 109 dB, 150 kW quadrophonic sound system—meant that touring in the conventional sense was an impossibility, although the band did briefly investigate the idea of using an inflatable, slug-like transportable arena. Instead, they set up a series of shows in the U.S. and Europe: the Los Angeles Memorial Sports Arena and New York’s Nassau Coliseum in February 1980, London’s Earls Court in August (once their tax exile was over), and the Westfalenhalle in Dortmund, Germany, in February 1981, with a second run at Earls Court in June. These Earls Court performances in June 1982 were filmed for the upcoming movie of *The Wall*, and it was the last time that Waters, Gilmour, Mason, and Wright would play together for 26 years.

The band would end up playing 29 shows for an estimated 300,000 people, all of which passed off within a hitch—except for during the opening night, when a curtain caught fire. (Most people thought it was part of the show.) Most audiences were deceived by the surrogate band, who wore masks, and they watched in awe as the band gradually disappeared behind the wall but continued playing, with a barely visible light show continuing on the stage behind them. They were dazzled by the crashing plane, the outlandish inflatable puppets, the poignant scenes set in a living room within the wall, and the provocative animations projected upon it. Most importantly, they were left unscathed when the wall finally came tumbling down. For many, the highlight came when Gilmour appeared on top of the wall, midway through the second half of the show, to sing “Comfortably Numb.”

Waters regards *The Wall* shows as “the best we did together as Pink Floyd.” Over the next two decades, he received numerous requests for permission to stage *The Wall* from various promoters, producers, and directors, but the only ones he agreed to were amateur productions by colleges and schools. “It’s ironic because the favorite anthem, ‘We don’t need no education,’ caused uproar when it first came out. Politicians and educationalists lined up to denounce it as the death knell of all schooling. In fact the piece has turned out to be a great help to a large number of people trying to teach music and English to kids because the kids get interested in all the ideas it attempts to express. This makes me happy.”

RIGHT: Roger Waters (top left) and Pink Floyd (bottom) performing in February of 1980 at Nassau Coliseum in Uniondale, New York.

RIGHT: Pink Floyd’s *The Wall* tour poster, ticket, and backstage pass for stage crew.

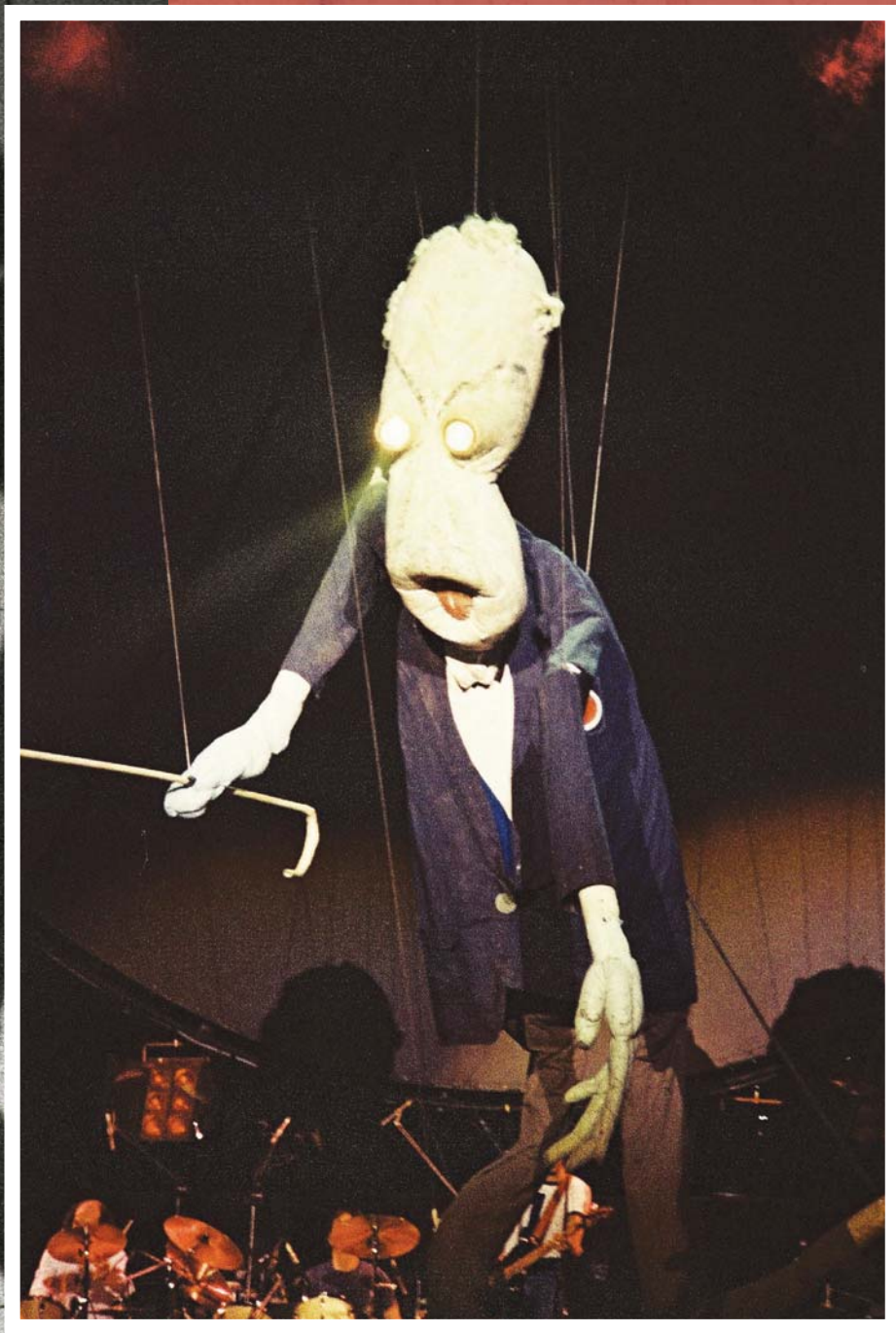


BELOW: Pink Floyd performing on August 7, 1980, at Earls Court, London, in front of the literal "wall" constructed specifically for the show.







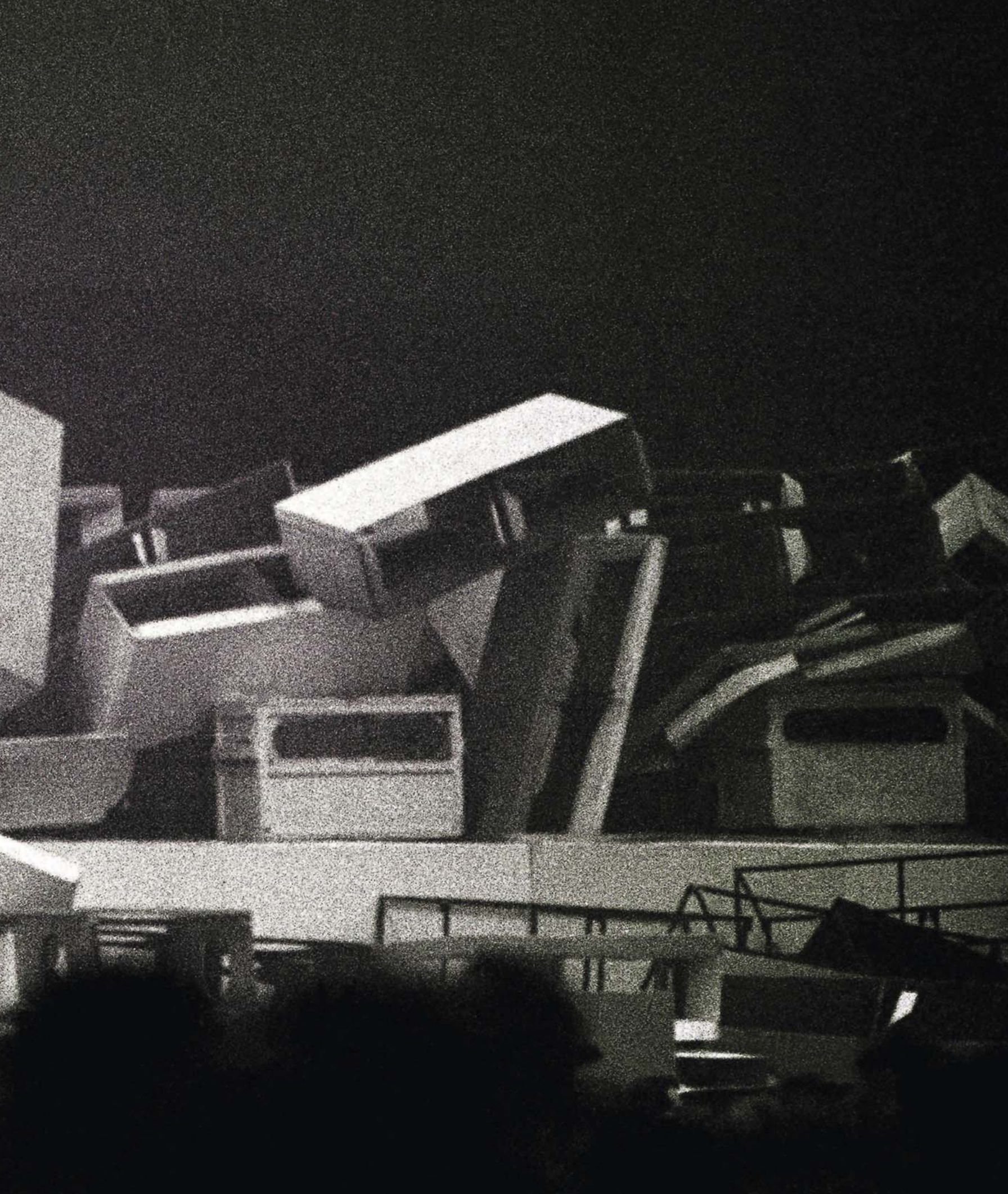


ABOVE: A "teacher" puppet at The Wall stage show on June 16, 1981, at Earls Court, London.

LEFT: Pink Floyd performing onstage during The Wall stage show on August 6, 1980, at Earls Court, London.

OVERLEAF: The wall destroyed...Pink Floyd performing onstage at Earls Court in London during The Wall tour on August 6, 1980.





CHAPTER 9

Cut to Pieces

RIGHT: David Gilmour performing live onstage at the Hammersmith Odeon in London on April 1, 1984.
He is playing a Fender Stratocaster.





ABOVE: Film director Alan Parker observes a rehearsal.

The final part of Waters's original three-part vision for *The Wall* began in September 1981 when production got under way for a film directed by Alan Parker, who had established his credentials as a strong-minded visionary three years earlier with *Midnight Express*. Waters had already written a script and was in line to play the lead role of Pink, the alienated, dysfunctional pop star. He had also enlisted Gerald Scarfe to provide animations for the movie. Pink Floyd put up a sizeable chunk of the \$20-million production budget, with Parker investing some of his own money as well.

The original idea had been to base the film around a combination of concert film footage with Scarfe's animations and some additional scenes starring Pink. But when Parker reviewed the footage from the Earls Court shows he was not impressed. He told the band he was not interested in making a rock'n'roll movie. It had been the ideas and the concept behind *The Wall* that had attracted him, and he had now begun to develop his own ideas about how these could be portrayed in the film.

Parker had not been encouraged by Waters's screen test, either, and persuaded him to abandon his acting dream and allow the director to pursue his own vision for the film instead,

using Pink Floyd's songs and Scarfe's animations as a starting point. Waters acquiesced and went off on a six-week holiday, leaving Parker to begin work on the film. He began by casting Bob Geldof, the singer with the Irish New Wave band the Boomtown Rats (and not a Floyd fan), in the largely nonverbal role of Pink.

"I really made the film with a completely free hand," Parker told *Rolling Stone* magazine. "I had to have that. I couldn't be second-guessed by Roger, and he appreciated that. The difficulty came when I'd finished. I'd been shooting for 60 days, 14 hours a day—that film had become mine. Then Roger came back and I had to go through the very difficult reality of having it put over to me that it was actually a collaborative

effort. It wasn't a totally happy experience."

Waters would later describe the making of the film as "the most unnerving, neurotic period of my life, with the possible exception of my divorce." The two men were used to getting their own way in their respective fields, and they had egos to match. They clashed repeatedly, with Parker threatening to quit on more than one occasion.

"I REALLY MADE THE FILM WITH A COMPLETELY FREE HAND... I HAD TO HAVE THAT. I COULDN'T BE SECOND-GUESSED BY ROGER, AND HE APPRECIATED THAT. THE DIFFICULTY CAME WHEN I FINISHED..." —ALAN PARKER



"Our story is about Pink, a rock and roll performer, who sits locked in a hotel room... a burned-out case. We shuffle and place, reality and nightmare, as we venture into Pink's painful memories, each one a 'brick' in the wall he has gradually built around his feelings. ... —Alan Parker

Bob Geldof stars as Pink in the MGM presentation of "Pink Floyd The Wall".

An Alan Parker Film: "Pink Floyd The Wall" by Roger Waters. Designed by Gerald Scarfe. With Bob Geldof as Pink. Film Music Produced by Roger Waters and David Gilmore. Executive Producer Steve D'Esposito. Produced by Alan Marshall. Animation Directed by Gerald Scarfe. Screenplay by Roger Waters. Directed by Alan Parker.

Released in the United States and Canada by MGM/UA Entertainment Co.

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ABOVE and BELOW: Stills from *The Wall* directed by Alan Parker.

LEFT: *The Wall* press photo of Bob Geldof.



BELOW: Still from *The Wall* starring Bob Geldof and directed by Alan Parker.



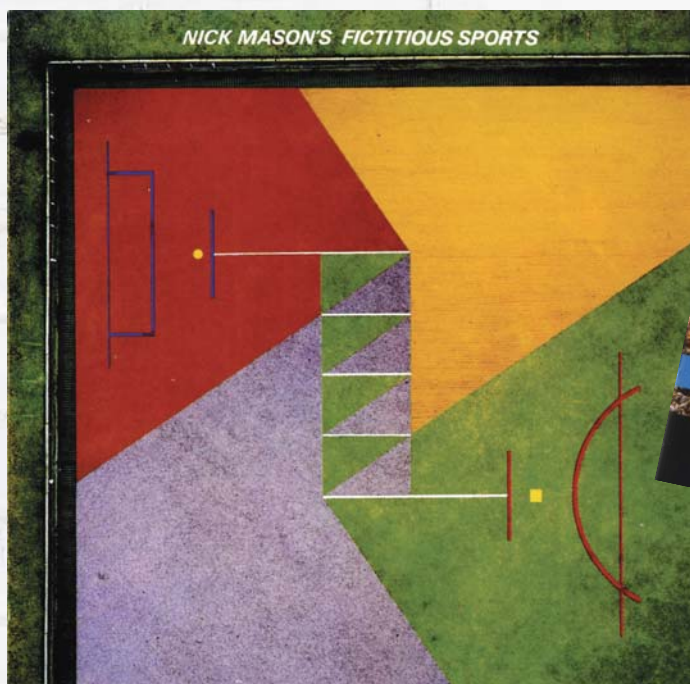


Pink Floyd rerecorded several songs from *The Wall* for the film, including a couple that had not made the cut the first time around. Waters also wrote a new song, the poignant “When the Tigers Broke Free,” which serves as the film’s overture and specifically references his father’s death at the Battle of Anzio during World War II. Gilmour and Mason declined to get involved in the furor surrounding the film and kept a low profile throughout, although Gilmour briefly assumed an unexpected public persona when he captained a team on BBC TV’s light entertainment show, *Pop Quiz*, beating teams led by Phil Collins and Queen drummer Roger Taylor. Meanwhile, Mason recorded his first “solo” album, *Nick Mason’s Fictitious Sports*, in collaboration with jazz keyboard player Carla Bley, who wrote all the material. (It is arguably more of a Carla Bley record than a Nick Mason record.)

As Christmas approached, CBS Records decided to see what more they could squeeze from the Pink Floyd catalogue by compiling *A Collection of Great Dance Songs*, its title a jokey reference to the band’s recently acquired dancefloor status with “Another Brick in the Wall Part 2.” None of the other five tracks on the album were remotely danceable, with the possible exception of “Money,” which had been rerecorded after a contractual dispute with Capitol Records (not that you could really tell the difference).



ABOVE: Nick Mason collaborated with jazz keyboard player Carla Bley (above) on his album *Nick Mason’s Fictitious Sports*.



ABOVE: Album covers for *Nick Mason’s Fictitious Sports* and Pink Floyd’s *A Collection of Great Dance Songs*.

When THE TIGERS Broke Free

Words and Music by ROGER WATERS



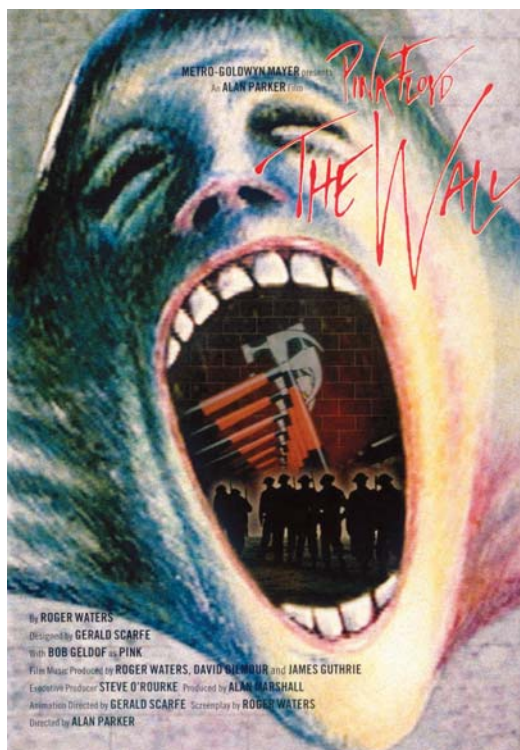
Recorded by **Pink Floyd** on COLUMBIA RECORDS

THE WALL

ABOVE: Sheet music for "When the Tigers Broke Free."



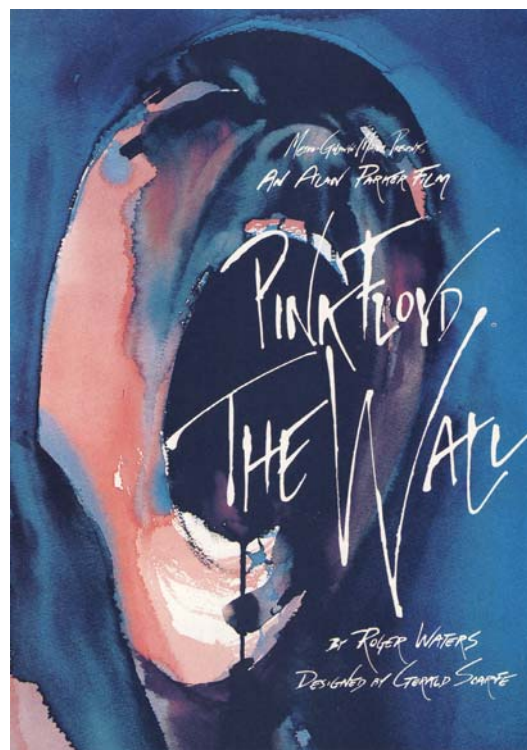
RIGHT: Album cover for *The Wall: Music from the Film*.



ABOVE: *The Wall* film poster.

After an advance screening at the Cannes Film Festival, *The Wall* was given its official premiere at London's Leicester Square Odeon theater on July 14, 1982. Waters, Gilmour, and Mason all attended (Wright was apparently "on holiday"), as did Gerald Scarfe and Bob Geldof, but Alan Parker was notable by his absence. Reviews of the film were generally favorable, although some critics resented being battered by the "relentless imagery." Many of those images were unforgettable, however, notably those of the schoolchildren in blob masks being led toward a meat grinder during "Another Brick in the Wall." Scarfe's animations were particularly vivid: the goose-stepping hammers, the genitalia-shaped flowers, the warplanes that turned into crosses, the judge who literally talked out of his backside.

Soon after the film opened, it was announced that Pink Floyd would be releasing a soundtrack album featuring the newly recorded material. The album was even given a working title, *Spare Bricks*, but when Gilmour and Mason turned up to start work on it they discovered that Waters had scrapped the idea in favor of new album concept about the senseless futility of war. In many ways, this was a continuation of the themes Waters had pursued on *The Wall* and earlier albums, but his anger had been

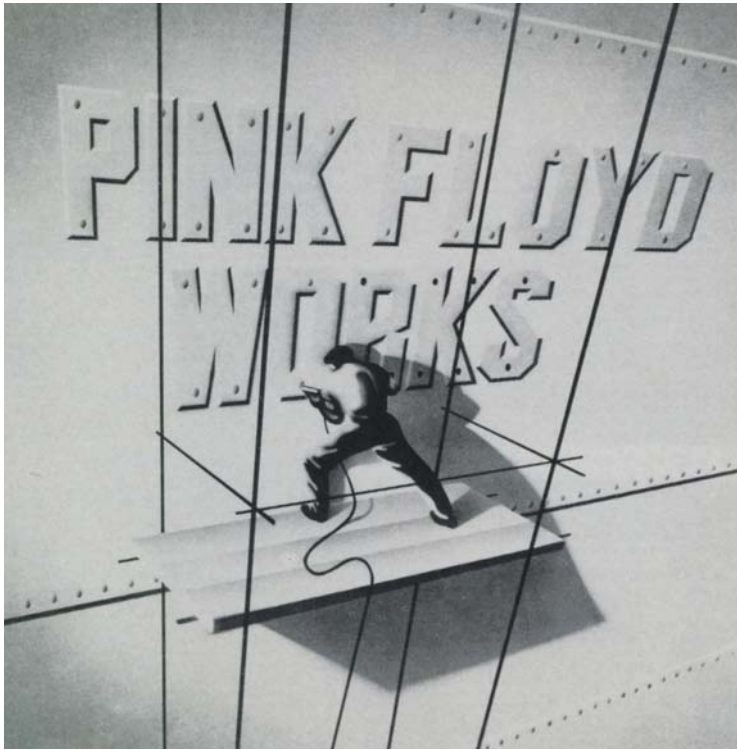


ABOVE: *The Wall* promotional booklet.

sharpened by Britain's recent war with Argentina over sovereignty of the Falklands Islands, which had resulted in more than 800 deaths during the spring and summer of 1982.

The Final Cut is the album on which any pretense of Pink Floyd functioning as a democratic unit was exposed as a sham. After his bruising confrontations with Alan Parker during the making of *The Wall*, Waters was in no mood to countenance dissent—as Gilmour discovered early on, when he queried both the suitability of the concept and the quality of the songs. "I said to Roger, 'If these songs weren't good enough for *The Wall*, why are they good enough for now?'" he recalled. "We had the most awful time. Roger had got Rick out, Nick wasn't around much, and now he was starting on me. It was a most unpleasant and humiliating experience."

Waters was unrepentant. "The fact was that I was making this record," he subsequently told *Uncut* magazine. "Dave didn't like it, and he said so. There wasn't any room for anyone else to be writing. I didn't play the guitar solos, Dave didn't write any lyrics." When the others complained, Waters threatened to take the album away from Pink Floyd and release it as his own. As far as Mason was concerned, however, it was effectively a Roger Waters



ABOVE: Pink Floyd's *Works* LP, released in 1983.

solo album anyway. "The rest of us just sort of drifted into it," he said. "It was a ghastly period with Roger, being treated more and more like a useless piece of kit and him saying menacingly, 'If we want to make another record, it will be different after this.'" Mason's confidence was further undermined when funk/soul drummer Andy Newmark was brought in to play on the final track, "Two Suns in the Sunset."

The album was recorded in piecemeal fashion at a half-dozen studios in and around London, but tellingly not at Pink Floyd's own Britannia Row studio. Bob Ezrin was not invited back, his confrontational style having been deemed unwelcome. In any case, he'd blown it soon after *The Wall* was released by telling a journalist in confidence about the upcoming live shows, only to have his thoughts relayed in the following week's edition of *Billboard* magazine.

Gilmour's dissatisfaction with the project and his rows with Waters culminated in him insisting his name be removed from the production credits. "My ideas weren't the way Roger saw it," he told the UK newspaper the *Sun*. "It is not personally how I would see a Pink Floyd record going." Instead, Waters was listed as producer alongside James Guthrie, who had worked on *The*



ABOVE: Single for Pink Floyd's "Not Now John."

Wall and mixed the sound at the band's live shows, and Michael Kamen, who had provided the orchestral arrangements on *The Wall* while the album was subtitled "A Requiem for the Post-War Dream by Roger Waters." Gilmour and Mason were credited simply as performers, while Wright's name was nowhere to be seen. It was the first time anyone realized that he was no longer a member of the band.

Released in March 1983, *The Final Cut* made use of an impressive new technical innovation: Holophonic Sound, which enabled specific sounds to be projected outside the usual stereo range. It would prove particularly effective when listening to the album with headphones. The missile heard at the beginning of side two, for example, appears to be launched from in front of you before traveling overhead and then crashing behind you.

After the success of *The Wall*, *The Final Cut* was bound to chart on the strength of advance orders alone. It reached No. 6 in the U.S. but fell away quite sharply, ultimately selling around two million copies—much the same as *Meddle*, which had only made it to No. 70 on the charts. In the U.K., the album made it all the way to No. 1—an improvement on *The Wall*, which had stalled at No. 3—and remained on the charts for nearly six months.

By now, the future of Pink Floyd had begun to attract media attention, with Wright's departure and stories of disagreements between the remaining members becoming widely known. Many assumed that the album's title was a signal of the band's impending demise, and the lack of any further activity from the band only added to the speculation—as did the silence emanating from their management office.

A year passed before news broke of any further Pink Floyd-related activity, the release of Gilmour's second solo album, *About Face*, in March 1984. Featuring ten self-penned songs (with lyrics by the Who's Pete Townshend on a couple), the album was recorded in France with a band of handpicked session musicians, including drummer Jeff Porcaro and bassist Pino Palladino, plus a guest appearance from Traffic frontman Steve Winwood on keyboards.

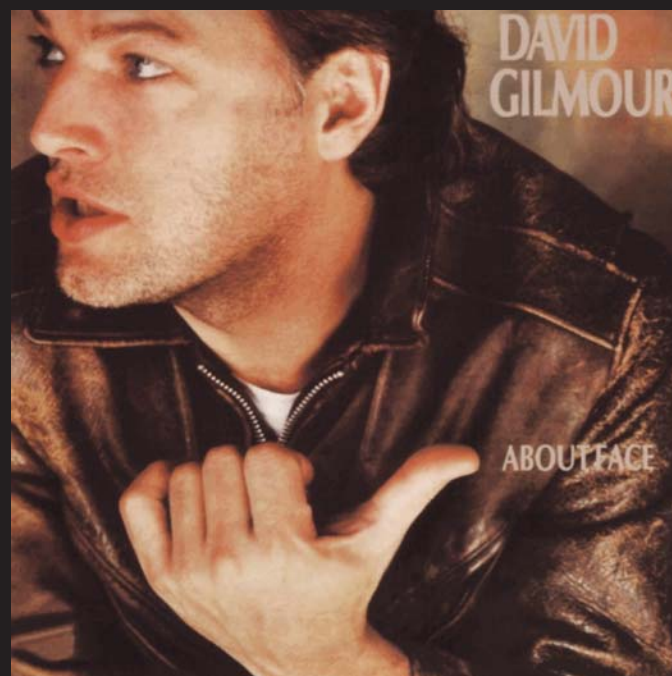
More significant was the presence of producer Bob Ezrin, who helped to give the album direction and substance, notably on "Murder," an uncharacteristic outburst of anger by Gilmour at the man who killed John Lennon. "He was looking to do things that he couldn't do within the context of Pink Floyd," Ezrin recalled. "During the making of *The Wall*, David and I found that our sessions were fun and productive—more about the art than the ego. And during *About Face* we struck up a deeper relationship."

"I had a bit more time and was feeling a bit freer about things on this album," Gilmour told *Source* magazine. He maintained much the same attitude that summer with a tour of 3–4,000-capacity theaters (rather than stadiums) in Europe and North America with a band that included Mick Ralphs from Bad Company. "It's nice to get out and do something on a slightly different scale, go out and do theaters, which is not really a possibility with Pink Floyd until we get a lot less popular," he told *Musician*.

Meanwhile, Waters had returned to the studio a month before the release of *The Final Cut* with most of the people who had worked on the album—except for Gilmour and Mason. Over the next ten months he recorded *The Pros and Cons of Hitch Hiking*, a concept piece that he had first presented to Pink Floyd in 1978, when it was rejected in favor of *The Wall*. The overarching idea had developed into a 40-minute dream about one man's midlife crisis, presented in the realtime of the album, with the tracks running from "4:30 A.M. (Apparently They Were Traveling Abroad)" to "5:11 A.M. (The Moment of Clarity)."



ABOVE: Richard Wright at Britannia Row in the 1980s.



ABOVE: The album cover of David Gilmour's second solo album, *About Face*.



ABOVE: The album cover of Roger Waters's *The Pros and Cons of Hitchhiking*.

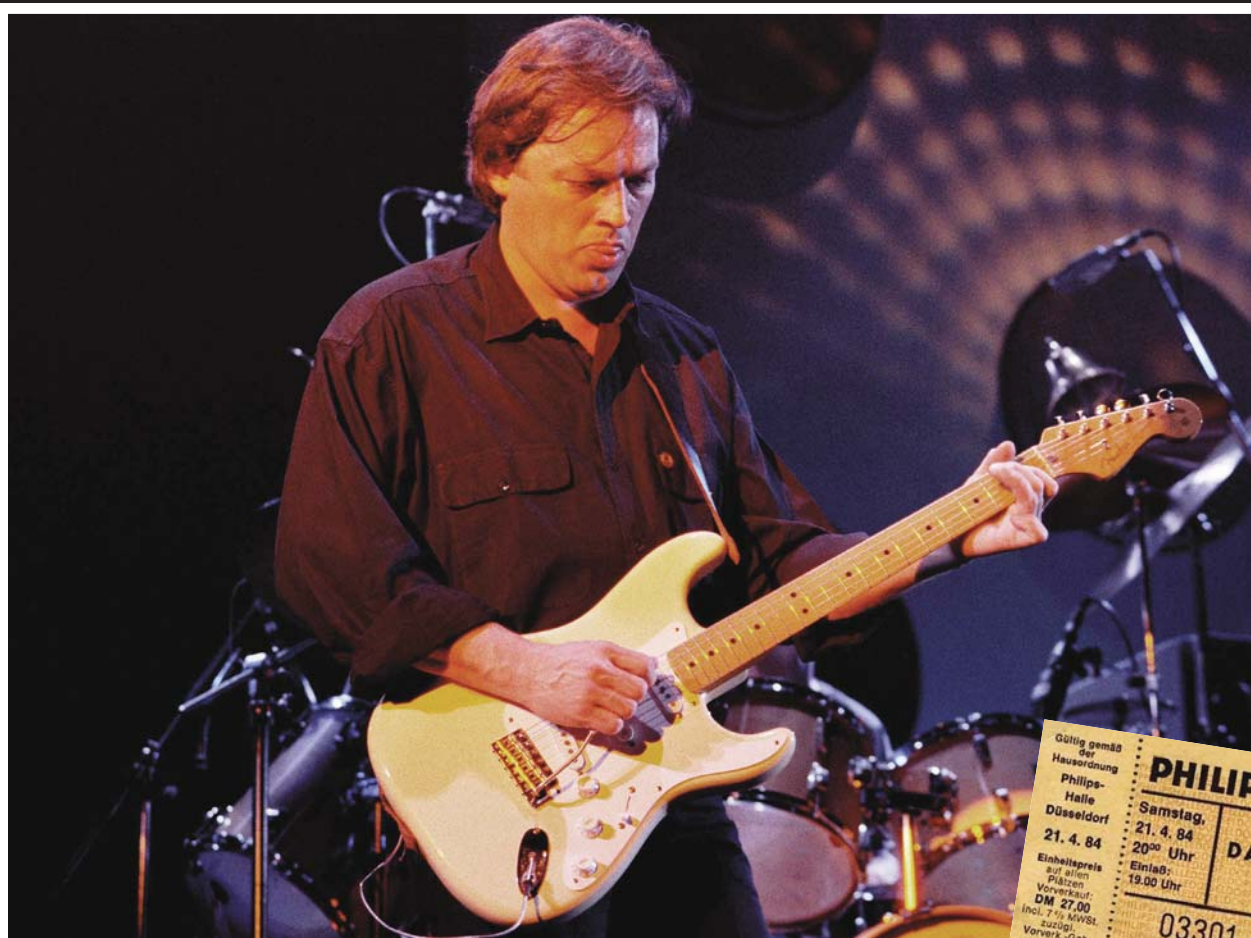


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DAVID GILMOUR



ABOVE: Promotional photo of David Gilmour.



ABOVE: David Gilmour performing live onstage at the Hammersmith Odeon in London on April 1, 1984.



RIGHT: A tour ticket to David Gilmour and Band in 1984.

The biggest surprise when the album was released in May 1984 was the presence of Eric Clapton on guitar and, more noticeably, Dobro. It was an unlikely pairing at first sight, but Waters had recently helped Clapton record the soundtrack to the John Hurt film *The Hit*, and Clapton was happy to return the favor. The cover art, by Gerald Scarfe, showed a blond hitchhiker wearing nothing but red high-heeled shoes and a backpack (a reference to the part of the album where the lead character fantasizes about having sex with a hitchhiker he has picked up). It was denounced as sexist by feminist groups, prompting CBS Records to put a black sticker over the girl's buttocks—thereby succeeding only in drawing more attention to them.

THE BIGGEST SURPRISE ON WATERS'S NEW ALBUM WAS A GUEST APPEARANCE BY ERIC CLAPTON ON GUITAR. WATERS HAD HELPED CLAPTON RECORD THE SOUNDTRACK FOR A JOHN HURT FILM, AND HE WAS HAPPY TO RETURN THE FAVOR...

Waters's subsequent tour of the U.S. and Europe that summer (followed by a second U.S. leg in March 1985) was closer in scale to a Pink Floyd event. He played arenas, backed by Scarfe's animations and films by Nicholas Roeg that were projected onto large screens behind the band. Clapton formed part of the band for the 1984 shows, alongside Michael Kamen on keyboards and Andy Newmark on drums. The first half of the show featured Pink Floyd material that dated as far back as "Set the Controls for Heart of the Sun" and "If," as well as a couple of songs from *The Final Cut*; for the second half, Waters presented the whole of his new album. Concert receipts were not up to the Pink Floyd scale, however, and Waters was rumored to have lost up to a million dollars on the venture.

RIGHT: Roger Waters performing with Eric Clapton onstage in Rotterdam on June 19, 1984.







ABOVE: Singer Bryan Ferry (center) performs with Pink Floyd's David Gilmour (far left) onstage during the Live Aid concert at Wembley Stadium on July 13, 1985, in London, England.



ABOVE: Nick Mason's second solo album, *Profiles*, which was a collaboration with Mike Oldfield and Rick Fenn.

WHEN WATERS' MANAGER, STEVE O'ROURKE, SUGGESTED THAT HE MAKE ANOTHER RECORD WITH GILMOUR AND MASON, WATERS' RESPONSE WAS TO FIRE HIM...

Hitch Hiking and *About Face* each scored respectable chart positions on either side of the Atlantic, with Waters’s album reaching No. 31 in the U.S. and No. 13 in the U.K. and Gilmour’s peaking at No. 32 in the U.S. and No. 21 in the U.K. Neither came close to the kind of sales figures that a new Pink Floyd album would have been expected to achieve, however. In fact, Pink Floyd still owed another album to CBS and EMI, but when manager Steve O’Rourke suggested that Waters make another album with Gilmour and Mason, Waters’s response was to fire his manager.

In a series of business meetings during 1985, Waters made it clear to Gilmour and Mason that he would not be recording a new album with them. In his view, Pink Floyd was finished, and he wanted the band laid to rest so that he could continue his solo career. As Gilmour explained to *Uncut*, “Roger said, ‘I’m not working with you guys again.’ He’d say to me, ‘Are you going to carry on?’ and I’d say, quite honestly, ‘I don’t know. But when we’re good and ready I’ll tell everyone what the plan is.’”

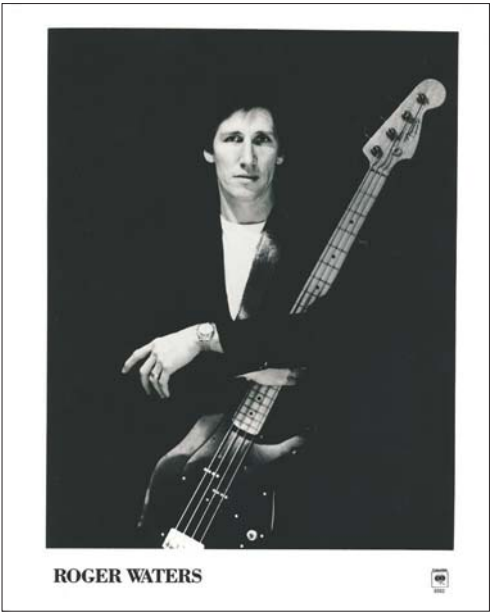
ROGER WROTE FORMALLY TO THE RECORD COMPANIES AND STATED THAT HE THOUGHT PINK FLOYD WAS A “SPENT FORCE CREATIVELY”...

The same argument festered through 1985. Gilmour made a handful of live appearances, mainly guesting with other artists. Most notably, he appeared at the London Live Aid event in July as a member of Bryan Ferry’s band. He was also onstage for the famous finale, although he was too far from the microphones to be heard. Later that year he played with Pete Townshend’s Deep End band at concerts in aid of the Double “O” charity, which Townshend had set up to help heroin addicts.

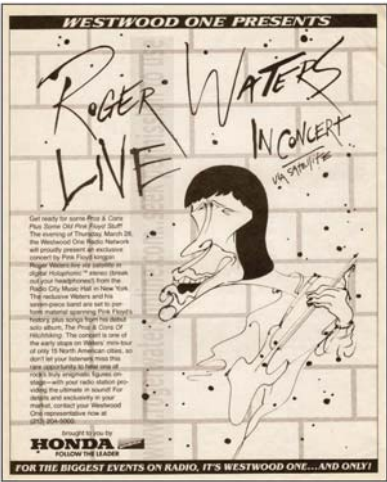
Mason released his second “solo” album in August 1985: *Profiles*, a collaboration with 10cc guitarist Rick Fenn and Mike Oldfield. It was mostly instrumental, although Gilmour showed up to sing on one track. Mason had at least remained faithful to Britannia Row Studio, recording the album there and becoming the de facto owner as the others gradually sold their shares of the building to him. His other notable appearance that year was on

BBC TV’s *Driving Force* show, where he teamed up with Richard Noble (at the time the holder of the world land-speed record) to drive a double decker bus around an obstacle course and change a tire on an 18-wheeler truck.

After completing his *Pros and Cons of Hitch Hiking* tour, Waters kept a low profile until December, when he appeared in a BBC tribute to John Lennon, playing “Across the Universe.” A few days later, he wrote formally to EMI and CBS Records, stating that he considered Pink Floyd to be a “spent force creatively,” and making clear that he would not be recording again with Gilmour and Mason—“or with anyone [else] as Pink Floyd.”



ABOVE: Press photo of Roger Waters.



ABOVE: 1985 promotional poster for Roger Waters’s concert in NYC.

CHAPTER 10

Lapses and Divisions

RIGHT: Rick Wright, David Gilmour, and Nick Mason in May of 1988.





PHOTOGRAPH: DINO SAFARI

From left: NICK MASON, DAVID GILMOUR, and RICK WRIGHT.

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PINK FLOYD



ABOVE: The record company publicity photo for Pink Floyd's "Learning to Fly" single in 1987.

The year 1986 was, for the most part, one of phony war between Waters, who wanted Pink Floyd to disband, and Gilmour, who didn't believe any one member had the right to call time on the group. As far as Gilmour was concerned, Waters's letter to CBS and EMI, in which he made clear that he had no intention of recording with or as Pink Floyd ever again, was an attempt to "gear us up into doing something."

"He believed very strongly that we wouldn't do it," Mason said.

"Or couldn't do it," Gilmour added. "I remember meetings in which he said, 'You'll never fucking do it.' That's precisely what was said. Exactly that term . . . except slightly harder."

Mason would later recall another meeting where Waters tried

to convince the others that Pink Floyd was over. "Our feeling was, 'It's not correct for you to decide.' By telling us that we couldn't carry on without him, Dave—who can be very pigheaded—absolutely saw red and finally got it together to go back to work. Roger had been my great mate for years, but even I thought it was an outrage." The irony, as Mason would later point out, was that Waters could easily have killed off the group simply by staying in it. "By remaining in it and never doing another stroke of work, nothing would ever have happened."

In early 1986 Gilmour began to create a new Pink Floyd album, bringing in musicians like keyboardist Jon Carin, who had played with Bryan Ferry, along with Mason. Wright got in touch after he

heard that Waters had left the group. Gilmour also recruited Bob Ezrin to help bring the project to fruition. It was a challenge that Ezrin couldn't resist, but it wasn't quite as simple as that, since he'd just turned down the opportunity to work with Waters on his next album.

"After years of not talking to me and being negative about me in the press, I get a call from Roger apologizing for the way he'd treated me and wanting to discuss working with me on his next album," Ezrin explained. He was excited at first by the material Waters played him, but he began to feel uncomfortable once they started to negotiate the terms of making the album. "As flexible as he would like to portray himself, he's an incredibly rigid guy."

The plan was that Ezrin and his family would move to the U.K. for three months while they made the record. "But I knew it would take six months . . . probably longer. I talked to my wife about it, and for two weeks we were going to do it. But one day she burst into tears and said she just couldn't face it. So I called Roger and said that I couldn't do it. And there were fireworks, and everyone was angry with me—again."

WHEN WATERS FOUND OUT THERE WAS GOING TO BE A PINK FLOYD ALBUM WITHOUT HIM, HE BEGAN A HIGH COURT APPLICATION TO HAVE THE GROUP LEGALLY DISSOLVED...

Two weeks later, Ezrin received a call from Gilmour, who wanted to play him some songs intended for an album Pink Floyd were planning to make without Waters. "When I heard them I was definitely interested," Ezrin recalled. Gilmour proposed starting work on the album in the U.K., with regular breaks for Ezrin to return home, before completing the record in Los Angeles. "This all seemed much more favorable and human to me, so I said yes."

Now Waters was really angry, believing this all to be part of a conspiracy against him. When he found out there was going to be a Pink Floyd album without him, he began a High Court application in October 1987 to have the group legally dissolved.

The statement he had previously issued to CBS and EMI Records was now made public, complete with his assertion that Pink Floyd were "a spent force creatively."

The others responded in November with a statement of their own. "Although Roger Waters quit in December 1985, the group have no intention of disbanding. On the contrary, David Gilmour and Nick Mason with Rick Wright and producer Bob Ezrin are currently recording a new album." Gilmour's own explanation was equally measured. "The strength of Pink Floyd always lay in the talents of all four members. Naturally we will miss Roger's artistic input. However, we will continue to work together as in the past. We are surprised at recent claims that Roger believes the band to be 'a spent force creatively' as he's had no involvement with the current project. The three of us are very excited by the new material and would prefer to be judged by the public on the strength of the forthcoming Pink Floyd album."

EMI and CBS Records were anxious not to get embroiled in the legal battle—not least because they had deals with both Waters and Pink Floyd—but when Waters's lawyers started making threatening noises about what might happen if a new Pink Floyd album came out, the labels checked the small print of the band's contract and found that it allowed for various permutations of the band members to operate as Pink Floyd—including one that did not include Waters. Even so, the labels were wary as to whether the public would buy an album by this reconfigured Pink Floyd in such high quantities as before, so were not about to offer any inducements to the band, financial or otherwise, to speed up their progress.

A Momentary Lapse of Reason came together on Gilmour's houseboat, built in 1910 for Edwardian music hall impresario Fred Karno, which Gilmour had moored on the Thames at Hampton Court. Gilmour had also converted the dining room into a studio. "It wasn't just the boat," Ezrin recalled. "It was the whole environment around the boat. It was so imposing that it was impossible to divorce it from the music we were making. We agreed that what made a great Pink Floyd album was the atmosphere and the sense of environment from start to finish. Everyone nodded, and when we looked around we realized we were in the place—this magnificent boat on this magical river." Inspired by the setting, Ezrin now found himself sitting in a rowboat at five o'clock one Sunday morning, "freezing my nuts off," as he attempted to record the album's opening sequence.



ABOVE: Roger Waters's *Radio K.A.O.S.* album released in June of 1987.

While the music came easily to Gilmour, words were a tougher proposition. Looking beyond the professional wordsmiths-for-hire, he found a veteran of the early 1970s hippie daze, Anthony Moore, a former member of a little-known group called Slapp Happy. Moore's lyrics strengthened three of the early, crucial tracks on the album.

"We were all conscious that Roger's greatest contribution was his amazing poetic, lyrical sense," Ezrin continued. "We never tried to replicate that, but we knew there was a hole that we needed to fill. And Pink Floyd was always a collaboration, so we brought in collaborators. Once we got into the right frame of mind, which we did very early on, we were in the flow." Mason and Wright were involved only in a limited capacity. Mason was present, but by his own admission he was out of practice; Wright arrived later and was also rusty. As far as Gilmour was concerned, Waters had broken their confidence.

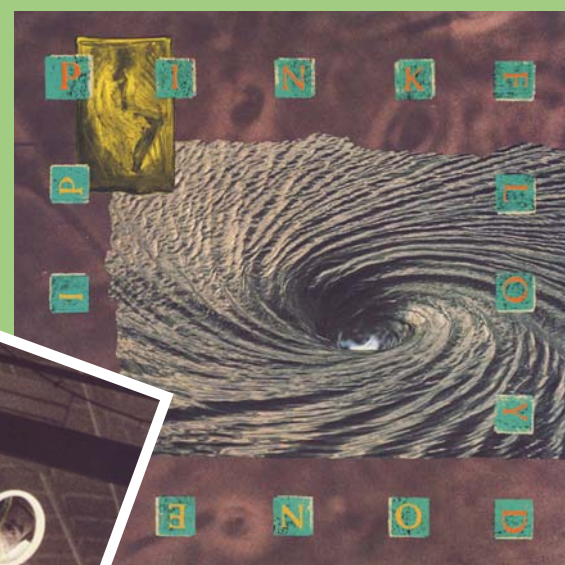
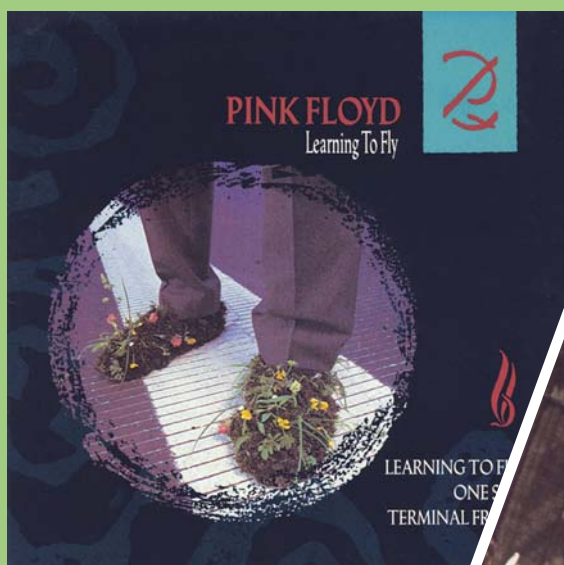
Gilmour was also distracted by threats of injunctions from Waters's lawyers, particularly once it became known that Pink Floyd intended to tour in 1987. Once the band had finished recording the basic tracks on Gilmour's boat they moved to Los Angeles for mixing and overdubs. As well as giving them access to top U.S. session players—including drummers Jim Keltner and Carmine Appice, bassist Tony Levin, and saxophonist Tom

Scott—the move also had the advantage, according to Ezrin, of placing them in a time zone that restricted the number of hours during which Waters's lawyers could pester them. Just in case anyone thought that Waters was giving up the fight, however, his lawyers issued a new statement in April 1987 declaring that his dispute with the other members of Pink Floyd was "proceeding in the courts to resolve the question of rights to the name and assets of Pink Floyd, which include the many stage effects used in the past. Despite press reports to the contrary, Waters, the major songwriter and producer of *Dark Side of the Moon* and *The Wall* as well as the lead singer and creative force, has not dropped any of his claims." (Among Waters's claims was that he held the "creative rights" to Algie, the flying pig. When the others checked back, they found that Waters had indeed commissioned Algie, but also that he had specified a sow, so it was decided that the pig for the band's forthcoming concerts would have unfeasibly large testicles. This, of course, was not enough to deter Waters's lawyers, who issued another writ in which they claimed that the gender of the pig was "irrelevant.")

ONE OF ROGER'S CLAIMS WAS THAT HE HELD THE "CREATIVE RIGHTS" TO ALGIE, THE FLYING PIG...

Despite Waters's best efforts, it was proving tough for him to force the other members of Pink Floyd to disband. There had never been a formal partnership between them, making it much less straightforward for the group to be legally dissolved. In the meantime, Waters had been working on a second solo album, *Radio K.A.O.S.*, which was released in June 1987. Taking the form of a radio show hosted by noted Los Angeles D.J. Jim Ladd, the album explored the power of capitalism and market forces over politicians and was dedicated "to all those who find themselves at the violent end of monetarism." Produced by Waters and keyboard player Ian Ritchie, the album failed to match the success of its predecessor, stalling at No. 50 in the U.S. and No. 25 in the U.K.

In August, Waters started a 34-date tour of North American arenas for which he was joined on stage by Ladd, who introduced



ABOVE: Singles taken from *A Momentary Lapse of Reason*: "Learning to Fly" (left), "On the Turning Away" (center), and "One Slip" (right).

a selection of songs that ranged from Pink Floyd material to tracks from the new album. The set varied from night to night but would frequently include an homage to Syd Barrett, with the original promotional film for "Arnold Layne" shown on the big screen while Waters and his band had tea on stage; during the interval, Waters would enter a phone booth in the auditorium and take questions from the audience. The show closed each night with the optimistic anthem from *Radio K.A.O.S.*, "The Tide Is Turning (After Live Aid)," which Waters had composed after watching the transatlantic charity concert on television. The tour finished with two nights at London's Wembley Arena—the only European dates on the tour.

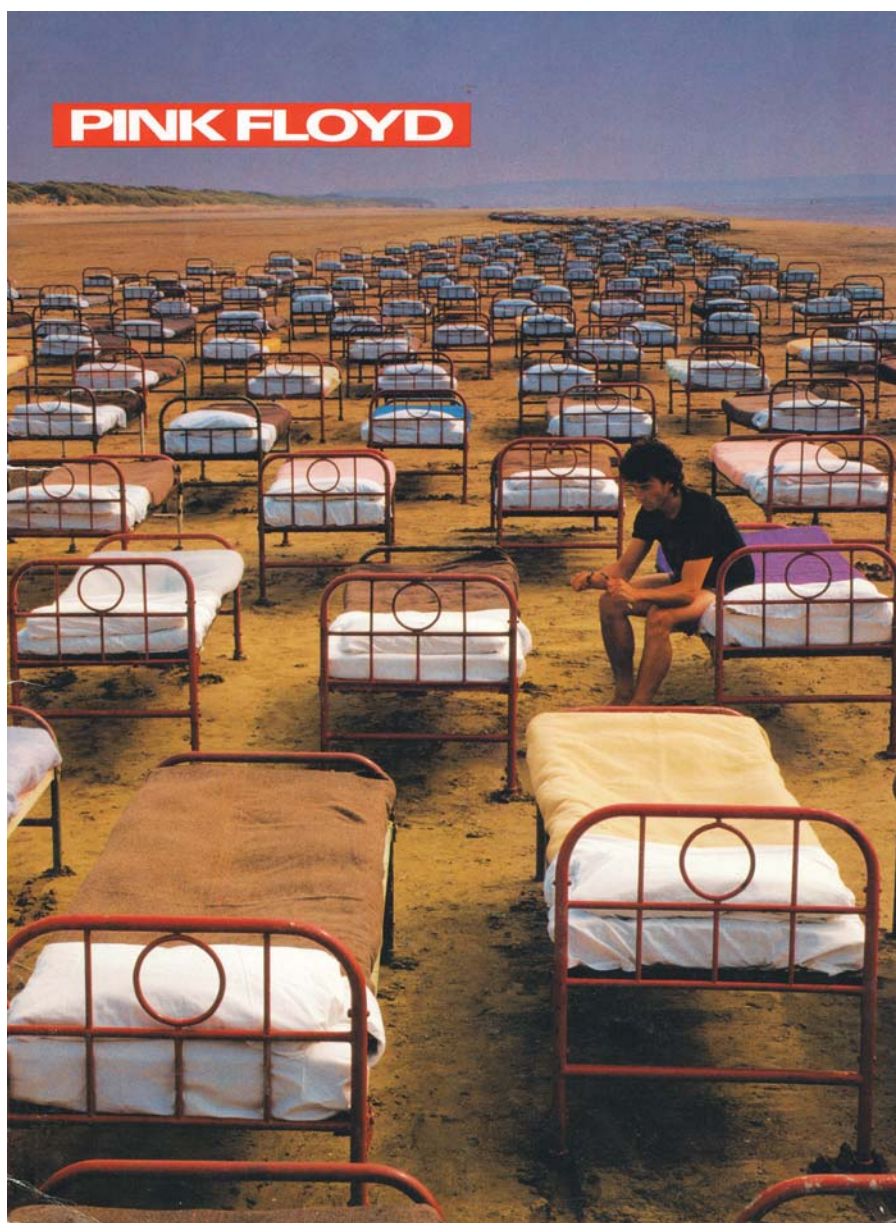
Pink Floyd's *A Momentary Lapse of Reason* was released in early September 1987, with many of the reviews naturally focused on whether it was a "real" Pink Floyd album or not. Opinions were divided; as far as Waters was concerned, the album was "a pretty fair forgery." The cover marked a return for Storm Thorgerson and Hipgnosis, who managed to round up 800 hospital beds and set them up for a photo shoot on the beach at

Saunton Sands in Devon, southwest England. The inner sleeve contained a picture of Gilmour and Mason, Wright's return having been complicated by several factors, including a clause in his leaving agreement that prevented him from rejoining the band and Gilmour's lingering uncertainty over whether Wright would be able to contribute more than he had on recent albums, as well as to protect him from the litigation Waters was taking against the band.

The album confounded the record companies' doubts and rose swiftly to No. 3 in both the U.S. and the U.K., comfortably outselling its predecessor, *The Final Cut*. Even so, with the band having not toured for ten years there was some speculation—not least within the Pink Floyd camp—as to whether they could still attract a stadium-sized crowd. Gilmour and Mason had put up \$3 million in startup costs for the tour themselves, with Mason having to sell a couple of vintage cars to fund his share of the cash. Their anxieties were assuaged when the first show to go on sale, at Toronto's Canadian National Exhibition Stadium, sold out in a few hours. A second show was added, and that sold out too.

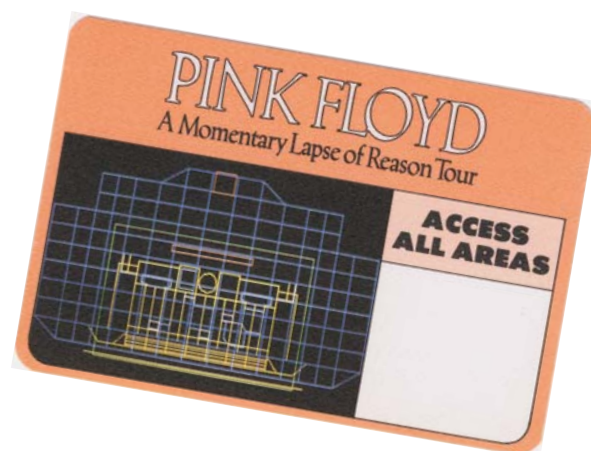


LEFT: David Gilmour (seated left), Rick Wright (seated right), and Nick Mason (standing) in Versailles, France, on June 9, 1988.



LEFT: 1987 Pink Floyd World Tour program.

BELOW: A Momentary Lapse of Reason tour pass in 1987.



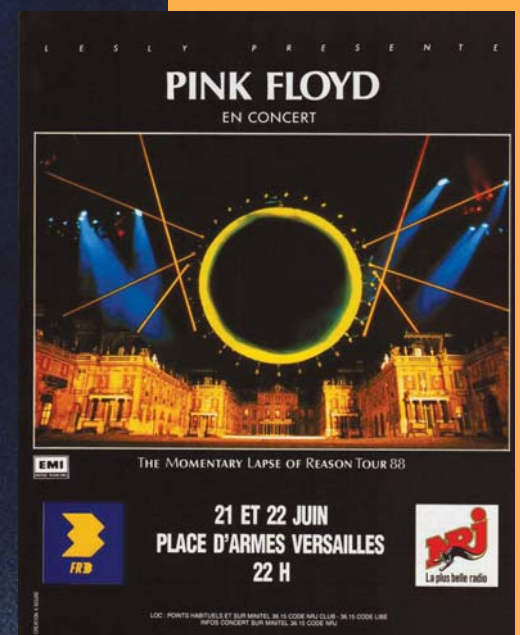
On September 9, 1987, following a month of rehearsals, Pink Floyd started a three-month tour of North American stadiums and arenas in Ottawa, Canada. The eight-piece band recruited for the tour included guitarist Tim Renwick (another of the Cambridge generation who had played on Waters's *Pros and Cons of Hitch Hiking* tour), young session bassist Guy Pratt (who had established his reputation with the Dream Academy, Icehouse, and Bryan Ferry), keyboard player Jon Carin, drummer Gary Wallis, and three backup singers.

The tour's promoters had already attracted the attention of Waters's lawyers, who warned of injunctions if their client's "creative rights" were infringed. Pink Floyd had lawyers on

standby in every city, just in case. Waters himself was having to face a grim reality—one that was brought home forcibly during a couple of weeks in October, when the two bands found themselves touring in uncomfortably close proximity. Pink Floyd's stadium shows—with lights, sound, and special effects to match—were selling out; Waters, meanwhile, was struggling to half-fill arenas. Waters may have been the "creative leader" of Pink Floyd, but to the hundreds of thousands of people who flocked to see the band—many of them for the first time—he was simply the bass player who had left the group. It was Gilmour's guitar and voice that best embodied the sound of Pink Floyd.



ABOVE: The giant pig above the stage at a Pink Floyd concert at Wembley Stadium, UK, on August 5, 1988.



ABOVE: Poster for a concert in Versailles, Paris, in June of 1988.



ABOVE: Curtain call after Pink Floyd's concert at the Hubert H. Humphrey Metrodome in Minneapolis, Minnesota, on May 24, 1988. David Gilmour is second from the left, and Richard Wright is on the far right.

LEFT: Ticket for concerts in both Japan and Wembley Stadium in London in 1988.

“My [attorney] told me over a year ago that the kind of justice I was after I could only get from the public,” Waters told *Rolling Stone*. “The law is not interested in the moral issue but in the name as a piece of property. I’m out on the road in competition with myself—and I’m losing. I’m sure I would be much happier if I could murder them professionally as Pink Floyd.”

At the end of 1987, with the threat of a long, bitter, and costly court case looming, the two sides came to an agreement that effectively ended the legal dispute between them. Waters acknowledged Gilmour and Mason’s right to the name “Pink Floyd”; they in turn conceded his rights to the concept of *The*

Wall and various special effects—including the pig. Only the animosity remained. Waters went home, Pink Floyd went global.

The band spent the first quarter of 1988 touring New Zealand, Australia, and Japan, the second back in North America, and the third trundling around the stadiums of Europe. They also played a huge outdoor show at the Royal Palace of Versailles on the edge of Paris, and another at West Berlin’s Reichstagsgelände, where 2,000 East Berliners gathered on the other side of the Berlin Wall to listen to the show. Arrests were made after people chanted for the Wall to be knocked down. (A year and a half later, the Wall would come down, along with the regime that built it.)





**PINK FLOYD PLAYED
A CONCERT IN WEST
BERLIN, AND 2,000
EAST BERLINERS
GATHERED ON THE
OTHER SIDE OF
THE BERLIN WALL
TO LISTEN...**



ABOVE: Press photo of Nick Mason.

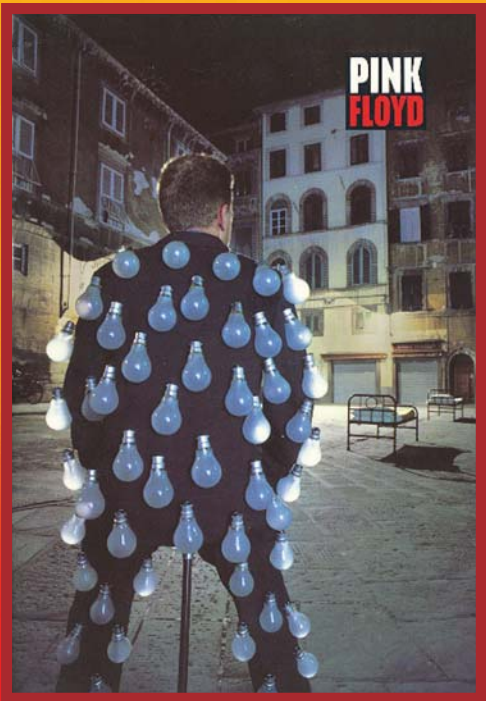
LEFT: Pink Floyd performing live onstage in the Netherlands on the Momentary Lapse of Reason tour on June 13, 1988.



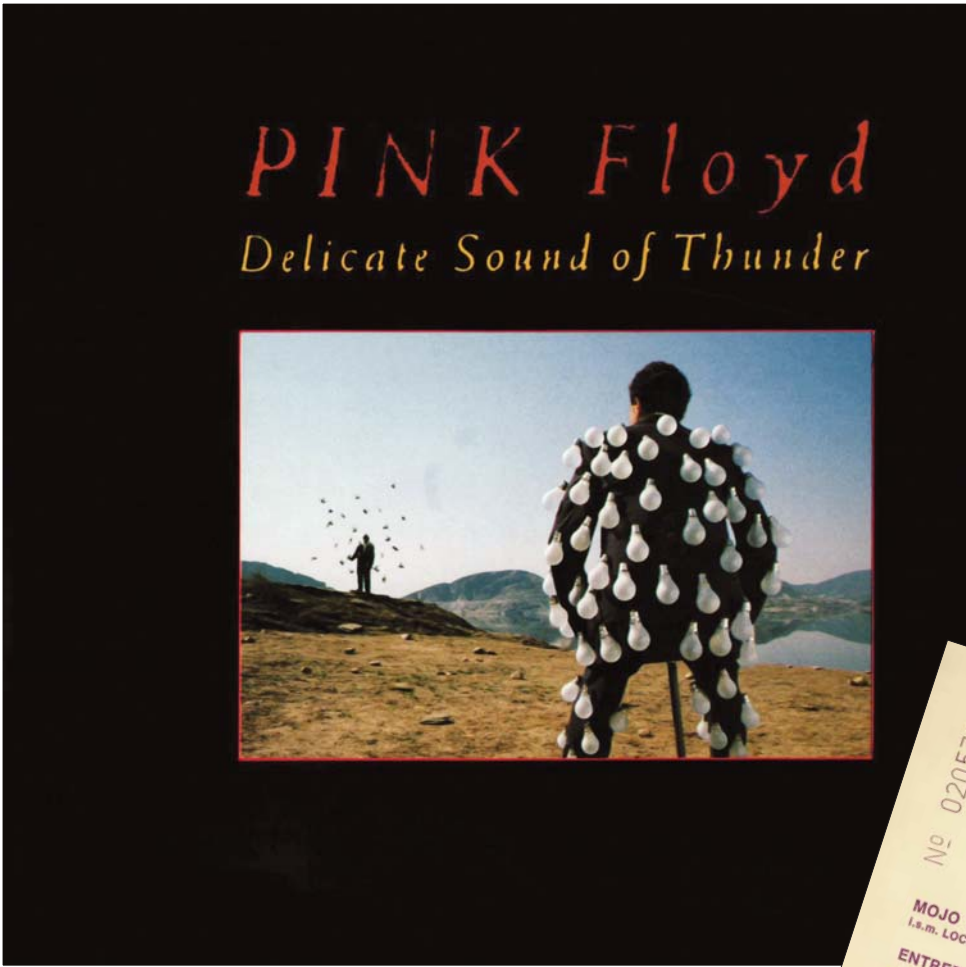
RIGHT: Pink Floyd in the Netherlands on June 13, 1988.



THE *DELICATE SOUND OF THUNDER* WAS THE FIRST ROCK ALBUM TO BE PLAYED IN SPACE WHEN A RUSSIAN SPACECRAFT TOOK IT WITH THEM ON BOARD...



ABOVE: Pink Floyd 1989 tour program.



ABOVE: *Delicate Sound Of Thunder* LP and live album which was released in November of 1988



RIGHT: Goffertpark Nijmegen, in the Netherlands, ticket stub.



ABOVE: Pink Floyd performing live onstage on the first date of the Another Lapse tour.

Pink Floyd wound down with another short tour of the East Coast of the U.S.A., including four nights at Nassau Coliseum, which were recorded for a live album. When the results were issued on a double CD set as *Delicate Sound of Thunder* in November 1988, some critics were suspicious that the live sound was “too perfect.” It was with some pleasure that Gilmour made clear that there had been no fixing, no overdubbing. “It’s real music performed by live people,” he explained, “with one or two younger, keen hired guns helping us in there.” The album features live versions of most of the tracks from *A Momentary Lapse of Reason* plus numerous Floyd classics, including a ten-minute romp through “Money” and the awesome finale of “Comfortably Numb” and “Run Like Hell.” It reached No. 11 in both the U.S. and the U.K. It was also the first rock album to be played in outer

space when the crew of the Russian spacecraft Soyuz TM-7 took it with them at the end of November. Gilmour and Mason attended the launch in Baikonur, Kazakhstan, where they handed over a cassette of the album. (The crew left the cassette box behind to “save weight.”)

The tour didn’t stop with the release of the live album. In May 1990, Pink Floyd were back in Europe, playing Italy and Greece before taking their live show to Russia for four nights at Moscow’s Olimpiyskiy Stadium in early June. Many bands would scale down their Russian shows in view of the distances involved and the problems of getting paid in a convertible currency; Pink Floyd requested that the Russian promoter fly their full show in and out of the country, and were paid a proportion of their fee in a consignment of timber.



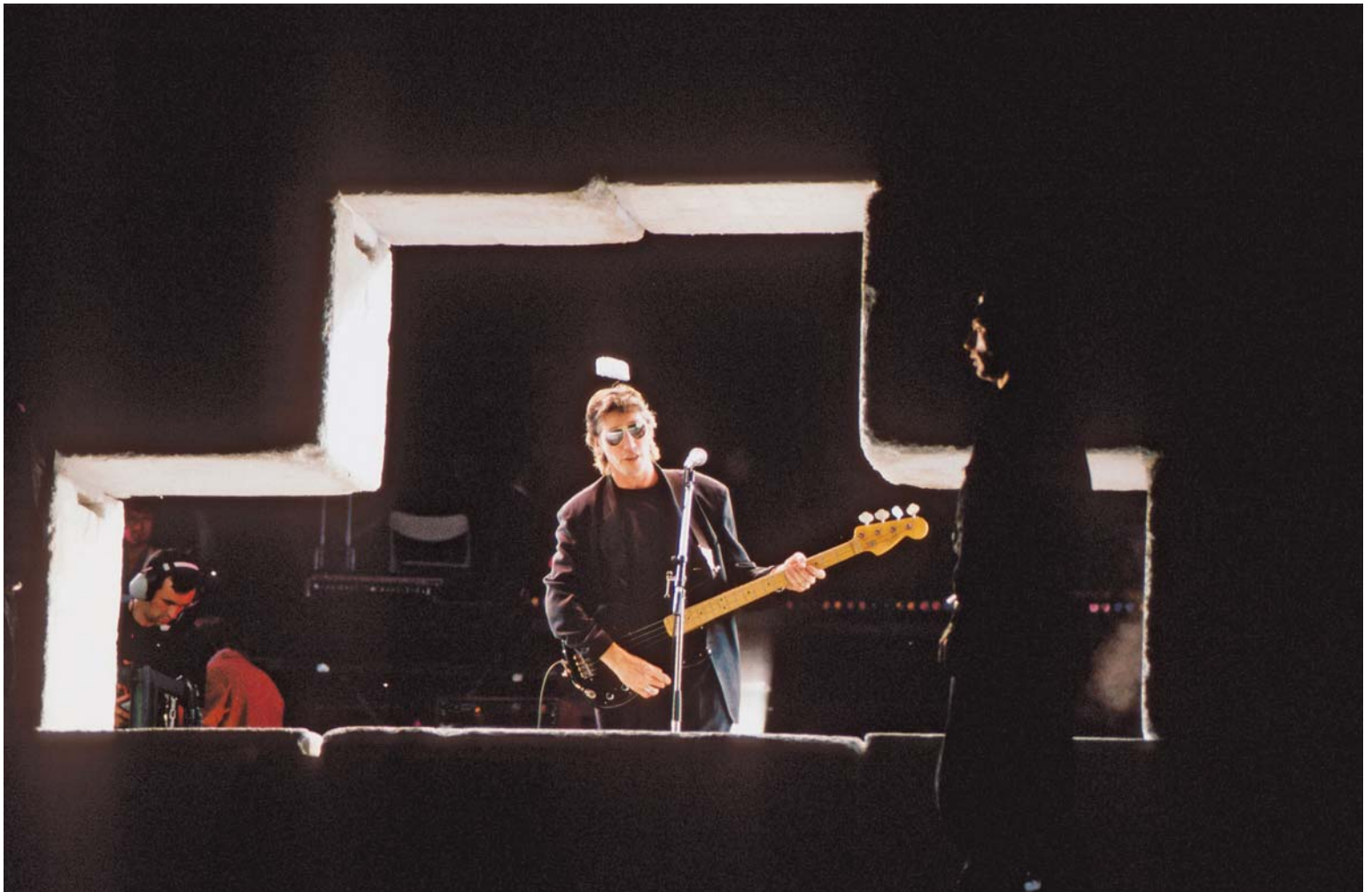
ABOVE: Don't cross the streams...Pink Floyd's laser light show on March 18, 1990.

The whole operation was certainly more efficient than the fiasco of their Venice concert the following month. The band had arranged to play a free show on a floating barge on the lagoon facing St. Mark's Square. The concert would be simulcast to television around the globe. Two days before the show, however, the Superintendent of Monuments suddenly announced that the vibrations from the band's sound system could damage the facades of ancient buildings, with a risk of falling masonry. Bemused that the subject had not been raised before, the band agreed to lower their decibel level. On the day of the concert, more than 200,000 people turned up to find that the civic authorities had made no provision for them whatsoever. Not a single mobile toilet had been arranged. The result was that parts of the city came to resemble open-air latrines. In the aftermath, the army was called in to clear up 300 tons of rubbish and excrement,

prompting first the head of the city's culture committee and then the rest of the council to resign, leaving Venice to be governed by an ad hoc administration. Plans for a commemorative postage stamp were quietly canceled.

Even so, more than 100 million people got to see the concert in the more comfortable surroundings of their living rooms, and by the time the tour finished, a couple of weeks later, Pink Floyd had played 200 shows to an audience of some 5.5 million people, with total receipts estimated at \$100 million. Less happily, Gilmour's 14-year marriage to Ginger had reached breaking point, and Waters was suing the band for unpaid royalties for using the pig.

Waters had spent the first part of 1988 working on an album that would eventually emerge as *Amused to Death*. He put the project aside for a while, however, when he was approached to



ABOVE: Roger Waters performs live onstage at The Wall concert in Berlin, Germany, on July 21, 1990.

write an opera based on a libretto by the French writer Étienne Roda-Gil, whom he had first met 20 years earlier. The opera, titled *Ça Ira* (which translates approximately as *We Will Make It*) was based on the events leading up to the French Revolution, and there were plans to stage it at the bicentennial celebrations of the storming of the Bastille in the summer of 1989 before the project got mired in budgetary constraints and French cultural politics.

Later in 1989, the fall of the Berlin Wall gave Waters another idea. He had previously stated that he would perform *The Wall* in Berlin once the existing Wall was demolished, and in April 1990 he made good on that promise when he announced plans to stage the album at Berlin's Potsdamer Platz, located in what was once no-man's land between East and West Berlin, on July 21, in aid of the Memorial Fund for Disaster Relief. The scale of the event matched anything Pink Floyd had ever attempted, with or without

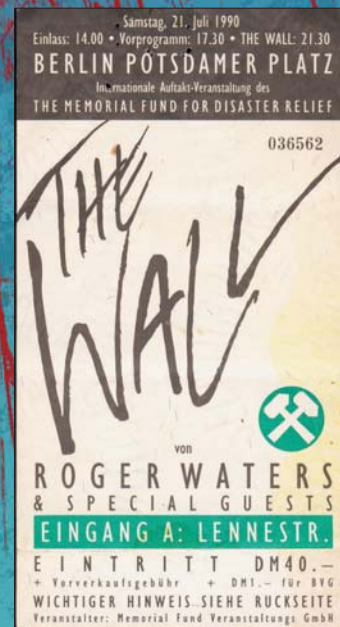
Waters. Mark Fisher and Jonathan Park, who had designed the original Wall in 1980, were hired to build a new open-air Wall strong enough to withstand 40 mph. winds. An all-star cast was assembled for the show, including Bryan Adams, Thomas Dolby, Marianne Faithfull, Cyndi Lauper, Joni Mitchell, Van Morrison, Sinéad O'Connor, German band the Scorpions, and Levon Helm, Rick Danko, and Garth Hudson from The Band.

Despite the logistical complexity, the short preparation time, and the sheer difficulty of organizing an event in a nation still in the throes of reunification, the show passed without incident. The performance itself was largely the same as the version of *The Wall* staged in 1980, although Waters added "The Tide is Turning" as a more optimistic finale. Some 180,000 people had bought tickets, but another 120,000 are thought to have gatecrashed the show, which was filmed for release on video later in the year.





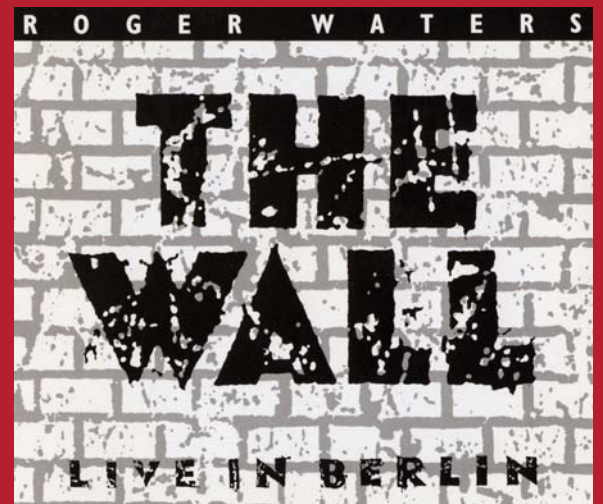
WATERS PROMISED TO
PERFORM *THE WALL* IN BERLIN
ONCE THE EXISTING WALL WAS
DEMOLISHED, AND HE MADE
GOOD ON HIS PROMISE...



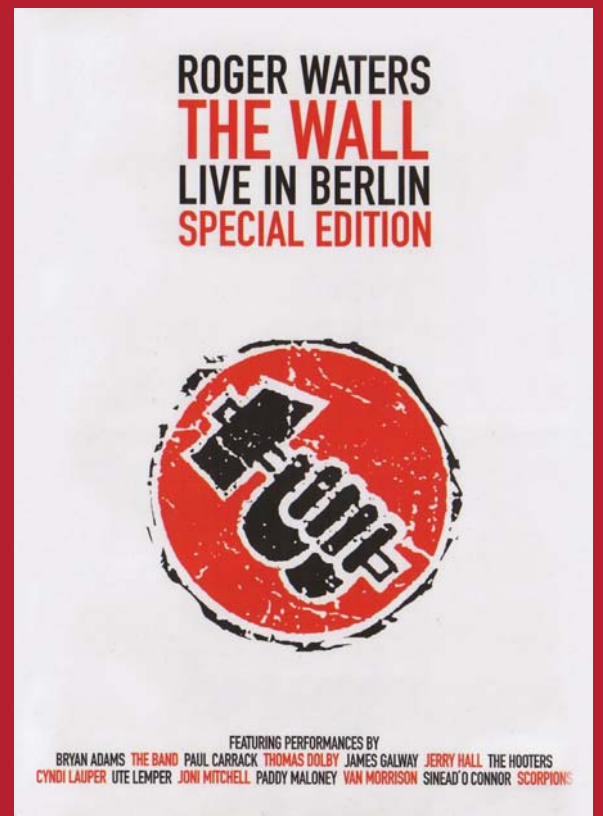
ABOVE: Concert pass for The Wall show
starring Roger Waters and special guests.

LEFT: Roger Waters with the Scorpions at the rehearsal for The Wall concert in Berlin,
Germany.



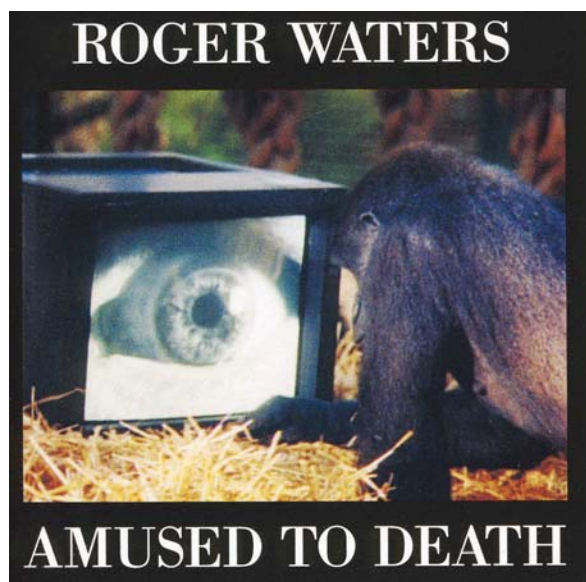


ABOVE: CD for *The Wall—Live in Berlin*.

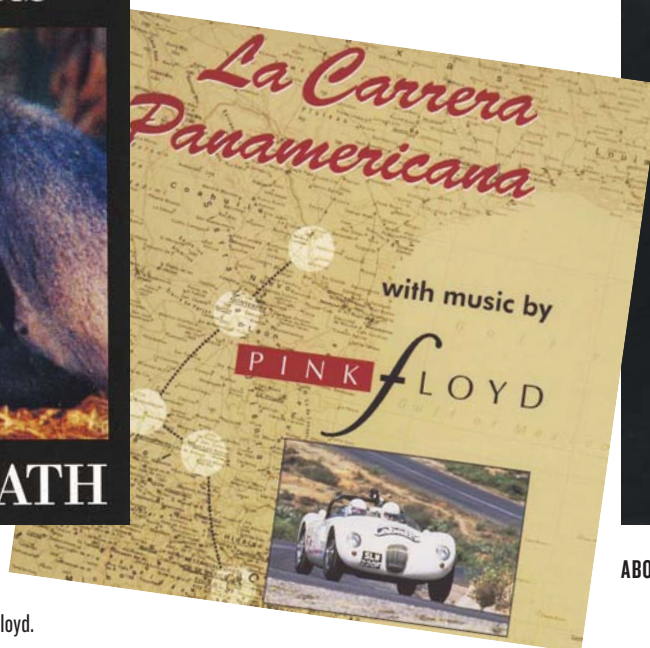


ABOVE: Special Edition DVD for *The Wall—Live in Berlin*.

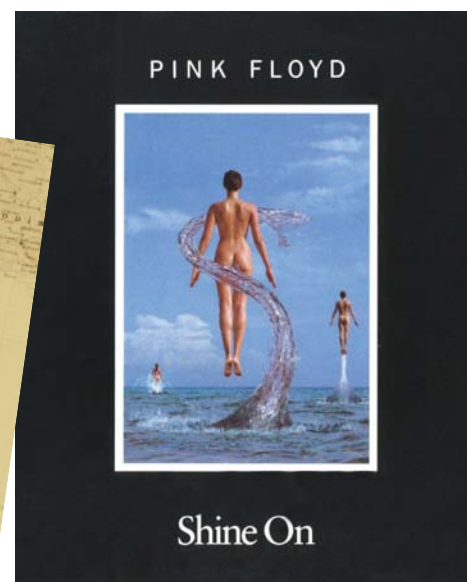
LEFT: Roger Waters performs in Berlin, Germany, on July 21, 1990, to commemorate the fall of the Berlin Wall.



ABOVE: Roger Waters' solo CD, *Amused to Death*.



RIGHT: *La Carrera Panamericana* CD featuring music by Pink Floyd.



ABOVE: Boxed set for Pink Floyd's *Shine On*.

Despite the success of the show, Waters couldn't resist a dig at his former band, who had just played their only concert of 1990, headlining the Silver Clef Awards Winners charity show at Knebworth Park on a bill also featuring Paul McCartney, Elton John, Genesis, Eric Clapton, and Dire Straits. "It will be most gratifying that a few more people in the world will understand that *The Wall* is my work and always has been," he told *Q* magazine. "Still, most of the audience for this show will think it's Pink Floyd anyway. The attachment to the brand name is limpet-like. It's just something I have to live with."

After releasing *The Wall—Live In Berlin* in September, Waters resumed work on *Amused to Death*. Progress was slow, and not helped by the breakup of his marriage to his second wife, Carlyne Christie. The album was eventually released in September 1992, featuring another surprise guest guitarist: Jeff Beck.

"Roger had been chasing me for months," Beck recalled. "When he put me on [the album], the thing was nowhere near completed. He played me only the pieces where he wanted guitar. On the opening track ("The Ballad of Bill Hubbard"), we just blazed away for 15 minutes, had a coffee, and went home. Forgot all about it. Next thing I know it's the lead track on the album. I don't know what the hell it's all about. He did explain it to me, but I wasn't really listening."

In fact, the album was about the power and influence of television—which, according to Waters, has the potential either to save or destroy us. The album performed better in the charts than *Radio K.A.O.S.*, reaching No. 21 in the U.S. and No. 6 in the U.K., but sales were not strong enough to make the idea of a tour economically feasible.

Pink Floyd meanwhile took an extended break after completing the Momentary Lapse tour in the summer of 1990, during which Mason married actress Annette Lynton, his second wife, and Gilmour began a relationship with journalist Polly Samson. In 1991, Gilmour and Mason, along with manager Steve O'Rourke, decided to indulge their collective passion for vintage sports cars by taking part in the Mexican Carrera Panamericana. Combining business with pleasure, they decided to make a film of their rally experience for which they would also provide the soundtrack. The whole venture nearly ended in disaster when the replica C-type Jaguar driven by Gilmour and O'Rourke went over a cliff at a high speed. While Gilmour suffered only cuts and abrasions, O'Rourke suffered a compound leg fracture and was hospitalized. According to Mason, it could have been a lot worse.

Recording the soundtrack to the film took Gilmour, Mason, and Wright back in time to Pink Floyd's early dalliances with the

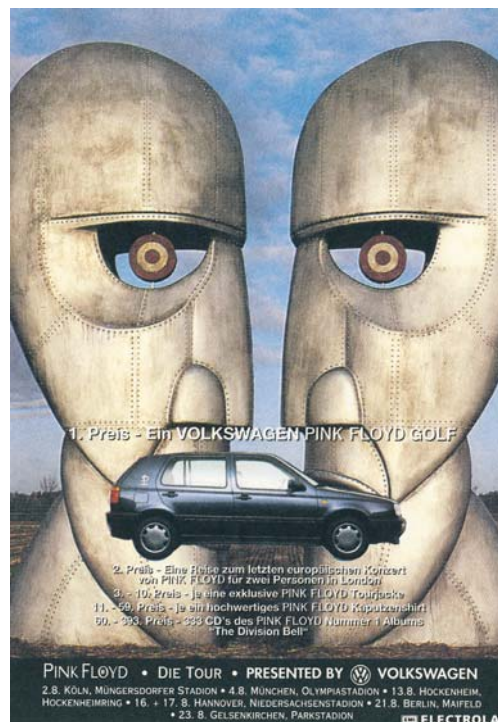


ABOVE: Polly Samson and David Gilmour at the Serpentine in London.

movie industry in the late '60s/early '70s, on albums like *More* and *Obscured by Clouds*, creating music in the studio to fit existing visual images. So it was perhaps no accident that they took a similarly retro approach when it came to recording a new Pink Floyd album at the beginning of 1993. The three of them convened at the newly refurbished Britannia Row Studio with no preconceived ideas and started jamming together. Within a couple of days it was clear that this “old fashioned” method that had served them so well on the *Atom Heart Mother*, *Meddle*, and *Dark Side of the Moon* albums was still capable of yielding results. They decided to invite their bassist, Guy Pratt, to the sessions, and he added a new dynamic to their endeavors. After two weeks, they had over 40 workable musical ideas down.

In February they moved to Gilmour's houseboat studio where they were joined by Bob Ezrin, and they began the process of turning the best ideas into songs. With less pressure and fewer distractions—and no angst from Waters's lawyers—the atmosphere was congenial and productive. At one point they even entertained the idea of a second, more ambient-oriented record, which could have opened up a whole new range of possibilities, before deciding to focus on a single album. Wright was now a fully functioning member of the band again, and he would end up writing one song and cowriting four others.

Gilmour was also more relaxed as the album began to take shape. His playing was more expansive and his lyric writing was encouraged by his girlfriend (and soon-to-be wife) Polly, to the point where he decided she should be given cowriting credits. Admitting that *A Momentary Lapse of Reason* had been “a very, very difficult process,” he told *Guitar World*, “We're all playing and functioning much better than we were after the trials and tribulations of the late Roger years.” Communication became a recurring theme for many of the songs, particularly on “Poles Apart,” “Lost for Words,” and “Keep Talking.” It was a theme that Storm Thorgerson would pick up on for the album cover, for which he constructed two 15 ft. high metal heads that he placed facing each other in the flat fenland near Ely in Cambridgeshire.



ABOVE: Postcard for Pink Floyd's *Division Bell* tour.

By the summer the band were ready to commit to releasing the album in March 1994 with a world tour to coincide. This gave them time to work on their staging and presentation, and they commissioned their longtime designer Mark Fisher and lighting designer Marc Brickman to design a stage based on the shape of the Hollywood Bowl with a giant rotating circular screen encircled with lights that could hover horizontally above the band as well as hanging vertically behind them. Two towers on either side of



ABOVE: The Pink Floyd Airship.



ABOVE: Pink Floyd's "Take It Back" single.



ABOVE: Pink Floyd's "High Hopes" single.

AUTHOR DOUGLAS ADAMS CAME UP WITH THE TITLE FOR *THE DIVISION BELL* ALBUM.

the stage would house a state-of-the-art Turbosound PA system with up to 300 speakers, but still leaving room for an inflatable pig to poke its head over the top. Three stages were eventually built so that the band could maximize their touring schedule as the stages leapfrogged their way along the route.

As the album neared completion, new films were commissioned to be projected onto the screen for particular songs. Meanwhile, Brickman was lining up 400 Vari-Lites and two copper-vapor lasers that had originally been developed for NASA and were so powerful that they required Federal Aviation Authority approval so that the airspace above the venue could be closed. The mirror ball was enlarged and moved to the newly designed sound-and-lighting center in front of the stage so that the whole stadium could be bathed in shafts of light. But amidst all the cutting-edge technology, the band brought back their original 1960s lighting man, Peter Wynn Wilson, to recreate his

psychedelic liquid oil patterns during the two Syd Barrett-era songs they were planning to play on tour.

Only the album title itself was subject to the usual last-minute panic. In the end, the band's friend and fan Douglas Adams, author of *The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy*, came up with *The Division Bell*. The grateful band came up with a generous donation to the charity of his choice before realizing that the title actually came from one of the song lyrics. *The Division Bell* was released on time in March 1994 and went straight to No. 1 in both the U.S. and the U.K. The tour began in Miami at the end of that month and crisscrossed North America through July. The Apple computer system operating the light shows was flexible enough that the band could change their set list without having to let everyone know days in advance (as would often be the case), and they took full advantage, bringing a new edge to the show and keeping the crew, which now numbered 200, on their toes.



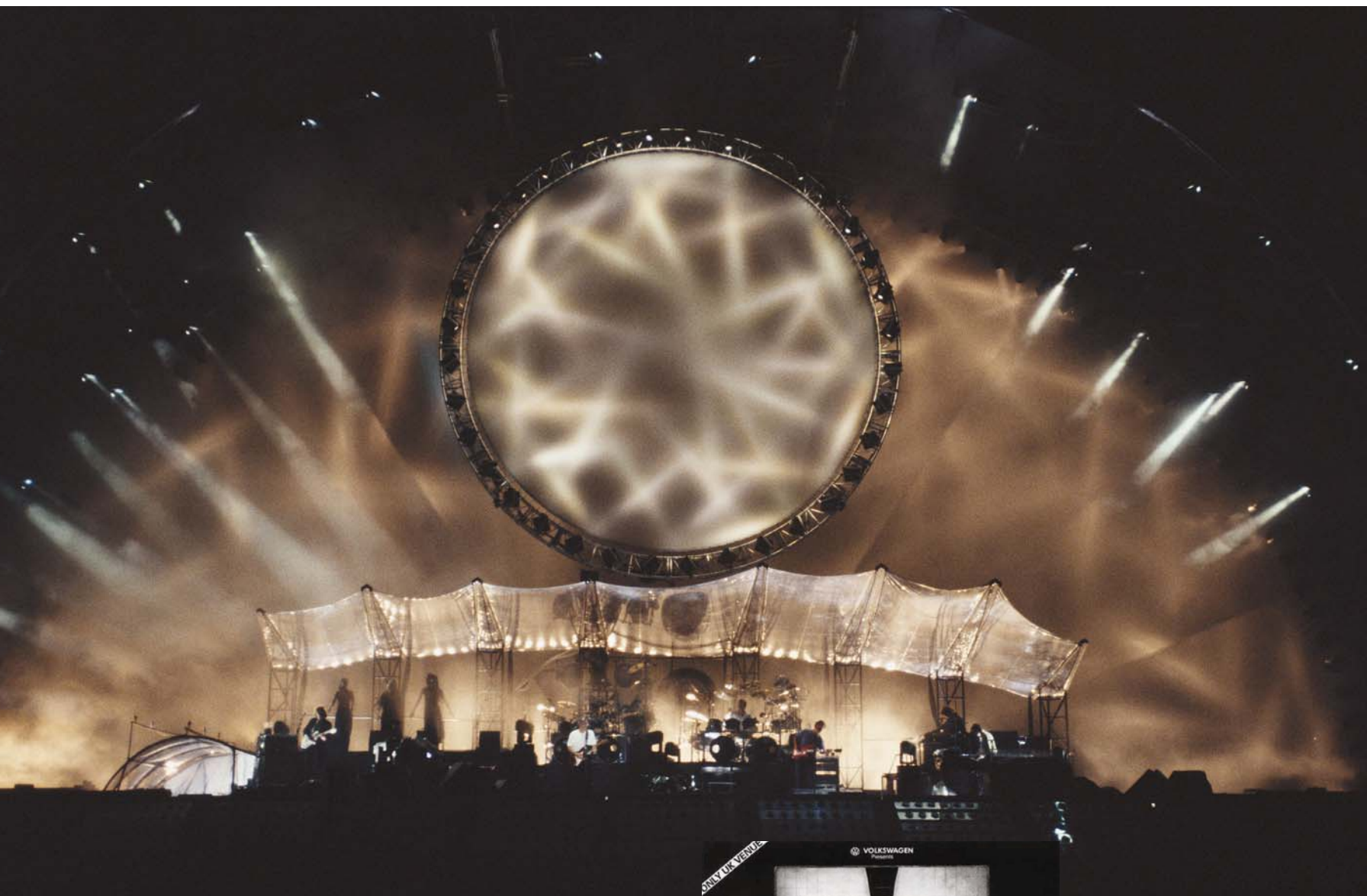
ABOVE: From left to right: David Gilmour, Rick Wright, and Nick Mason of Pink Floyd at a concert on their Division Bell tour in April of 1994.



ABOVE: Ticket to Pink Floyd's Munich concert in 1994.

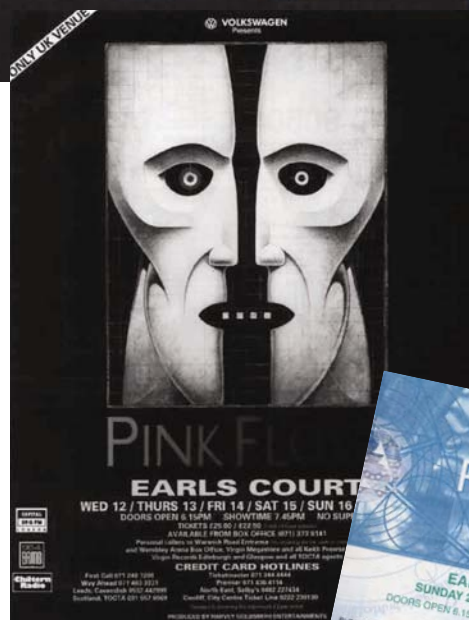
Just four days after their last U.S. show, Pink Floyd started their European tour in Portugal, having flown their equipment across the Atlantic in one huge Russian Antonov transporter and a couple of Boeing 747s. By now, the band had taken to playing the whole of *Dark Side of the Moon*, in sequence, for the second half of the show, and had commissioned new films to replace

some of the original visuals, which they considered to be dated. They also extended an invitation for Waters to join them for that part of the show, but he declined, which was a shame, since if nothing else he would surely have enjoyed the dinner with Czech Republic president, playwright, and former political prisoner Václav Havel that followed the band's concert in Prague.

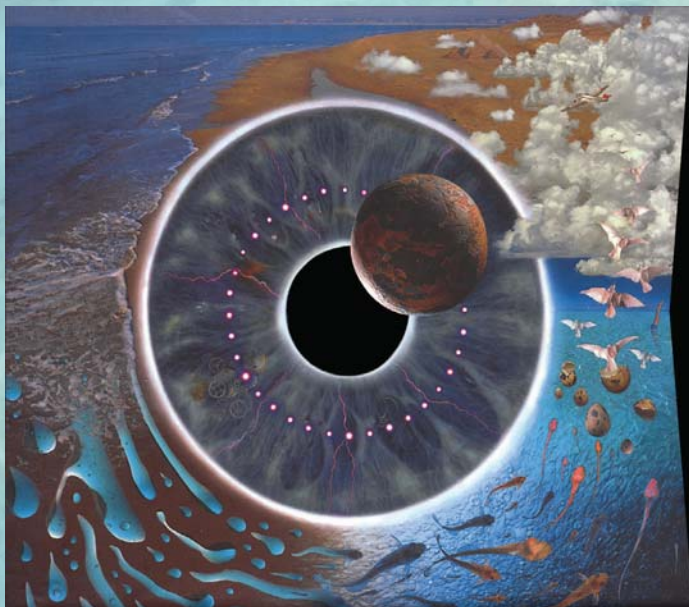


ABOVE: A view of the dynamic stage show during a Pink Floyd concert on the Division Bell tour in 1994.

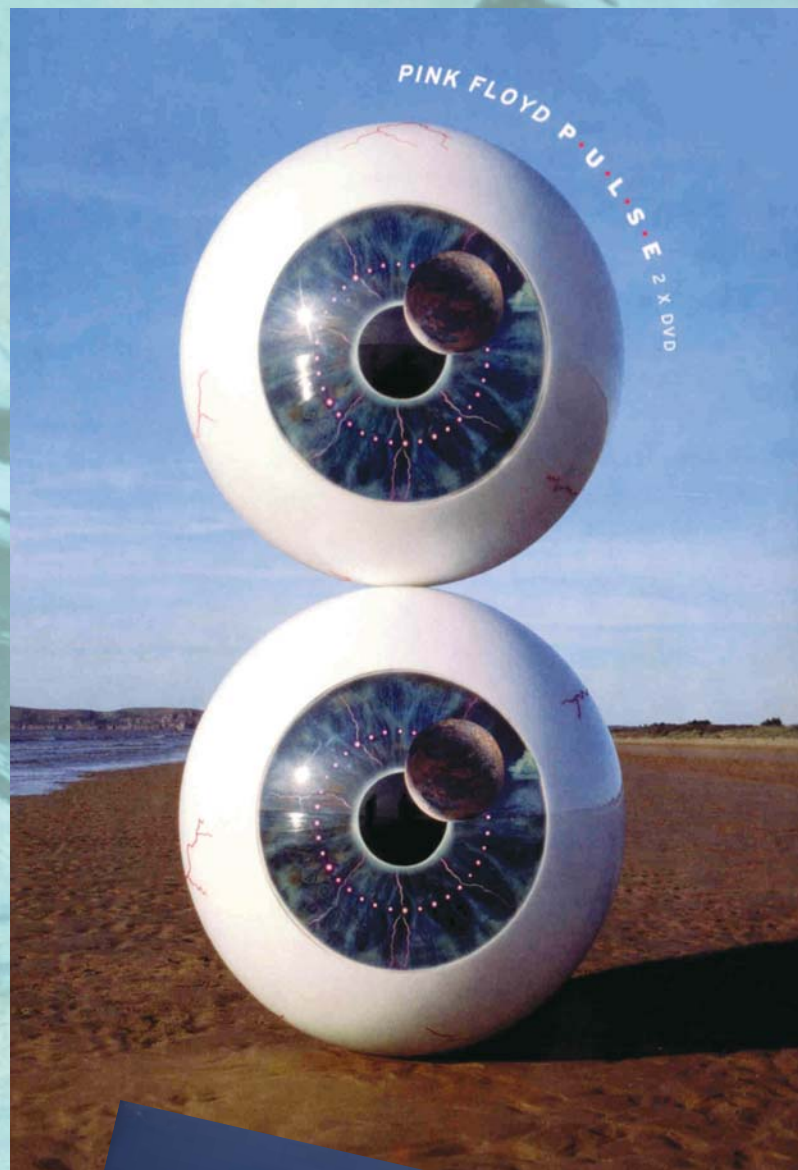
The tour ended in London with a 14-night run at the indoor Earls Court arena. The opening night was canceled after a section of seating collapsed minutes before the concert was due to start, injuring several people, although fortunately no one was seriously hurt. The concerts were recorded and filmed for another live album and video, *Pulse*. The tour ended on October 29, having reached the same number of people and earned the same gross income in six months that the previous tour had taken two-and-a-half years to accrue. But while the tour had been an outstanding success, there were no further plans on the horizon.



ABOVE: Ticket and poster for Pink Floyd's Earls Court, London, concert.



ABOVE: Single for "Wish You Were Here" released in 1995.



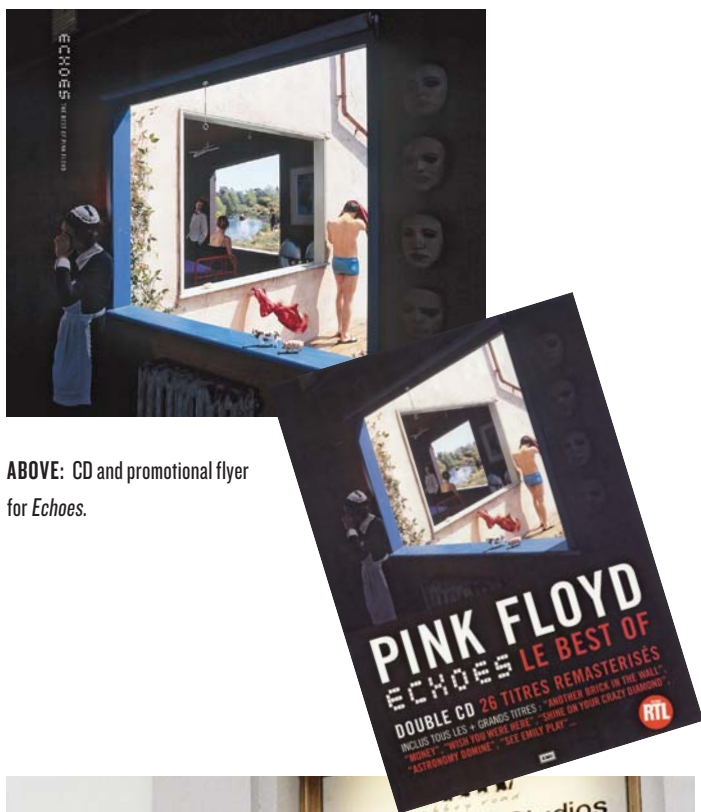
ABOVE: *Pulse* press folder, DVD, and CD released in 1995.

CHAPTER 11

Not Just Another Brick

RIGHT: Roger Waters performing at the Glastonbury Festival on June 28, 2002.





ABOVE: CD and promotional flyer for *Echoes*.

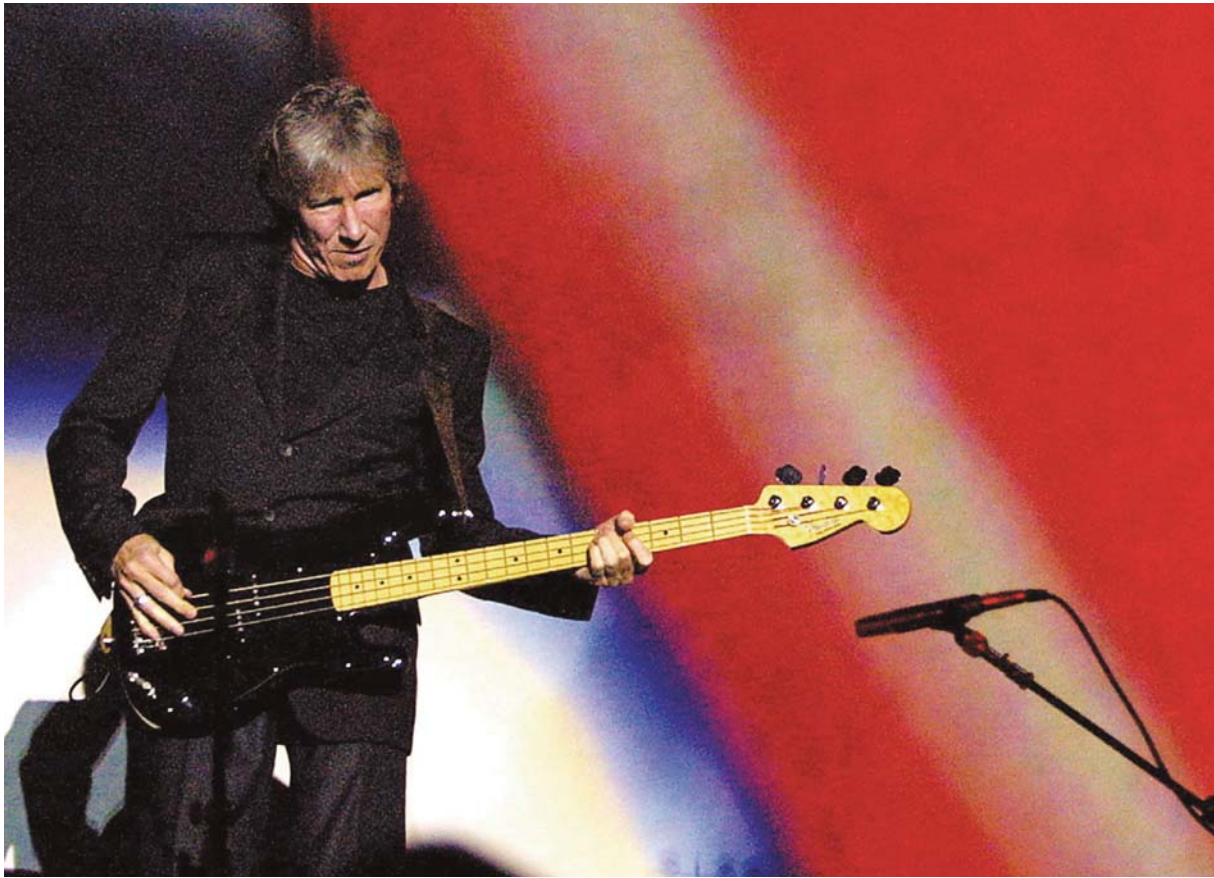


The last sighting of Pink Floyd in the 20th century came in January 1996, when Gilmour, Mason, and Wright attended New York’s Waldorf Hotel for the band’s induction into the Rock and Roll Hall of Fame. (Waters and Syd Barrett had also been sent invitations but declined to attend.) They were inducted by Billy Corgan of the Smashing Pumpkins, who vividly recalled the impact of hearing *Dark Side of the Moon* as a teenager before joining Gilmour and Wright for an impromptu version of “Wish You Were Here.”

After that, Pink Floyd quietly and deliberately slipped below the radar. The response from management to enquiries about recording or touring was that there were “no plans at present.” Instead it was Roger Waters who emerged with an American tour in the summer of 1999, having remained out of the spotlight since the release of his *Amused to Death* album in 1992. “I’ve sensed a turning of the tide in recent years in terms of the public’s awareness of who I am and what my contribution to Pink Floyd was,” he said at the time. With no new album to promote, Waters devised a show that would provide an overview of his career. “I listened to everything I’d done in the last 30 years. I wrote a list—a very long list—and then I slowly whittled it down until it was about two and a half hours long.” While the show included most of *Dark Side of the Moon* and *Wish You Were Here*, and chunks of *The Wall*, Waters reclaimed several songs that his former band had ignored like “Welcome to the Machine” and “Dogs” while also collating songs from his solo albums into one segment.

“I’VE SENSED A TURNING OF THE TIDE IN RECENT YEARS IN TERMS OF THE PUBLIC’S AWARENESS OF WHO I AM AND WHAT MY CONTRIBUTION TO PINK FLOYD WAS...” —ROGER WATERS

LEFT: Roger Waters sitting outside Abbey Road Studios in London circa 2001.



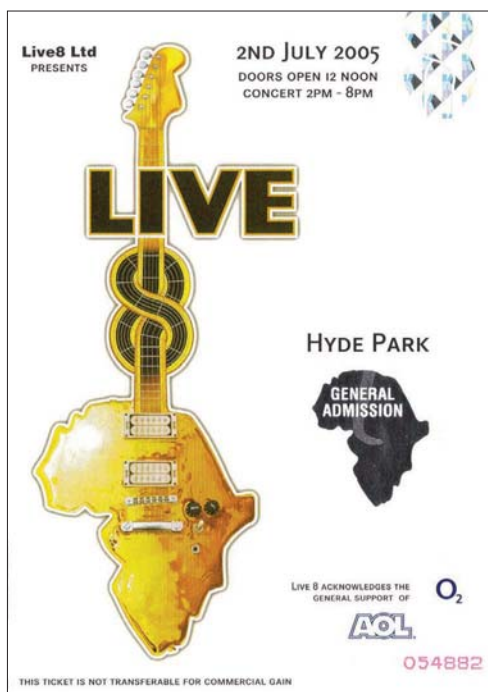
LEFT: Roger Waters performing in Caracas, Venezuela, during the Festival Pop concert on March 17, 2002.

By starting with “In the Flesh,” “The Thin Ice,” “Another Brick in the Wall,” and “Mother,” Waters put the emphasis on *The Wall*. Amid the quadrophonic sound, big-screen projections of Gerald Scarfe’s animations, and the flying pigs, he continually stressed the message of the songs. The success of the tour—24 shows in little over a month—led Waters to repeat the exercise the following summer for a series of shows at which he refined the set list by delving back to “Set the Controls for the Heart of the Sun,” from *A Saucerful of Secrets*, and adding a new closing song, “Each Small Candle,” which he had recently written in response to the wars that were tearing Yugoslavia to pieces. The concert at Seattle’s Rose Garden Arena was filmed and recorded for release on DVD and CD.

While Waters took a break in 2001, Gilmour returned with a couple of solo shows in London and Paris. He played several Pink Floyd favorites, with Wright joining the band for “Fat Old Sun” from *Atom Heart Mother* as well as a rare gem, “Terrapin,” from Syd Barrett’s abortive solo career. There was also a new song, “Smile,” and a version of Bizet’s “Je Crois Entendre Encore,” from his opera *The Pearl Fishers*.

The shows were also a signal that Gilmour was laying Pink Floyd to rest. “I don’t like to say that I’ll never do something again, but I suspect that I’ve done that,” he said. “One never knows if one’s poor tired old ego might creep up on you and persuade you to give it another go. I mean, I’m at liberty to play with Nick and Rick any time. But the weight of the whole Pink Floyd thing is something that I don’t feel like lifting these days. I wouldn’t feel happy doing it without a new record, so you’re talking about two years at least. I just think that I’ve grown out of it. Finally. Probably.”

Waters resumed his In the Flesh Tour in 2003, after a year’s break, playing South Africa, South America, Japan, South Korea, Australia, Thailand, India, and the United Arab Emirates in March and April before hitting Europe in May and June. In London he was formally reunited with Mason, who joined the band for “Set the Controls for the Heart of the Sun.” The tour ended with a show at the Glastonbury Festival in Somerset, which had started as a small hippie gathering in the late 1960s but had since grown into the biggest annual festival of the year in Britain, with a predominantly young audience.



ABOVE: Ticket for Live 8 on July 2, 2005.

In interviews, Waters said he had been tempted by offers to stage *The Wall* again. “I had all kinds of stupid grandiose plans for building a wall across the Grand Canyon. Then I thought, somebody has to pay for this. I mean, the Berlin show had cost \$6 million, and we only got that back through the video and album. When I looked into it they were actually thinking about the Indianapolis Race Track, and while they talked about crowd control and things it was really going to be an exercise in selling Coca-Cola or whatever. Actually, doing *The Wall* again would be very difficult”—but perhaps not quite as difficult as he first thought.

The next two years were quiet. Gilmour was awarded a CBE (Commander of the British Empire) in the Queen’s 2003 birthday honors list, and he joined in the Strat Pack concert in September 2004 to mark the 50th anniversary of his favorite guitar, the Fender Stratocaster. Meanwhile, Waters released two songs via the internet in 2004, one of which was “Leaving Beirut,” which he’d written about his travels in the Middle East as a teenager. He also took part in the hastily prepared benefit concert for the survivors of the Indian Ocean tsunami, offering a filmed performance of “Wish You Were Here” with Eric Clapton.

And so the announcement on June 12, 2005, that Waters, Gilmour, Wright, and Mason would be appearing together as Pink

Floyd at the forthcoming Live 8 concert in London’s Hyde Park came as a total surprise. Organized by Bob Geldof, Live 8 marked the 20th anniversary of Live Aid, with the aim of raising awareness for the Make Poverty History campaign, and it was timed to coincide with the G8 summit in Scotland. “Like most people I want to do everything I can to persuade the G8 leaders to make huge commitments to the relief of poverty and increased aid to the third world,” Gilmour said at the time. “Any squabbles Roger and the band have had in the past are so petty in this context, and if reforming for this concert will help focus attention then it’s got to be worthwhile.”

Waters explained the sequence of events. “I think Bob ran into Nick at a party and said, ‘Why don’t you talk to Roger?’ And Nick said, ‘Why don’t you talk to him?’ So we spoke on the telephone, and he asked me if I’d make the call, and I said, ‘Yeah, well, why not?’ So I did, and David was a bit surprised when the phone rang and it was me. We chatted for a few minutes, and he said, ‘I’ll have a think about it.’ And he called me back about 24 hours later and said, ‘All right. I’ll do it.’”

The band spent three days preparing for their 25-minute spot, which was now set to close the show. While the atmosphere was committed and congenial, both Waters and Gilmour had to make adjustments in their style. Each of them had made their own subtle adjustments to classic Pink Floyd songs over the previous 20 years; now they had to present the material as it had originally been performed. They recruited backing musicians—guitarist Tim Renwick, keyboard player Jon Carin, and saxophonist Dick Parry—to ensure that the audience would hear exactly what they expected to hear. There was also some dispute as to what songs to play; “Another Brick in the Wall Part 2” was eventually dropped because the underlying message was thought to be “too negative.”

At the climax of the day-long Live 8 show on July 5, the reunited Pink Floyd walked out onto a darkened stage in Hyde Park to the accompaniment of a thudding heartbeat that became the introduction for “Speak to Me”/“Breathe.” They were a model of utterly focused attention, meticulously reproducing the sound of a song that was already embedded in the consciousness of the audience and millions of television viewers around the world. Waters was visibly affected by the significance of the occasion. After “Money,” which gave the band the chance to loosen up a little, he addressed the crowd while Gilmour tinkered with the



LEFT: Rick Wright performing at the Live 8 show in 2005.



ABOVE: David Gilmour and Roger Waters performing together for the first time in over 20 years at the Live 8 show.



RIGHT: Nick Mason performing at the Live 8 show in 2005.



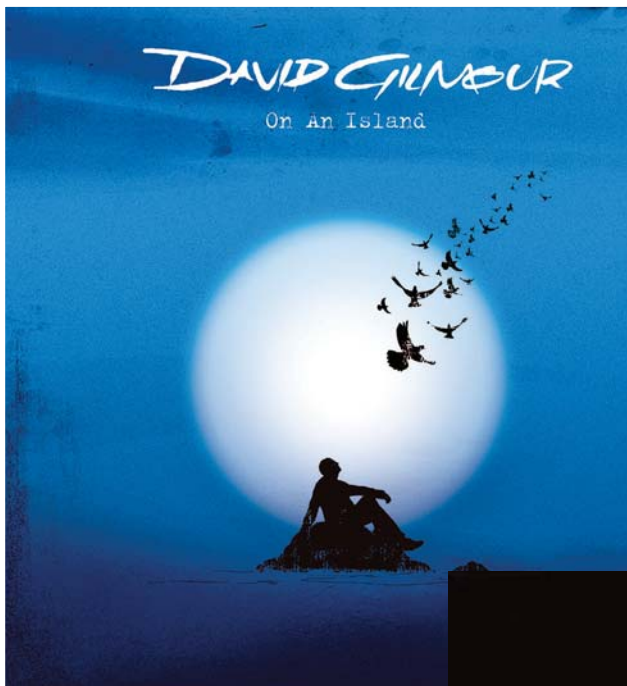
ABOVE: David Gilmour performing at the Live 8 show.

opening chords of “Wish You Were Here.” “It’s actually quite emotional standing up here with these three guys after all these years, standing to be counted with the rest of you,” he said. “Anyway, we’re doing this for everyone who’s not here, but particularly of course for Syd.”

After a version of “Wish You Were Here” that perfectly captured the nuances between the three acoustic guitars, Waters and Gilmour donned their electric instruments once more, and with a muttered “here we go” from Waters they plunged into “Comfortably Numb” while the screen behind them showed a wall inscribed with the words “Make Poverty History.” At the end Gilmour thanked the audience and turned to leave before Waters beckoned him back for a group hug that would become the most frequently used image in the following day’s newspapers—a symbol of the whole event.

“...I THINK I CAN CATEGORICALLY SAY THAT THERE WON’T BE A TOUR OR AN ALBUM AGAIN THAT I TAKE PART IN...IT’S JUST, I’VE BEEN THERE, I’VE DONE IT.” —DAVID GILMOUR

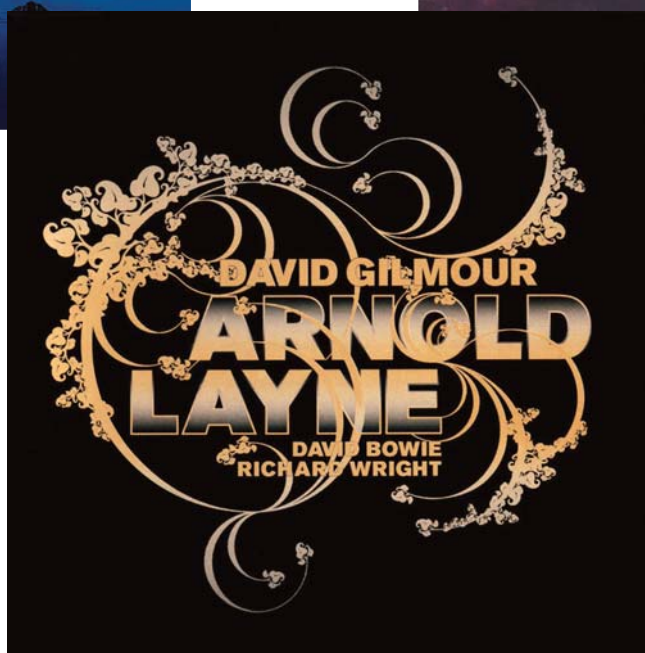
It was one of the shortest but most intense performances Pink Floyd had ever given—and, inevitably, it raised speculation about whether the reunited band might tour together again. Offers of £150 million were reportedly made; Waters, carried along by the emotion of the occasion, initially failed to quell the prospect of more shows. For Gilmour, however, the circumstances of the one-off reunion proved that things should remain that way—as a one-off. “The rehearsals convinced me that it wasn’t something I wanted to be doing a lot of,” he told the Associated Press. “There have been all sorts of farewell moments in people’s lives and careers which they have then rescinded, but I think I can categorically say that there won’t be a tour or an album again that I take part in. It isn’t to do with animosity or anything like that. It’s just . . . I’ve been there, I’ve done it.”



ABOVE: David Gilmour's *On an Island*.



ABOVE: Roger Waters' *Dark Side* tour program.



RIGHT: David Gilmour's "Arnold Layne" single featuring David Bowie and Richard Wright.

A year later, Gilmour and Waters were back on their separate career paths. Gilmour released his third solo album, *On an Island*, comprising ten new songs, several of which included lyrics cowritten by his wife, Polly Samson. The album featured Wright on Hammond organ, and orchestral arrangements by noted Polish composer Zbigniew Preisner, with David Crosby and Graham Nash providing backing vocals on the title track.

The album topped the U.K. charts and reached No. 6 in the U.S., providing Gilmour with his first Top 10 solo album there. He toured the U.S. between March and May, and Europe in July and August with a band that featured Wright and several

other former Pink Floyd collaborators, among them Guy Pratt, Jon Carin, and Dick Parry. At the London concert at the Royal Albert Hall, Crosby and Nash sang backup vocals on several songs, while David Bowie made a guest appearance at the end to sing "Arnold Layne" and "Comfortably Numb." The last date on the tour took place at the Gdańsk Shipyard in Poland, which was where the Solidarity Movement had been formed in the early '80s, precipitating the downfall of the Eastern European communist states. The performance was recorded and filmed for a live CD and DVD.

Meanwhile, Waters returned with his own band for a *Dark*



ABOVE: Roger Waters performs live onstage at the Acer Arena in Sydney, Australia, on January 25, 2007.

Side of the Moon live tour featuring the whole of the album in the second half of the show—just as Pink Floyd had done during their final tour in 1994. The open-air shows featured elaborate staging by lighting designer Marcus Brickman, including lasers, flamethrowers, psychedelic projections, fog machines, and floating puppets. The tour started in Europe in June before moving to North America in the fall and continuing the following year with live engagements in South America, Australia, and Asia. He then returned to North America and Europe in 2008, bringing the total number of shows to 110.

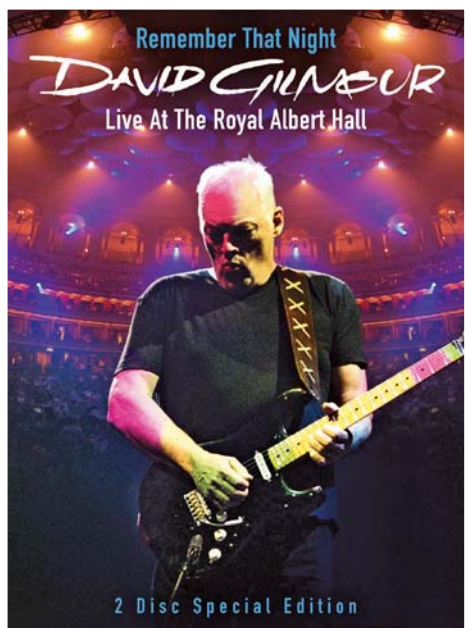


ABOVE: Pink Floyd's *Oh, by the Way* CD.





LEFT: Passers-by on Primrose Hill in London watch as Sky Arts pays tribute to Pink Floyd's *Dark Side of the Moon* album cover on October 21, 2009.



ABOVE: *Remember That Night*, a two-disc DVD special edition of David Gilmour performing live at the Royal Albert Hall.

The death of Syd Barrett in July 2006 briefly stopped his former colleagues in their tracks. Barrett had been in the hospital with complications arising from diabetes and died a week after returning home following a short battle with pancreatic cancer. None of the other members of Pink Floyd attended his cremation, and they said nothing about his death beyond an official statement of regret and sadness. There was some criticism of this in the media, but in truth they had already expressed themselves fully as his specter hung over *Dark Side of the Moon*, *Wish You Were Here*, and *The Wall*. “I lost Syd 30 years ago,” a deeply affected Gilmour told a friend.

The prospect of the post-Barrett line-up reuniting once again ended with the death of Richard Wright, who had also been battling cancer, on September 15, 2008.



ABOVE: Richard Wright performing at the Live 8 show on July 2, 2005. Wright passed away on September 15, 2008, after battling cancer.

A year earlier, Wright had appeared with the other members of the band at a tribute to Barrett in London, although they did not perform together. Wright’s final public appearance had taken place a year earlier when he performed with Gilmour at the premiere of *Remember That Night*, the film of Gilmour’s concerts at the Royal Albert Hall the previous May.

In April 2010, Waters announced that he was taking *The Wall* on a world tour, starting in North America in September. He explained that the idea for the show had arisen during his *Dark Side of the Moon* tour. “I had been kind of reluctant to take that whole piece and redo it,” he said. “But it really worked well. So when I’d recovered from that, I thought maybe I had one more in me. Laurie, my fiancée, said that maybe I should do *The Wall*. I said I couldn’t, but it wouldn’t go away.”



ABOVE: Roger Waters sings during a performance at Hong Kong's Convention and Exhibition Centre on February 15, 2007. An image of Syd Barrett is projected on the screen behind him as he plays. Syd died on July 7, 2006, in Cambridge, UK.

Back in 1980, *The Wall* had never been considered a viable touring proposition due to the complexity of the production. Improvements in technology had changed that perception, although as stage designer Mark Fisher points out, “It’s the same bloody wall. Identical. The engineering behind the building of the wall—the platforms that the men go up and down on to build the wall, the stabilizing masts that go up inside the wall to stop it falling over and the cardboard bricks themselves—are exactly what I designed back in 1980.” The only difference lay in how it was all controlled. “In 1980, there were no computer control systems. So I sat behind the stage with a bank of switches and moved things up and down. Now we have a computer that does the same thing, and a man that watches the computer.” As far as Fisher was concerned, it was only the cost that prevented a full-

scale tour of *The Wall* in the 1980s. “It wasn’t that the show was really expensive—it was that tickets were really cheap. In 1980 the top ticket price in London was £8. Now people are paying £80 and more. Even allowing for inflation of around 300 percent, that changes the economics of putting a touring show together.”

If the basic technology of building *The Wall* had not changed, other elements of the show were radically transformed. If you wanted a moving light in 1980, you had to use an elaborate pulley system, or put a guy with a spotlight on top of a cherry picker. Today, it’s possible to fit 24 automated Vari-Lites around the rim of a circular screen. But the biggest advances were in video and animation projection. In 1980 three 35mm projectors struggled to project Gerald Scarfe’s inimitable animations onto the wall in focus and without too much overlap. In 2010 Fisher had 15



ABOVE and RIGHT: Roger Waters performs *The Wall* in its entirety at the Wells Fargo Center in Philadelphia on November 8, 2010. In the above picture, the children next to him are wearing t-shirts that say “Fear Builds Walls.”

high-definition projectors pointed at the wall and mapped to a digital grid capable of adding each brick to the projection space as soon as it was positioned on the wall. All of this required considerable choreography, meaning the overall mood was a far cry from some of the shows in 1980, which Fisher would describe as “a mad race between the drug-crazed road crew and the band to see who could get to the intermission first.”

The projectors had to be precisely focused on the wall before every show, which meant that the road crew would have to build the wall almost as soon as they completed the load-in and then take it down again to allow the band to soundcheck. “There’s a lot of tight scheduling, so that everyone can do the things they need to do at the right time,” said video content director Sean Evans, an American who listened to *The Wall* so much while growing up that he already knew the album “inside and out.”

Early on in proceedings, Waters told Evans that he didn’t “just want to do this as it was. I have no interest in not making

this political. We have to modernize it, and we have to bring a message.” According to Waters, the show was no longer simply the story of one frightened man hiding behind a wall, but a more expansive look at the way nations and ideologies are divided from each other. “We are controlled by the powers that be, who tell us that we need to guard against the evil ones who are over there and different from us and who we must be frightened of,” he explained.

Part of the message included broadening out the references to World War II to take in other wars and acts of violence that have occurred in the years since. “Roger put a notice on his website asking for people to send in pictures and details of family members, civilian or military, killed in wars or terrorist acts,” Evans recalled. “He wanted to include them on ‘The Thin Ice’ but he didn’t know how, so we just waited to see what showed up. We worked on it for months, and the first time I saw it with an audience even I welled up. It’s very intense.”



Getting Scarfe's original animations to hold up against the new graphics was another time-consuming task. "His stuff is legendary, you can't mess with it," Evans said. "Fortunately, Roger had the original film, so we were able to restore it from the best possible source, but it still took a lot of work to make it look good against the other stuff we were doing. Some of it, like the flower sequence, was actually made for the circular screen, so we extended the stems across the wall so that it looked as if the flowers were coming from somewhere." The projectors at Evans's disposal could also create black holes in the wall and make the whole edifice sway and buckle alarmingly. In fact, there were moments in the show where you wondered whether the animated trickery might upstage the climax to the show, when the wall comes crashing down.

"We've paced the effects so it all builds up to that point," Evans said. "It's very intentional. And we thought about whether to add any effects to the wall as it falls. But actually, it looks pretty spectacular from wherever you are in the arena, with all the smoke billowing out and stuff. But if you're in the first five rows it feels like it's gonna hit you. I've been in the pit a couple of times with a camera and gotten brained a couple of times. Those things are heavier than they look."

The Wall opened in Toronto on September 15, 2010, and continued across North America before reaching Mexico City on December 21. The tour grossed more than the one by Lady Gaga that took place at the same time and was second only to Bon Jovi's stadium tour in terms of revenue—a remarkable achievement for a show that was as much about the message as entertainment. More significantly, the tour established that *The Wall* was Waters's creation, as originally played by Pink Floyd—a subtle distinction that was not widely understood in 1980.

The Wall moved to Europe in March 2011, with the tour continuing until August. By now, the show had developed a tight choreography, but Waters kept the production crew alert by continually revising various elements of it. He had also developed a crowd-friendly demeanor, smiling and making eye contact with the fans down the front. It was a far cry from the remote, uncommunicative figure he had cut for so long—not least during the original performances of *The Wall*.

"I'm completely different, and feel completely different, about being on stage now than I did then," he has since admitted. "In the last 30 years I've come round to embracing the possibilities of that connection with the audience. Now I milk it mercilessly,

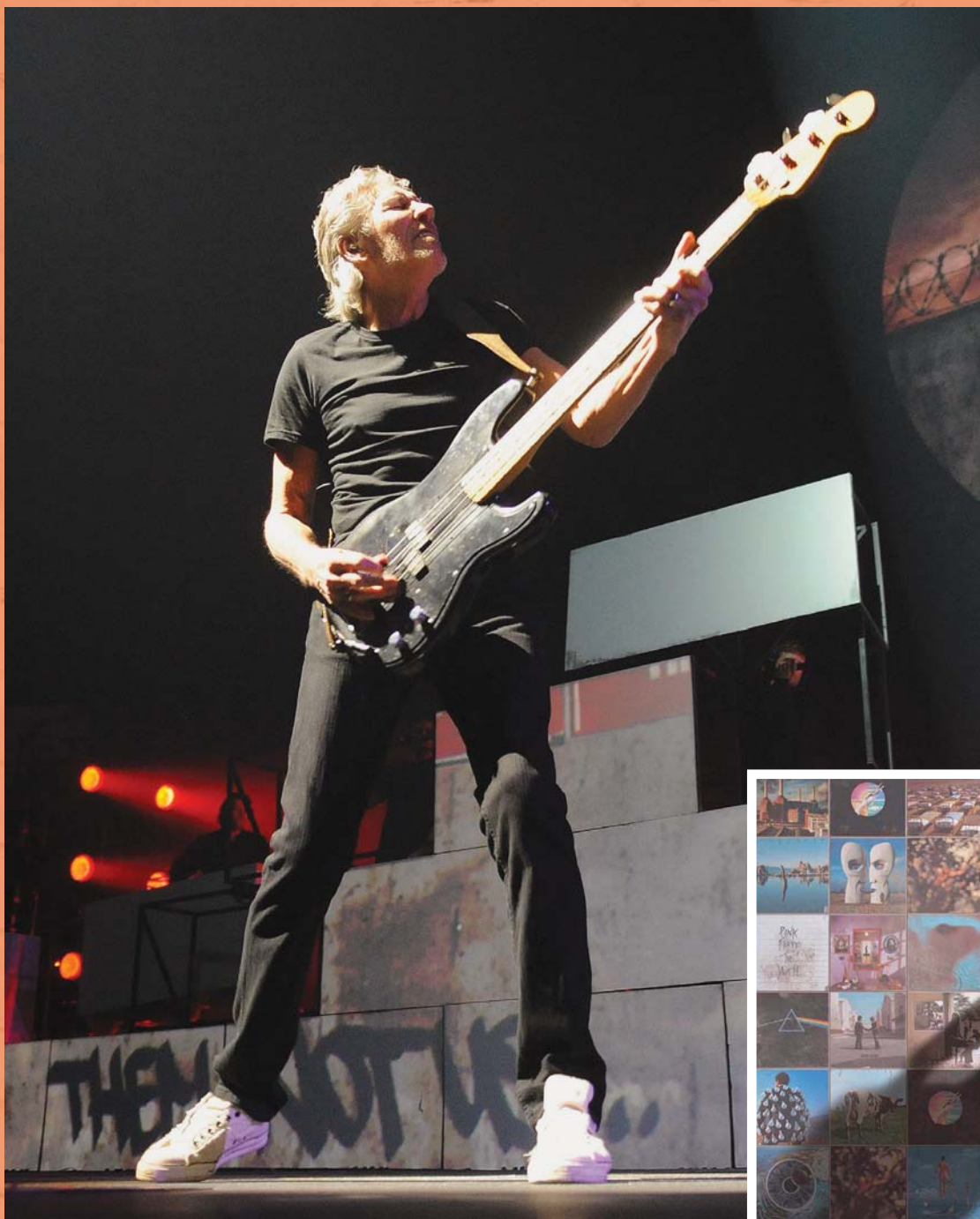
because it's fun and it feels good, whereas back then I was so fearful that when I was on stage I was the same as I was at a party; standing in a corner, not looking at anybody, smoking cigarettes and more or less saying, 'Don't come anywhere near me.' Thank goodness I've grown up a bit since then."

When *The Wall* reached London in April 2011, Waters was reunited with Gilmour, who briefly reprised his original role of playing and singing "Comfortably Numb" at the top of the wall. After the wall came tumbling down, Gilmour and Mason clambered across the rubble to join a visibly moved Waters. "Thirty years ago, when David and Nick and I first did this, I was a rather grumpy person, disaffected with rock'n'roll audiences, as young David will attest," Waters announced, to which Gilmour smiled and nodded. "But all that's changed—I could not be happier than to be in this room with these two guys and all of you here tonight." Gilmour and Mason then joined the rest of the band for the encore of "Outside the Wall" on mandolin and tambourine.

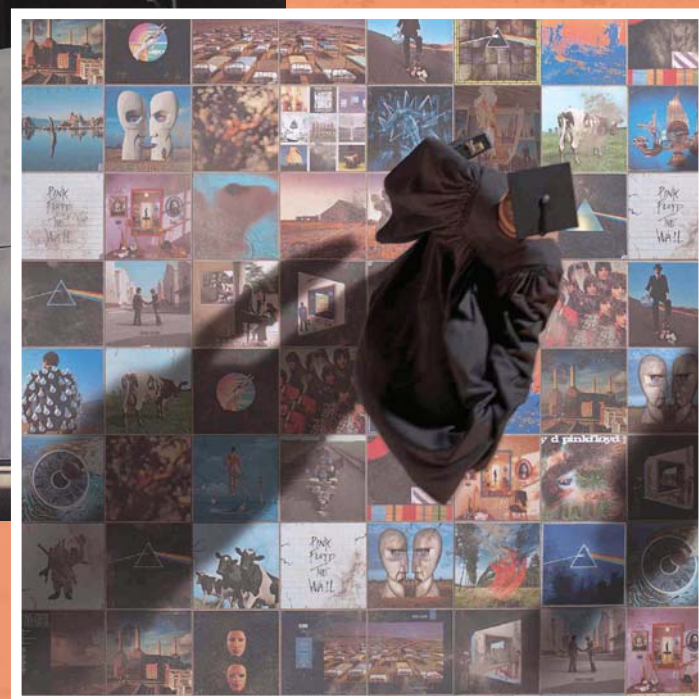
ROGER WATERS' *THE WALL* TOUR GROSSED MORE THAN THE ONE BY LADY GAGA THAT TOOK PLACE AT THE SAME TIME...

In 2012, *The Wall* toured Australia, South America, and North America, selling more than 1.4 million tickets and moving into stadiums to fulfill demand. But it wasn't just about the scale. In October, Waters made a guest appearance at the "Love for Levon" concert in tribute to the late Levon Helm, drummer with The Band. In December he hurriedly rounded up his band to appear at 12-12-12: The Concert for Sandy Relief at New York's Madison Square Garden, where he was joined on stage by Pearl Jam's Eddie Vedder for "Comfortably Numb."

The Wall was back in Europe during the summer of 2013, this time playing stadiums, and as this book went to press there were still no plans to demolish it once and for all. It could well end up becoming the enduring legacy of Pink Floyd—even more so than *Dark Side of the Moon*.



ABOVE: Roger Waters rocking out at Philips Arena on June 13, 2012 in Atlanta, Georgia.



ABOVE: *A Foot in the Door*, Pink Floyd's greatest hits CD.

LEFT: Pink Floyd's *Discovery* boxed set.







ABOVE: Roger Waters performs *The Wall* live onstage at AT&T Park in San Francisco, California, on May 11, 2012.

WHAT'S SO SPECIAL ABOUT *DARK SIDE OF THE MOON*?

Forty years on, *Dark Side of the Moon* remains far and away the most successful concept album ever made. Its worldwide sales of 34 million copies dwarf all other contenders—as well as subsequent Pink Floyd efforts like *Wish You Were Here*, *Animals*, and *The Wall*, which some might argue are better concept albums.

It's not just the sales—only Michael Jackson's *Thriller* and AC/DC's *Back in Black* have sold more copies—but also the longevity. No album has spent more weeks in the charts than *Dark Side*. It was in the *Billboard* album chart for nearly 15 years, and would probably be there now had the eligibility rules not been changed in the late 1980s. It still notches up annual global sales of over a quarter-million copies.

So what's the secret? Why is the album's appeal so broad, so timeless? The central themes of *Dark Side of the Moon* are alienation and insanity—not topics that you would necessarily choose if you were aiming for popular appeal. It's a question even the band have trouble answering. "I don't think we ever really understood," Nick Mason has since confessed. "There are elements that you would never have perceived at the time. It was partly about timing and partly about the songs being relevant to people at that time, and that gave it a lift that brought it on to the attention of another bunch of people, and so on . . ."

Certainly, the band were aware that they were on to something special when they finished the album, even though they could not have predicted just how special it would be. "I can clearly remember that moment of listening to the final mix all the way through and thinking, 'My God, we've done something absolutely fantastic here,'" David Gilmour recalled.

Roger Waters—the dominant though not yet dominating force in the band when they recorded *Dark Side*—has his own theory. "The music's quite compelling," he said, "but I think there's something more. Maybe it's the simplicity of the ideas that appeal to a generation going through puberty and trying to make sense of it all."

On its release in March 1973, *Dark Side of the Moon* seemed to capture the zeitgeist: there was a rapidly expanding market for rock music, with new generations of listeners now coming aboard, and stereo sound had just become affordable to most of them, instead of being the exclusive pleasure of hi-fi enthusiasts. *Dark Side of the Moon* was the perfect stereo album.

DARK SIDE OF THE MOON WAS IN THE *BILLBOARD* ALBUM CHART FOR NEARLY 15 YEARS...

It was also headphone heaven. You can sit back and listen to the heartbeat gradually get louder as it mingles with a disembodied Scottish voice saying, "I've been mad for fucking years," and a maniacal laugh that gets blotted out by a helicopter noise whirring from one ear to another—which in turn collides with a screaming female voice before subsiding into the slow, deliberate beat and soothing guitars of "Breathe." Just as you've relaxed into the song, however, it suddenly shifts gears, and you're carried along by a rapid hi-hat rhythm and an electronic riff while voices, footsteps, whirring noises, and bits of feedback fly by on either side of your head. Next comes a dull explosion and more running footsteps, and as they die away there's the reassuring tick of a clock that lulls you in once again before a cacophony of alarm clocks shatters your senses and leads you into the heavy, ponderous guitar chimes of "Time." And after all that, you're still only eight minutes into the album, with another 34 to go.

The sonic experience of *Dark Side of the Moon* is as vivid now as it was then. Other artists have constructed more sophisticated soundscapes, but none have had the same immediacy. And nobody plays around with stereo like they did back then.



Discography

PINK FLOYD

ALBUMS

The Piper at the Gates of Dawn

August 1967

Columbia/EMI (U.K. #6) / Tower/Capitol (U.S. #131)

Produced by Norman Smith

Astronomy Domine / Lucifer Sam / Matilda Mother / Flaming /
Pow R Toc H / Take Up Thy Stethoscope and Walk / Interstellar
Overdrive / The Gnome / Chapter 24 / The Scarecrow / Bike

A Saucerful of Secrets

June 1968

Columbia/EMI (U.K. #9) / Tower/Capitol (U.S. —)

Produced by Norman Smith

Let There Be More Light / Remember a Day / Set the Controls for
the Heart of the Sun / Corporal Clegg / A Saucerful of Secrets /
See Saw / Jugband Blues

Soundtrack from the Film More

June 1969

Columbia/EMI (U.K. #9) / Tower/Capitol (U.S. #153)

Produced by Pink Floyd

Cirrus Minor / The Nile Song / Crying Song / Up the Khyber /
Green Is the Colour / Cymbaline / Party Sequence / Main
Theme / Ibiza Bar / More Blues / Quicksilver / A Spanish Piece /
Dramatic Theme

Ummagumma

October 1969

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #5) / Harvest/Capitol (U.S. #74)

Produced by Pink Floyd and Norman Smith

Astronomy Domine / Careful with That Axe, Eugene / Set the
Controls for the Heart of the Sun / A Saucerful of Secrets //
Sysyphus / Grantchester Meadows / Several Species of Small
Furry Animals Gathered Together in a Cave and Grooving with
a Pict / The Narrow Way / The Grand Vizier's Garden Party

Atom Heart Mother

October 1970

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #1) / Harvest/Capitol (U.S. #55)

Produced by Pink Floyd

Atom Heart Mother (Father's Shout / Breast Milky / Mother
Fore / Funky Dung / Mind Your Throats Please / Remergence) /
If / Summer '68 / Fat Old Sun / Alan's Psychedelic Breakfast
(Rise And Shine / Sunny Side Up / Morning Glory)

Meddle

November 1971

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #3) Harvest/Capitol (U.S. #70)

Produced by Pink Floyd

One of These Days / A Pillow of Winds / Fearless / San Tropez /
Seamus / Echoes

Obscured by Clouds

June 1972

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #6) / Harvest/Capitol (U.S. #46)

Produced By Pink Floyd

Obscured by Clouds / When You're In / Burning Bridges /
The Gold It's in the . . . / Wot's . . . Uh The Deal / Mudmen /
Childhood's End / Free Four / Stay / Absolutely Curtains

Dark Side of the Moon

March 1973

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #2) / Harvest/Capitol (U.S. #1)

Produced by Pink Floyd

Speak to Me / Breathe / On the Run / Time / The Great Gig in
the Sky / Money / Us and Them / Any Colour You Like / Brain
Damage / Eclipse

Wish You Were Here

September 1975

Harvest (U.K. #1) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #1)

Produced by Pink Floyd

Shine on You Crazy Diamond (Parts 1–5) / Welcome to the
Machine / Have a Cigar / Wish You Were Here / Shine on You
Crazy Diamond (Parts 6–9)

Animals

January 1977

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #2) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #3)

Produced by Pink Floyd

Pigs on the Wing (Part 1) / Dogs / Pigs (Three Different Ones) /
Sheep / Pigs on the Wing (Part 2)

The Wall

November 1979

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #3) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #1)

Produced by Bob Ezrin, David Gilmour, and Roger Waters

In the Flesh? / The Thin Ice / Another Brick in the Wall Part 1 /
The Happiest Days of Our Lives / Another Brick in the Wall
Part 2 / Mother / Goodbye Blue Sky / Empty Spaces / Young Lust
/ One of My Turns / Don't Leave Me Now / Another Brick in the
Wall Part 3 / Goodbye Cruel World // Hey You / Is There Anybody
Out There? / Nobody Home / Vera / Bring the Boys Back Home /
Comfortably Numb / The Show Must Go On / In the Flesh / Run

Like Hell / Waiting for the Worms / Stop / The Trial / Outside
the Wall

The Final Cut

March 1983

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #1) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #6)

Produced by Roger Waters, James Guthrie, and Michael Kamen

The Post War Dream / Your Possible Pasts / One of the Few /
When the Tigers Broke Free (added to 2005 CD edition) / The
Hero's Return / The Gunner's Dream / Paranoid Eyes / Get Your
Filthy Hands Off My Desert / The Fletcher Memorial Home /
Southampton Dock / The Final Cut / Not Now John / Two Suns in
the Sunset

A Momentary Lapse of Reason

September 1987

EMI (U.K. #3) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #3)

Produced by Bob Ezrin and David Gilmour

Signs of Life / Leaning to Fly / The Dogs of War / One Slip / On
the Turning Away / Yet Another Movie / Round and Around / A
New Machine (Part 1) / Terminal Frost / A New Machine (Part 2) /
Sorrow

Delicate Sound of Thunder

November 1988

EMI (U.K. #11) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #11)

Produced by David Gilmour

Shine on You Crazy Diamond / Learning to Fly / Yet Another
Movie / Round and Around / Sorrow / The Dogs of War / On
the Turning Away // One of These Days / Time / Wish You Were
Here / Us and Them / Money / Another Brick in the Wall Part 2 /
Comfortably Numb / Run Like Hell

The Division Bell

March 1994

EMI (U.K. #1) / Columbia/Sony (U.S. #1)

Produced by Bob Ezrin and David Gilmour

Cluster One / What Do You Want from Me / Poles Apart /
Marooned / A Great Day for Freedom / Wearing the Inside Out /
Take it Back / Coming Back to Life / Keep Talking / Lost For
Words / High Hopes

Pulse

June 1995

EMI (U.K. #1) / Columbia/Sony (U.S. #1)

Produced by James Guthrie and David Gilmour

Shine on You Crazy Diamond / Astronomy Domine / What Do You Want from Me / Learning to Fly / Keep Talking / Coming Back to Life / Hey You / A Great Day for Freedom / Sorrow / High Hopes / Another Brick in the Wall Part 2 // Speak To Me / Breathe / On the Run / Time / The Great Gig in the Sky / Money / Us and Them / Any Colour You Like / Brain Damage / Eclipse / Wish You Were Here / Comfortably Numb / Run Like Hell

**Is There Anybody Out There—
The Wall Live 1980–81**

March 2000

EMI (U.K. #15) / Columbia/Sony (U.S. #19)

Produced by James Guthrie

MC-Atmos / In the Flesh? / The Thin Ice / Another Brick in the Wall Part 1 / The Happiest Days of Our Lives / Another Brick in the Wall Part 2 / Mother / Goodbye Blue Sky / Empty Spaces / What Shall We Do Now? / Young Lust / One of My Turns / Don't Leave Me Now / Another Brick in the Wall Part 3 / The Last Few Bricks / Goodbye Cruel World // Hey You / Is There Anybody Out There? / Nobody Home / Vera / Bring the Boys Back Home / Comfortably Numb / The Show Must Go On / MC-Atmos / In the Flesh / Run Like Hell / Waiting for the Worms / Stop / The Trial / Outside the Wall

COMPILATIONS

Relics

May 1971

Starline/EMI (U.K. #32) / Capitol (U.S. #152)

Arnold Layne / Interstellar Overdrive / See Emily Play / Remember a Day / Paintbox / Julia Dream / Careful with That Axe, Eugene / Cirrus Minor / The Nile Song / Biding My Time / Bike

A Nice Pair

January 1974

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #21) / Capitol (U.S. #36)

Astronomy Domine / Lucifer Sam / Matilda Mother / Flaming / Pow R Toc H / Take Up Thy Stethoscope and Walk / Interstellar Overdrive / The Gnome / Chapter 24 / The Scarecrow / Bike // Let There Be More Light / Remember a Day / Set the Controls for the Heart of the Sun / Corporal Clegg / A Saucerful of Secrets / See Saw / Jugband Blues

A Collection of Great Dance Songs

November 1981

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #37) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #31)

One of These Days / Money / Sheep / Shine on You Crazy Diamond Parts 1–9 / Wish You Were Here / Another Brick in the Wall Part 2

Echoes

November 2001

EMI (U.K. #2) / Capitol (U.S. #2)

Astronomy Domine / See Emily Play / The Happiest Days of our Lives / Another Brick in the Wall Part 2 / Echoes / Hey You / Marooned / The Great Gig in the Sky / Set the Controls for the Heart of the Sun / Money / Keep Talking / Sheep / Sorrow // Shine on You Crazy Diamond Parts 1–7 / Time / The Fletcher Memorial Home / Comfortably Numb / When the Tigers Broke Free / One of These Days / Us and Them / Learning to Fly / Arnold Layne / Wish You Were Here / Jugband Blues / High Hopes / Bike

A Foot in the Door

November 2011

EMI (U.K. #14) / Capitol (U.S. #50)

Hey You / See Emily Play / The Happiest Days of Our Lives / Another Brick in the Wall Part 2 / Have a Cigar / Wish You Were Here / Time / The Great Gig in the Sky / Money / Comfortably Numb / High Hopes / Learning to Fly / The Fletcher Memorial Home / Shine on You Crazy Diamond Part 1–5 / Brain Damage / Eclipse

SINGLES

Arnold Layne / Candy and a Current Bun

March 1967
Columbia/EMI (U.K. #2) / Tower/Capitol (U.S. —)
Produced by Joe Boyd

See Emily Play / Scarecrow

June 1967
Columbia/EMI (U.K. #6) Tower/Capitol (U.S. #134)
Produced by Norman Smith

Apples and Oranges / Paintbox

November 1967
Columbia/EMI (U.K. —)
Produced by Norman Smith

Flaming / The Gnome

November 1967
Tower/Capitol (U.S. —)
Produced by Norman Smith

It Would Be So Nice / Julia Dream

April 1968
Columbia/EMI (U.K. —)
Produced by Norman Smith

Let There Be More Light / Remember a Day

August 1968
Tower/Capitol (U.S. —)
Produced by Norman Smith

Point Me at the Sky / Careful with That Axe, Eugene

December 1968
Columbia/EMI (U.K. —) / Capitol (U.S. —)
Produced by Norman Smith

The Nile Song / Ibiza Bar

July 1969
Harvest/Capitol (U.S. —)
Produced by Pink Floyd

Summer '68 / Julia Dream

October 1970
Tower/Capitol (U.S. —)
Produced by Pink Floyd and Norman Smith

One of These Days / Fearless

November 1971
Harvest/Capitol (U.S. —)
Produced by Pink Floyd

Free Four / Stay

July 1972
Harvest/Capitol (U.S. —)
Produced by Pink Floyd

Money / Any Colour You Like

May 1973
Harvest/Capitol (U.S. #13)
Produced by Pink Floyd

Time / Us and Them

February 1974
Harvest/Capitol (U.S. #101)
Produced by Pink Floyd

Have a Cigar / Welcome to the Machine

November 1975
Harvest/Capitol (U.S. —)
Produced by Pink Floyd

Another Brick in the Wall Part 2 / One of My Turns

November 1979
Harvest/EMI (U.K. #1) Columbia/CBS (U.S. #1)
Produced by Bob Ezrin, David Gilmour, and Roger Waters

Run Like Hell / Don't Leave Me Now

April 1980
Columbia/CBS (U.S. #53)
Produced by Bob Ezrin, David Gilmour, and Roger Waters

When the Tigers Broke Free / Bring the Boys Back Home

July 1982

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #37) Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by Roger Waters, James Guthrie, and Michael Kamen

Not Now John / The Hero’s Return

April 1983

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #30) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by Roger Waters, James Guthrie, and Michael Kamen

Learning to Fly / One Slip

October 1987

EMI (U.K. —) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #70)

Produced by Bob Ezrin and David Gilmour

On the Turning Away / Run Like Hell (live)

December 1987

EMI (U.K. #55) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by Bob Ezrin and David Gilmour

One Slip / Terminal Frost

June 1988

EMI (U.K. #50) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by Bob Ezrin and David Gilmour

Take It Back / Astronomy Domine (live)

May 1994

EMI (U.K. #23) / Columbia/Sony (U.S. #73)

Produced by Bob Ezrin and David Gilmour

High Hopes / Keep Talking

October 1994

EMI (U.K. —) / Columbia/Sony (U.S. —)

Produced by Bob Ezrin and David Gilmour

VIDEOS AND DVDS

Live at Pompeii

September 1972

Universal Home Video (U.K.)

Directed by Adrian Maben

Echoes (part 1) / Careful with That Axe, Eugene / A Saucerful of Secrets / One of These Days / Set the Controls for the Heart of the Sun / Mademoiselle Nobs / Echoes (part 2)

The Wall

August 1982

Sony Music Video (U.K./U.S.)

Directed by Alan Parker

Delicate Sound of Thunder

June 1989

PMI (U.K.) / MVE/CBS (U.S.)

Shine on You Crazy Diamond / Signs of Life / Learning to Fly / Sorrow / The Dogs of War / On the Turning Away / One of These Days / Time / On the Run / The Great Gig in the Sky / Wish You Were Here / Us and Them / Comfortably Numb / One Slip / Run Like Hell

Pulse—Earls Court, London, 10-20-94

June 1995

PMI (U.K.) / SMV (U.S.)

Shine on You Crazy Diamond / Learning to Fly / High Hopes / Take it Back / Coming Back to Life / Sorrow Keep Talking / Another Brick in the Wall Part 2 / One of These Days / Dark Side of the Moon / Wish You Were Here / Comfortably Numb / Run Like Hell

SYD BARRETT

ALBUMS

The Madcap Laughs

January 1970

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #4)

Produced by Malcolm Jones, Syd Barrett, David Gilmour, Roger Waters, and Peter Jenner

Terrapin / No Good Trying / Love You / No Man's Land / Dark Globe / Here I Go / Octopus / Golden Hair / Long Gone / She Took a Long Cold Look / Feel / If It's in You / Late Night

Barrett

November 1970

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —)

Produced by David Gilmour

Baby Lemonade / Love Song / Dominoes / It Is Obvious / Rats / Maisie / Gigolo Aunt / Waving My Arms in the Air / I Never Lied to You / Wined and Dined / Wolfpack / Effervescing Elephant

COMPILATIONS

Syd Barrett

November 1974

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —) / Harvest/Capitol (U.S. #163)

Double album repackaging of *The Madcap Laughs* and *Barrett*

The Peel Sessions

February 1988

Strange Fruit (U.K. —)

Recorded at the BBC, February 1970

Terrapin / Gigolo Aunt / Baby Lemonade / Effervescing Elephant / Two of a Kind

Opel

October 1988

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —)

Produced by Malcolm Jones, Syd Barrett, David Gilmour,

Roger Waters, and Peter Jenner

Opel / Clowns and Jugglers / Rats (alt. take) / Golden Hair (alt. take) / Dolly Rocker / Word Song / Wined and Dined (alt. take) / Swan Lee / Birdie Hop / Let's Split / Lanky (Part One) / Wouldn't You Miss Me (Dark Globe) / Milky Way / Golden Hair (alt. take)

Crazy Diamond: The Complete Syd Barrett

April 1993

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —)

Three CD boxed set containing *The Madcap Laughs*, *Barrett*, and *Opel*, each with additional outtakes and alternate versions

The Best of Syd Barrett: Wouldn't You Miss Me

April 2001

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —) / Capitol (U.S. —)

Includes one previously unreleased track, Bob Dylan Blues

The Radio One Sessions

March 2004

Strange Fruit (U.K. —)

Recorded at the BBC in February 1970 and February 1971

Terrapin / Gigolo Aunt / Baby Lemonade / Effervescing Elephant / Two of a Kind / Baby Lemonade / Dominoes / Love Song

An Introduction to Syd Barrett

October 2010

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #104) / Capitol (U.S. —)

Compilation of Pink Floyd and solo material plus one previously unreleased track, Rhamadan

SINGLES

Octopus / Golden Hair

November 1969

U.K. Harvest/EMI

Produced by Syd Barrett and David Gilmour

DAVID GILMOUR

ALBUMS

David Gilmour

May 1978

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #17) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #20)

Produced by David Gilmour

Mihalis / There's No Way out of Here / Cry from the Street /
So Far Away / Short and Sweet / Raise My Rent / It's Deafinitely /
I Can't Breathe Anymore

About Face

March 1984

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #21) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #32)

Produced by Bob Ezrin and David Gilmour

Until We Sleep / Murder / Love on the Air / Blue Light / Out of
the Blue / All Lovers Are Deranged / You Know I'm Right /
Cruise / Let's Get Metaphysical / Near the End

On an Island

March 2006

EMI (U.K. #1) / Columbia/Sony (U.S. #6)

Produced by David Gilmour, Phil Manzanera, and Chris Thomas

Castellorizon / On an Island / The Blue / Take a Breath / Red
Sky at Night / This Heaven / Then I Close My Eyes / Smile /
A Pocketful of Stones / Where We Start

Live in Gdansk

September 2008

EMI (U.K. #10) / Columbia/Sony (U.S. #26)

Produced by David Gilmour and Phil Manzanera

Speak to Me / Breathe / Time / Breathe (Reprise) / Castellorizon /
On an Island / The Blue / Red Sky at Night / This Heaven / Then I
Close My Eyes / Smile / Take a Breath / A Pocketful of Stones /
Where We Start // Shine on You Crazy Diamond / Astronomy
Domine / Fat Old Sun / High Hopes / Echoes / Wish You Were
Here / A Great Day for Freedom / Comfortably Numb

Metallic Sphere (The Orb Featuring David Gilmour)

October 2010

Columbia/Sony (U.K. #12)

Produced by Martin 'Youth' Glover

Metallic Spheres / Hymns to the Sun / Black Graham / Hiding in
Plain View / Classified // Es Vedra / Hymns to the Sun (Reprise) /
Olympic / Chicago Dub / Bold Knife Trophy

SINGLES

There's No Way out of Here / It's Deafinitely

August 1978

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by David Gilmour

Blue Light / Cruise

February 1984

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #62)

Produced by Bob Ezrin and David Gilmour

Love on the Air / Let's Get Metaphysical

April 1984

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —)

Produced by Bob Ezrin and David Gilmour

All Lovers Are Deranged / Murder

April 1984

Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by Bob Ezrin and David Gilmour

On an Island / On an Island (edit)

February 2006

EMI (U.K. —) / Columbia/Sony (U.S. —)

Produced by David Gilmour, Phil Manzanera, and Chris Thomas

Smile / Island Jam

June 2006

EMI (U.K. —) / Columbia/Sony (U.S. —)

Produced by David Gilmour, Phil Manzanera, and Chris Thomas

NICK MASON

ALBUMS

Nick Mason's Fictitious Sports

May 1981

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —) / Columbia/Sony (U.S. —)

Produced by Nick Mason and Carla Bley

Can't Get My Motor to Start / I Was Wrong / Siam / Hot River /

Boo to You Too / Do Ya? / Wervin' / I'm a Mineralist

Profiles (Mason & Fenn)

August 1985

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by Rick Fenn and Nick Mason

Malta / Lie for a Lie / Rhoda / Profiles (Parts 1 & 2) / Israel / And the Address / Mumbo Jumbo / Zip Code / Black Ice / At the End of the Day / Profiles (Part 3)

SINGLES

Lie for a Lie / And the Address (Mason & Fenn)

September 1985

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —)

Produced by Rick Fenn and Nick Mason

ROGER WATERS

ALBUMS

Music from the Body (Ron Geesin & Roger Waters)

November 1970

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —)

Produced by Ron Geesin and Roger Waters

Our Song / Sea Shell and Stone / Red Stuff Writhe / A Gentle Breeze Blew Through Life / Lick Your Partners / Bridge Passage for Three Plastic Teeth / Chain of Life / The Womb Bit / Embryo

Thought / March Past of the Embryos / More Than Seven Dwarfs in Penis-Land / Dance of the Red Corpuscles / Body Transport / Hand Dance—Full Evening Dress / Breathe / Old Folks Ascension / Bedtime-Dream-Clime / Piddle in Perspex / Embryonic Womb Walk / Mrs. Throat Goes Walking / Sea Shell and Soft Stone / Give Birth to a Smile

The Pros and Cons of Hitch Hiking

April 1984

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #13) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #31)

Produced by Roger Waters and Michael Kamen

4:30AM (Apparently They Were Travelling Abroad) / 4:33AM (Running Shoes) / 4:37AM (Arabs with Knives and West German Spies) / 4:39AM (For the First Time Today Part 2) / 4:41AM (Sexual Revolution) / 4:47AM (The Remains of Our Love) / 4:50AM (Go Fishing) / 4:56AM (For the First Time Today Part 1) / 4:58AM (Dunroamin / Duncarin / Dunlavin) / 5:01AM (The Pros and Cons of Hitch Hiking Part 10) / 5:06AM (Every Stranger's Eyes) / 5:11AM (The Moment of Clarity)

Radio K.A.O.S.

June 1987

EMI (U.K. #25) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. #50)

Produced by Roger Waters, Nick Griffiths, and Ian Richie

Radio Waves / Who Needs Information / Me or Him / The Powers that Be / Sunset Strip / Home / Four Minutes / The Tide is Turning (After Live Aid)

The Wall—Live In Berlin

September 1990

Mercury/Phonogram (U.K. #27 / U.S. #56)

Produced by Roger Waters and Nick Griffiths

In the Flesh (featuring the Scorpions) / The Thin Ice (featuring Ute Lemper) / Another Brick in the Wall Part 1 / The Happiest Days of Our Lives / Another Brick in the Wall Part 2 (featuring Cyndi Lauper) / Mother (featuring Sinéad O'Connor and The Band) / Goodbye Blue Sky (featuring Joni Mitchell and James Galway) / Empty Spaces / What Shall We Do Now? (featuring Bryan Adams) / Young Lust (featuring Bryan Adams) / One of My Turns / Don't Leave Me Now / Another Brick in the Wall Part 3 / The Last Few Bricks / Goodbye Cruel World // Hey You (featuring Paul Carrack) / Is There Anybody Out There? / Nobody Home /

Vera / Bring the Boys Back Home / Comfortably Numb (featuring Van Morrison) / In the Flesh (featuring the Scorpions) / Run Like Hell (featuring the Scorpions) / Waiting for the Worms (featuring the Scorpions) / Stop / The Trial (featuring Tim Curry, Thomas Dolby, Ute Lemper, Marianne Faithfull, and Albert Finney) / The Tide is Turning

Amused to Death

September 1992

Columbia/Sony (U.K. #8 / U.S. #21)

Produced By Roger Waters, Nick Griffiths, and Patrick Leonard
The Ballad of Bill Hubbard / What God Wants Part 1 / Perfect Sense Part 1 / Perfect Sense Part 2 / The Bravery of Being Out of Range / Late Home Tonight Part 1 / Late Home Tonight Part 2 / Too Much Rope / What God Wants Part 2 / What God Wants Part 3 / Watching TV / Three Wishes / It's a Miracle / Amused to Death

In The Flesh—Live

December 2000

Columbia/Sony (U.S. — / U.K. —)

Produced by James Guthrie

In the Flesh / The Happiest Days of our Lives / Another Brick in the Wall Part 2 / Mother / Get Your Filthy Hands Off My Desert / Southampton Dock / Pigs on the Wing Part 1 / Dogs / Welcome to the Machine / Wish You Were Here / Shine on You Crazy Diamond Parts 1–8 / Set the Controls for the Heart of the Sun // Breathe (In the Air) / Time / Money / Pros and Cons of Hitch Hiking / Perfect Sense Parts 1 and 2 / The Bravery of Being Out of Range / It's a Miracle / Amused to Death / Brain Damage / Eclipse / Comfortably Numb / Each Small Candle

Ça Ira (featuring Bryn Terfel, Ying Huang, and Paul Groves)

September 2005

Sony Classical (U.K. — / U.S. —)

Produced by Roger Waters and Rick Wentworth

Act One: The Gathering Storm / Overture / Scene 1: A Garden in Vienna 1765 / Madame Antoine, Madame Antoine / Scene 2: Kings Sticks And Birds / Honest Bird, Simple Bird / I Want to Be King / Let Us Break all the Shields / Scene 3: The Grievances of the People / Scene 4: France in Disarray / To Laugh is to Know How to Live / Slavers, Landlords, Bigots at Your Door / Scene

5: The Fall of the Bastille / To Freeze in the Dead of the Night / So to the Streets in the Pouring Rain / Act Two: Scene 1: Dances and Marches / Now Hear Ye / Flushed with Wine / Scene 2: The Letter / My Dear Cousin Bourbon of Spain / The Ship of State is all at Sea / Scene 3: Silver Sugar and Indigo / To the Windward Isles / Scene 4: The Papal Edict / In Paris There's a Rumble under the Ground // Act Three: Scene One: The Fugitive King / But the Marquis of Boulli has a Trump Card up his Sleeve / To Take Your Hat Off / The Echoes Never Fade from that Fusillade / Scene 2: The Commune de Paris / Vive la Commune de Paris / The National Assembly is Confused / Scene 3: The Execution of Louis Carpet / Adieu Louis, for You It's Over / Scene 4: Marie Antoinette—The Last Night on Earth / Adieu My Good and Tender Sister / Scene 5: Liberty / And in the Bushes where They Survive

COMPILATIONS

Flickering Flame—The Solo Years

May 2002

Columbia/Sony (U.K. — / U.S. —)

Knockin' on Heaven's Door / Too Much Rope / The Tide is Turning / Perfect Sense Parts 1 and 2 / Three Wishes / 5:06AM (Every Stranger's Eyes) / Who Needs Information / Each Small Candle / Flickering Flame / Towers of Faith / Radio Waves / Lost Boys Calling

SINGLES

5:01AM (The Pros and Cons of Hitch Hiking Part 10) / 4:30AM (Apparently They Were Travelling Abroad)

April 1984

Harvest/EMI (U.K. #76) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by Roger Waters and Michael Kamen

5:06AM (Every Stranger's Eyes) / 4:56AM (For the First Time Today Part 1)

June 1984

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by Roger Waters and Michael Kamen

Radio Waves / Going to Live in L.A.

May 1987

EMI (U.K. #74) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by Roger Waters, Nick Griffiths, and Ian Richie

The Tide is Turning / Money (live)

November 1987

EMI (U.K. #54) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by Roger Waters and Nick Griffiths

**Another Brick in the Wall Part 2 (featuring Cyndi Lauper) /
Run Like Hell**

September 1990

Mercury/Phonogram (U.K. — / U.S. —)

Produced by Roger Waters and Nick Griffiths

The Tide is Turning / Nobody Home

October 1990

Mercury/Phonogram (U.K. #54 / U.S. —)

Produced by Roger Waters and Nick Griffiths

What God Wants Part 1 / What God Wants Part 1 (version)

August 1992

Columbia/Sony (U.K. #35 / U.S. —)

Produced by Roger Waters

To Kill the Child / Leaving Beirut

September 2004

Digital download

Produced by Roger Waters and Nick Griffiths

Hello (I Love You) / Hello (I Love You) (version)

March 2007

Silva Screen Records (U.K. —)

Produced by Roger Waters and James Guthrie

RICHARD WRIGHT

ALBUMS

Wet Dream

September 1978

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —) / Columbia/CBS (U.S. —)

Produced by Richard Wright

Mediterranean C / Against the Odds / Cat Cruise / Summer

Elergy / Waves / Holiday / Mad Yannis Dance / Drop in from the

Top / Pink's Song / Funky Deux

Zee—Identity

April 1984

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —)

Produced by Richard Wright and Dave Harris

Confusion / Voices / Private Person / Strange Rhythm / Cuts Like

a Diamond / By Touching / How Do You Do It / Seems We Were

Dreaming

Broken China

November 1996

EMI (U.K. —) / Guardian Records (U.S. —)

Produced by Richard Wright, Anthony Moore, and Laurie Latham

Breaking Water / Night of a Thousand Furry Toys / Hidden Fear /

Runaway / Unfair Ground / Satellite / Woman of Custom /

Interlude / Black Cloud / Far from the Harbour Wall / Drowning /

Reaching for the Rail / Blue Room in Venice / Sweet July / Along

the Shoreline / Breakthrough

SINGLES

Zee—Confusion / Eyes of a Gypsy

March 1984

Harvest/EMI (U.K. —)

Produced by Richard Wright and Dave Harris

Albums

The Piper at the Gates of Dawn (1967)



Pink Floyd's one and only album with Syd Barrett virtually defined British psychedelia in the 1960s. It's also a sparkling testament to the short-lived, shimmering genius of Barrett, who wrote almost all of this masterpiece off the top of his head, so to speak.

Liberated by LSD, Barrett's songs take flight on a magic carpet of cosmic philosophy ("Astronomy Domine," "Chapter 24"), surreal whimsy ("Matilda Mother," "Flaming") and sublime nursery-rhyme lyrics ("The Gnome," "The Scarecrow," "Bike"), bolstered by trippy, Technicolor instrumentals ("Interstellar Overdrive," "Pow R Toc H").

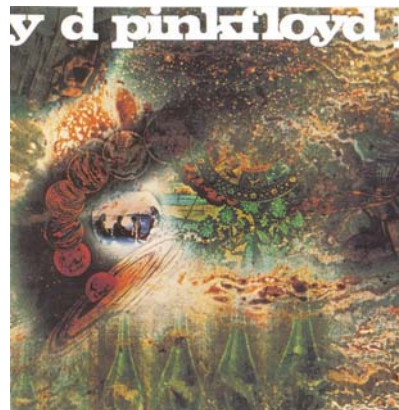
The other members are willing and able fellow travellers, having developed their style on the burgeoning London underground scene, where they were effectively the house band. Rick Wright's Farfisa organ playing in particular is a crucial element in the sound of the album, and he was clearly closest to Barrett in terms of musical empathy. Nonetheless, Roger Waters and Nick Mason provide a tight rhythmic foundation for Barrett's musical fantasies.

Credit is also due to EMI's inhouse producer Norman 'Hurricane' Smith, here stepping up to the plate for his first major production project, having previously engineered the

Beatles. He had no affiliation with or sympathy for psychedelia, but having learned all there was to know about the technical possibilities of EMI's Abbey Road Studio with the Beatles, he was able to capture the full dimension of the band's playing without compromising their edginess or Barrett's childlike innocence.

The Piper at the Gates of Dawn is a one-off. By the time it was released, in August 1967, the LSD that had enhanced Barrett's incandescent songwriting was already dragging him toward a mental hell, and when Pink Floyd came to make their next album, he was no longer a member of the band.

A Saucerful of Secrets (1968)



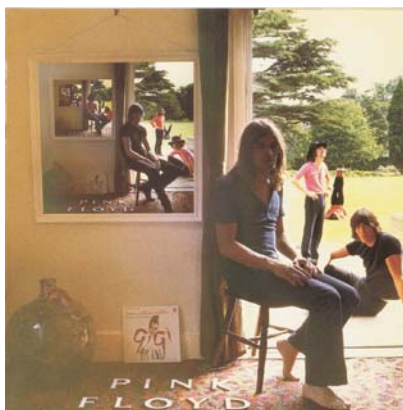
With Barrett gone, Pink Floyd were left groping for direction on their second album. Barrett's parting gift, "Jugband Blues," may sound jovial enough, but the lyrics are dark and damaged compared to the freewheeling gaiety of the first album. The

addition of a Salvation Army brass band to the song comes across as a forced attempt to lighten the mood. As the final track on *Secrets*, it makes for a dislocated farewell, especially with Barrett's closing line, "And what exactly is a dream? / And what exactly is a joke?"

Forced to rely on their own nascent songwriting, and with new guitarist David Gilmour still bedding down, the band put the emphasis on atmosphere. This works best on Waters's brooding, spacey "Set the Controls for the Heart of the Sun," with its rumbling rhythm and haunting vocal melody, and the 12-minute group-written title track, a three-part instrumental that begins with some tentative scraping and scratching, building to a rhythmic cacophony that eventually gives way to sonorous church organ. It's a template that the band would return to—with increasing finesse—on subsequent albums.

Elsewhere, Waters's opening "Let There Be More Light" kicks in with a brisk, vibrant bassline before getting bogged down by a plodding beat, although it's worth sticking with the song for Gilmour's revealing guitar solo near the end. And while Wright's breezy "Remember a Day" is promising, his other offering, "See Saw," is turgid by comparison. Overall, however, what saves *A Saucerful of Secrets* is its strong sense of determination.

Ummagumma (1969)



With no new group material prepared for their third album, Pink Floyd instead opted to give each member one half of an album side each to play with—an indulgence they scarcely warranted at this stage in their careers. Only Waters comes up with

a song worthy of the name: the gentle, acoustic "Grantchester Meadows," which evocatively recalls his childhood haunt, complete with pastoral sound effects. By contrast, the human-generated effects he provides for "Several Species of Small Furry Animals Gathered Together in a Cave and Grooving with a Pict" are, like the title, mere novelty.

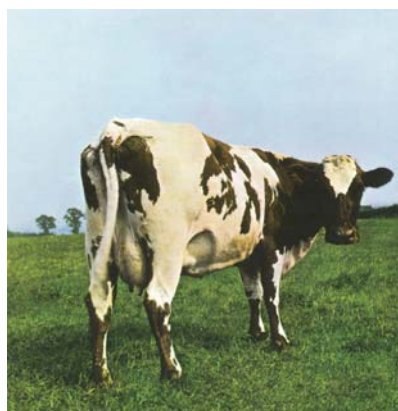
Wright's four-part "Sysyphus" is at least structured with an opening and closing theme, and some aggressive piano playing and loose sound sculptures in-between, but it's mostly too retentive to be easily accessible. Gilmour's three-part piece,

"The Narrow Way," which starts with an acoustic sequence followed by some eerie electric guitar, is also somewhat self-absorbed. Only Mason's "The Grand Vizier's Garden Party" makes an effort to engage, with its unorthodox nine-minute drum solo sandwiched between an entrance and exit theme that utilizes part of an unused Barrett instrumental.

Fortunately, the band had the good sense to include a second live album that would help sustain Pink Floyd's group identity. They punch out a tougher version of Barrett's "Astronomy Domine" before adding an edgy dynamic to "A Saucerful of Secrets" and "Set the Controls for the Heart of the Sun." Even better is a new song and fast-growing live favorite, the suspenseful "Careful with That Axe, Eugene," which finally releases its ever-growing tension with a blood-curdling scream from Waters.

All in all, *Ummagumma* served as a reminder that Pink Floyd were still around, but didn't really offer many pointers for the future.

Atom Heart Mother (1970)



After marking time with *Ummagumma*, Pink Floyd returned with renewed ambition. The title track of *Atom Heart Mother* is a 23-minute suite that employs an orchestra and choir. Such classical-rock fusions were fashionable at the time, with Deep Purple and the

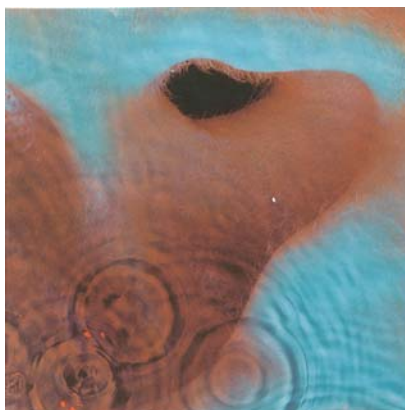
Nice among those taking the plunge, but Pink Floyd avoid the potential pitfalls by keeping the orchestral arrangements (by Ron Geesin) relatively simple. If it sounds a little stilted at times, that's down to technical recording problems rather than the concept or composition.

The opening brass bombast leads to the first of a series of mood changes that help maintain the impetus, which include a celestial-sounding choir and, most successfully, an unusually funky passage on which Waters and Wright lay down the rhythm

and Gilmour improvises sweetly on top. The recurring theme holds the piece together through some bumpy, dissonant passages, although the final five minutes appear not to have been thought through clearly enough, and the ending is somewhat inconclusive.

Waters again comes up with the best of the individual songs on the album's second side: the quietly contemplative "If," which deals with alienation—a topic that would soon become an obsession. Meanwhile, Wright gets unexpectedly personal on "Summer '68," while Gilmour makes his own way down to Grantchester Meadows on "Fat Old Sun." The final, effects-laden track, "Alan's Psychedelic Breakfast," is an indulgence to which Pink Floyd are rather more entitled this time around. And some of the quirky ideas therein will soon be developed more effectively as they hit their creative stride.

Meddle (1971)



Often regarded as the first "real" Pink Floyd album, *Meddle* leaves the last remnants of the group's psychedelic past behind them and marks the beginning of their most productive decade. Gilmour's growing confidence is almost palpable as their

trademark sound begins to coalesce. There's also a new sense of purpose and direction about the two standout tracks, "One of These Days" and "Echoes," even if they both rely on ideas that have already been explored on earlier albums.

The menacing, echo-drenched bass note that starts the opening "One of These Days" soon gives way to the relentless pounding of double-tracked guitar while Wright toys with the *Dr. Who* theme on keyboards. And after Mason's disembodied voice intones, "One of these days I'm going to cut you into little pieces," Gilmour takes over with some searing slide guitar.

Meddle is dominated by the 23-minute "Echoes," which builds gradually but deliberately from its opening "ping" of

piano through a series of cleverly linked fragments that have an aura of sophisticated mystery running through them, culminating in the tension and release of Gilmour's exquisite guitar crescendo before the final verse lets you down with a cozy glow.

The other four tracks are largely forgettable, although the wistful "A Pillow of Winds" (by Gilmour and Waters) has a pastoral charm. But it matters not. By now, Pink Floyd had reset the controls for the heart of the 1970s, revealing their true potential in the process.

Dark Side of the Moon (1973)



Pink Floyd's most consummate album, *Dark Side of the Moon* comes close to perfection, combining the group's individual talents into one groundbreaking concept set. Themed around the pressures of modern life and madness, the

potent sound dynamics highlight the contrasting imagery of the songs—light and dark, us and them—but the band keep things simple and stark, and the music is likewise tightly focused, making it easily accessible and giving it a timeless quality.

The dramatic impact of the album is enhanced by the various sound effects, which are integrated into the rhythm of the songs: the heartbeat and manic laughter at the start of "Speak to Me," the cacophony of clocks at the beginning of "Time," and of course the coin-clashing, speaker-hopping, register-ringing "Money," which has become Pink Floyd's most recognizable anthem.

Gilmour's guitar provides a superb instrumental identity to the band—particularly with the solo on "Time"—but the whole band sound closer here than they ever will again. That said, they were unafraid to bring in outsiders who they felt could add something more—Clare Torry's anguished vocal on "The Great Gig in the Sky," perhaps the most seductive song ever written

about death, certainly does just that. So too does saxophonist Chris Parry, with his strident solo on “Money,” and his more measured contribution to “Us and Them.” *Dark Side of the Moon* took a huge conscious effort to make, but it possesses a vitality that still has the power to thrill.

Wish You Were Here (1975)



Despite the daunting prospect of having to follow *Dark Side of the Moon*, *Wish You Were Here* rises admirably to the challenge. What it lacks in dynamics and interplay, it more than makes up for in tension and control—nowhere more so than during

the album’s first four minutes, where Gilmour’s taut guitar and Wright’s keyboard chords stretch the suspense to breaking point and beyond before Gilmour finally provides exquisite relief with a simple, unadorned, four-note riff.

That riff sets the mournful tone for “Shine on You Crazy Diamond,” an epic 26-minute eulogy to Syd Barrett that bookends the album and is arguably the finest track the band would ever produce. While the ghost of Syd hovers above many a Pink Floyd album, “Shine on . . .” is the only track written specifically about him, celebrating the genius that leaked into madness while mourning his loss to the band. Waters’s lyrics and the band’s playing are so complimentary it hurts.

Between the two halves of this epic are a pair of rants against the system—the acerbic “Welcome to the Machine” and the viciously cynical “Have a Cigar”—and the melancholic, acoustic title track, which neatly sums up how the band were feeling at the time.

Despite Waters’s growing dominance of Pink Floyd, *Wish You Were Here* is still very much a “band” album, with each of the musicians contributing to the overall sound. It may not have the spark and fizz of *Dark Side*, but in other ways it cuts much deeper.

Animals (1977)



The first Pink Floyd album on which the lyrics play as big a part as the music, *Animals* is Waters’s bleak, Orwellian view of the world, summed up by the antics of “Dogs,” “Pigs (Three Different Ones),” and “Sheep.” Said dogs are selfish,

greedy yuppies, trampling over everyone else to get to the top and then trampling over each other; the three different kinds of pig each have their own morality, which they try to impose on everyone else; and the sheep are the exploited masses who rise up against the dogs, egged on by a sarcastic parody of the 23rd Psalm. At either end of this barrage of cynicism is an optimistic, personal, acoustic love song, “Pigs on the Wing,” which attempts to lighten the gloom.

Ironically, there’s as much vitriol pouring out of *Animals* as there was from any of the punk albums released at the time. Pink Floyd may not snarl very effectively, but when it comes to creating a sustained atmosphere of brooding menace they are in their element. The sound of *Animals* is dank and constricted, pierced occasionally by fists of noise and some superb expletives of guitar from Gilmour.

Animals is not a pretty album, but then it was never meant to be. It conveys its message in the stark yet consummate manner Pink Floyd had made entirely their own. It was never going to appeal to the rock’n’roll fashion victims—not when punk was about to provide them with another photo opportunity—but then *Animals* doesn’t need safety pins to hold it together.

The Wall (1979)



The most spectacular piece of rock theater ever devised, *The Wall* is the pinnacle of Pink Floyd's achievements. Conceived by Waters as a (double) album, stage show, and film, it takes the recurring themes of the band's previous three albums to their logical

conclusion, homing in on the barriers people erect around themselves for protection as well as the barriers society imposes for control.

The Wall is a dense affair, its metaphors, allusions, and flashbacks often hard to follow. But it's saved by the atmosphere and the sense of drama that—once you're hooked—keeps you primed for more. It's also enlivened by a handful of superb songs. There's the opening, bombastic "In The Flesh?," a not-so-subtle slab of heavy rock that sets the scene. There's Pink Floyd's greatest hit, "Another Brick in the Wall Part 2," with its rant against the excesses of the education system and unlikely disco rhythms. There's "Hey You," a heartfelt plea for human contact from the other side of the wall. There's "Comfortably Numb," possibly the most powerful and emotional song the band would ever record, and fittingly the final collaboration between Waters and Gilmour. And there's the potent, guitar-driven antifascist howl, "Run Like Hell."

The Wall is more of a soundtrack album than previous Pink Floyd albums—even previous Pink Floyd soundtrack albums. Some people prefer the live album, *Is There Anybody Out There—The Wall Live 1980–81*, which lacks the subtlety of its studio counterpart but is easier to follow. Take your pick.

The Final Cut (1983)



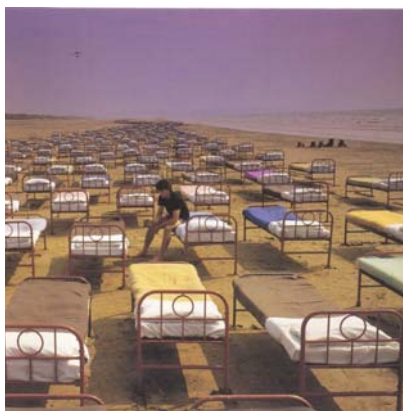
Effectively a Roger Waters solo album in all but name, *The Final Cut* is disappointing as a Pink Floyd record but a good start to Waters's solo career. It's a disappointing Pink Floyd record because the band are barely on it—Wright was gone by now, while

Gilmour and Mason were restricted to doing as they were told. The overall theme—the futility of war—was never going to be a barrel of laughs, but without the other members' distinctive sense of drama (or their restraining influence) the atmosphere of unrelenting gloom becomes overwhelming.

As an album, however, *The Final Cut* has a greater sense of clarity than *The Wall*. It is certainly more bitter and vicious, as the opening track, "The Post War Dream," clearly demonstrates with its caustic attack on the nature of war. And if that doesn't prove the point, check out the dark humor of "The Fletcher Memorial Home," on which Waters literally spits out his condemnation of the world's "incurable tyrants": Margaret Thatcher, Ronald Reagan, and Leonid Brezhnev among them.

Having lambasted the carnage and death of World War II, Waters appeared to regard the Falklands War of 1982 as a personal affront. His focused anger makes for some devastating antiwar propaganda, but whether that makes for a great rock'n'roll album is rather more debatable. Ironically, Waters might have got more respect and attention had he released *The Final Cut* under his own name.

A Momentary Lapse of Reason (1987)

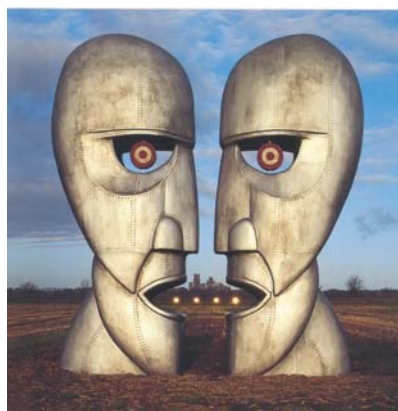


If *The Final Cut* is effectively a Waters solo album, where does that leave *A Momentary Lapse of Reason*? Without Waters, obviously. Mason and Wright are barely present, too, suggesting that this might be more of a Gilmour solo album, although it bears little

resemblance to his own *About Face*, released three years earlier. Rather, *A Momentary Lapse of Reason* is Gilmour's attempt to make a Pink Floyd album without Waters. His guitar and voice are a clearly identifiable part of the Pink Floyd sound, so there is an instant familiarity. He had also enlisted producer Bob Ezrin, who worked on *The Wall* (and *About Face*), to provide some continuity. And he roped in lyricist Anthony Moore to fill the gap that Waters left.

The opening "Signs of Life" has the same mood-setting atmosphere as "Speak to Me" (from *Dark Side of the Moon*) and "Shine on You Crazy Diamond." Later on, "The Dogs of War" could be a sequel to the songs from *Animals*, while "A New Machine" could refer to "Welcome to the Machine" (from *Wish You Were Here*). And despite its commercial aspirations, parts of "One Slip" are not dissimilar to elements of *The Wall*. On the other hand, "Learning to Fly" and "On the Turning Away" have been tweaked into radio-friendly rock by Ezrin. They are both great rock songs, but whether they are Pink Floyd songs is another matter. The inescapable fact is that without the presence of both Gilmour and Waters, a Pink Floyd album will always struggle to live up to the name.

The Division Bell (1994)



If you accept *A Momentary Lapse of Reason* as a Pink Floyd album, *The Division Bell* will make you feel better. It's a much more creditable attempt to make a Pink Floyd album without Waters.

For a start, Mason and Wright are back

onboard as fully participating members of the band, bringing a greater sense of musical legitimacy as well as a studied elegance to the proceedings. Wright arguably makes his strongest contribution to a Pink Floyd album since *Wish You Were Here*. There's also an easy familiarity running through the tracks as the band deftly rework their own trademarks with the benefit of better technology, courtesy of Bob Ezrin, who produces once again.

There's even a theme running through the album—communication, or rather the lack of it. It's an appropriate topic for Pink Floyd to tackle, although it's fair to say that Waters would not have done it this way. Many of the songs—notably "What Do You Want from Me," "Poles Apart," "Wearing the Inside Out," "Keep Talking," and "Lost for Words," are concerned with various aspects of the difficulties we have in communicating with each other. Gilmour's new wife, Polly Samson helped to harden the album's conceptual feel, cowriting many of the lyrics with her husband. Almost certainly the last Pink Floyd studio album, *The Division Bell* allowed the band to bow out in pristine fashion—which may or may not be what you want from them.



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PINK FLOYD LIKE YOU'VE NEVER SEEN BEFORE...

Covering nearly a half a century of rock, *Pink Floyd: Behind the Wall* showcases the dramatic and colorful history of the most popular psychedelic band the world has ever known. From their early roots in Cambridge with Syd Barrett penning lyrics to the unforgettable recording of *Dark Side of the Moon* and the eventual split between the band members, this is the first complete illustrated history of Pink Floyd. Discover secrets behind the songs, the evolution of their legendary light shows and puppets, the bitter disputes, and more. Featuring a complete discography and complemented by more than 200 images of Syd Barrett, Roger Waters, David Gilmour, Rick Wright, and Nick Mason, including live performances and candid off-stage photographs, *Pink Floyd: Behind the Wall* lets readers get a glimpse into the secret life of one of the most revolutionary bands ever to take the stage.

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